ImpactMEL

USER GUIDE

ImpactMEL

Plan, collect, check and report on your programmes. A task-by-task guide for every role.

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About this guide

This guide describes ImpactMEL release v0.10.36, with the interface introduced in version 2. It is printed from the online documentation at docs.impactmel.com, which is kept up to date with each release.

Screenshots come from the ImpactMEL demonstration workspace, Meridian Impact Alliance. Its people and figures are invented. Links in this guide open the matching page online.

Plans and prices are published at impactmel.com/pricing. For help, write to inquiries@impactmel.com.

PART

Getting started

1 Introduction

ImpactMEL is monitoring, evaluation and learning software for organisations that have to show what their programmes achieved, and prove it.

It holds your results framework, indicators and targets, collects figures from the field, puts every figure through review, and assembles donor reports from the approved record. Directors, M&E teams, programme staff, field teams, finance staff and funders all work in the same workspace, each with the screens their job needs.

1.1 Who it is for

- **National and international NGOs** reporting to several donors from one set of figures.
- **Government programmes and agencies** that need a clear approval trail. ImpactMEL can also run on your own servers.
- **Consortiums** where partners report into one framework.
- **Funders** who want consistent results from the organisations they fund.
- **Individual M&E consultants and officers** who report on their own work.

1.2 Key ideas

One approved record

Every figure in ImpactMEL has a status. It starts as a draft, is sent for review, and is either returned with a reason or approved. Only approved figures count in dashboards, progress and reports. The same approved figure feeds every report and every donor format, so the number you send one donor is the number you send the next.

Once approved, a figure is locked. Every change before that point is kept in its history, with who made it and when.

Plan, collect, check, report

The product follows the order of the work:

Stage	What you do	Where
Plan	Set up programmes and projects, build the results framework, define indicators with baselines and targets	Programmes and projects, Results framework, Indicators
Collect	Build forms, collect from phones and links, register participants, track activities	Forms, Collecting data, Participants
Check	Review figures with automatic checks, approve or return them, close and lock periods	Review and data quality, Reporting periods
Report	Analyse, build dashboards, assemble and publish reports, share them by link	Analysis, Reports

Roles

People are given roles, and a role is a set of permissions. ImpactMEL comes with seven built-in roles: Organisation admin, Director, M&E officer, Programme manager, Field officer, Finance officer and Viewer. Each role opens on its own home page with its own menu. A person can hold several roles and gets everything those roles allow together. Administrators can change any role or create new ones. See Roles at a glance.

Reporting periods

Figures and targets belong to reporting periods. A period is identified by its start and end dates, so quarters and years can sit side by side. Periods can be closed when collection ends and locked when the figures are final.

Nothing inferred is shown as fact

ImpactMEL shows what was reported and approved. Where something is missing, it says so: a report prints "Explanation outstanding" or "No target set" rather than a guess. Text drafted by AI is marked as a draft and cannot be published until a person accepts it.

1.3 Where ImpactMEL runs

ImpactMEL runs in our managed cloud, where each organisation has its own web address, for example `yourorganisation.impactmel.com`. It can also be installed on your own infrastructure. See Security and data and Plans.

1.4 How to use this documentation

- New to ImpactMEL? Start with Sign up and Set up your workspace.
- Joining a workspace someone else set up? Read Finding your way and the page for your role.
- Looking for a task? The user manual is organised by what you want to do.
- Prefer to watch? The video guides show each main task end to end.

The screenshots come from the ImpactMEL demonstration workspace, Meridian Impact Alliance. Its people and figures are invented.

2 Sign up

You can create an ImpactMEL workspace yourself in a few minutes. You choose a plan first, create your account, verify your email and then set up the workspace.

Joining an existing workspace?
If a colleague has invited you, you do not need to sign up. Open the link in your invitation email instead. See Accept an invitation.

2.1 Before you start

You need a work email address you can read, and a few minutes. Every plan can start with a 30-day free trial, so you do not need a card to look around. Plans and prices are on the pricing page.

2.2 Steps

Go to app.impactmel.com/signup. A panel on the left shows the steps and where you are.

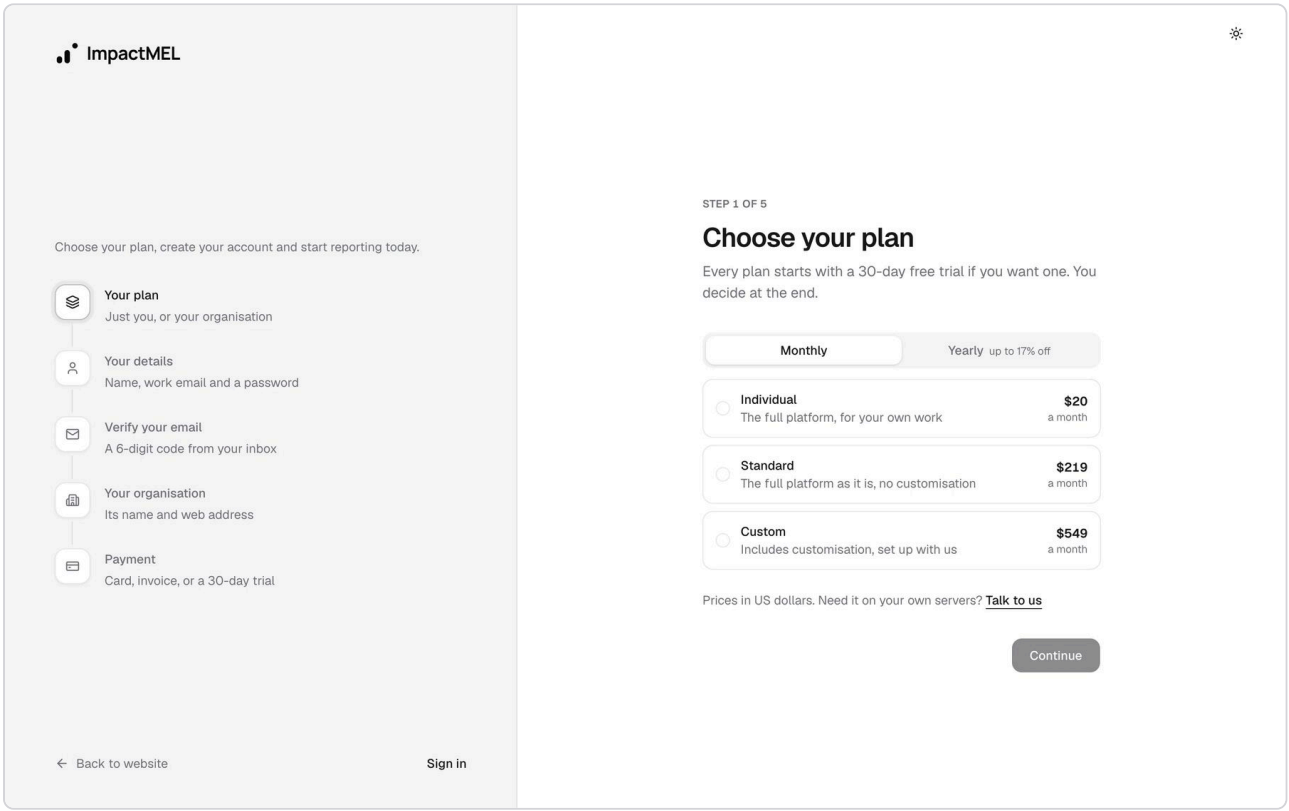


Figure 2.1 The first step of sign-up: choose a plan, monthly or yearly.

1. **Your plan.** Choose **Individual**, **Standard** or **Custom**, and **Monthly** or **Yearly**. If you came from the pricing page with a plan chosen, this step is skipped.
   - **Individual** is for one person reporting on their own work.
   - **Standard** is the full platform as it is, for an organisation that wants to start straight away.

- **Custom** adds customisation of your framework, forms, reports and workflows, set up with us.

2. **Your details.** Enter your full name, work email and a password of at least 8 characters. You can also choose **Sign up with Google** or **Sign up with Microsoft**.
3. **Verify your email.** We send a 6-digit code to your email. Type it in. If it has not arrived, wait 30 seconds and choose **Resend code**.
4. **Your organisation.** Enter your organisation's name and choose its web address, for example `meridian.impactmel.com`. Individual plans skip this step: the workspace is named after you.
5. **Payment.** Choose how to pay:
   - **Pay by card** opens a secure checkout with our payment provider, Polar.
   - **Pay by invoice** asks where to send the invoice and an optional purchase order number. Invoices are not available on Individual.
   - **Start 30-day free trial** lets you begin without paying. You can choose a payment method before the trial ends.

When you finish, ImpactMEL opens your workspace at its own address and starts the set-up steps. Continue with Set up your workspace.

2.3 Signing in later

Sign in at app.impactmel.com/login or at your organisation's own address.

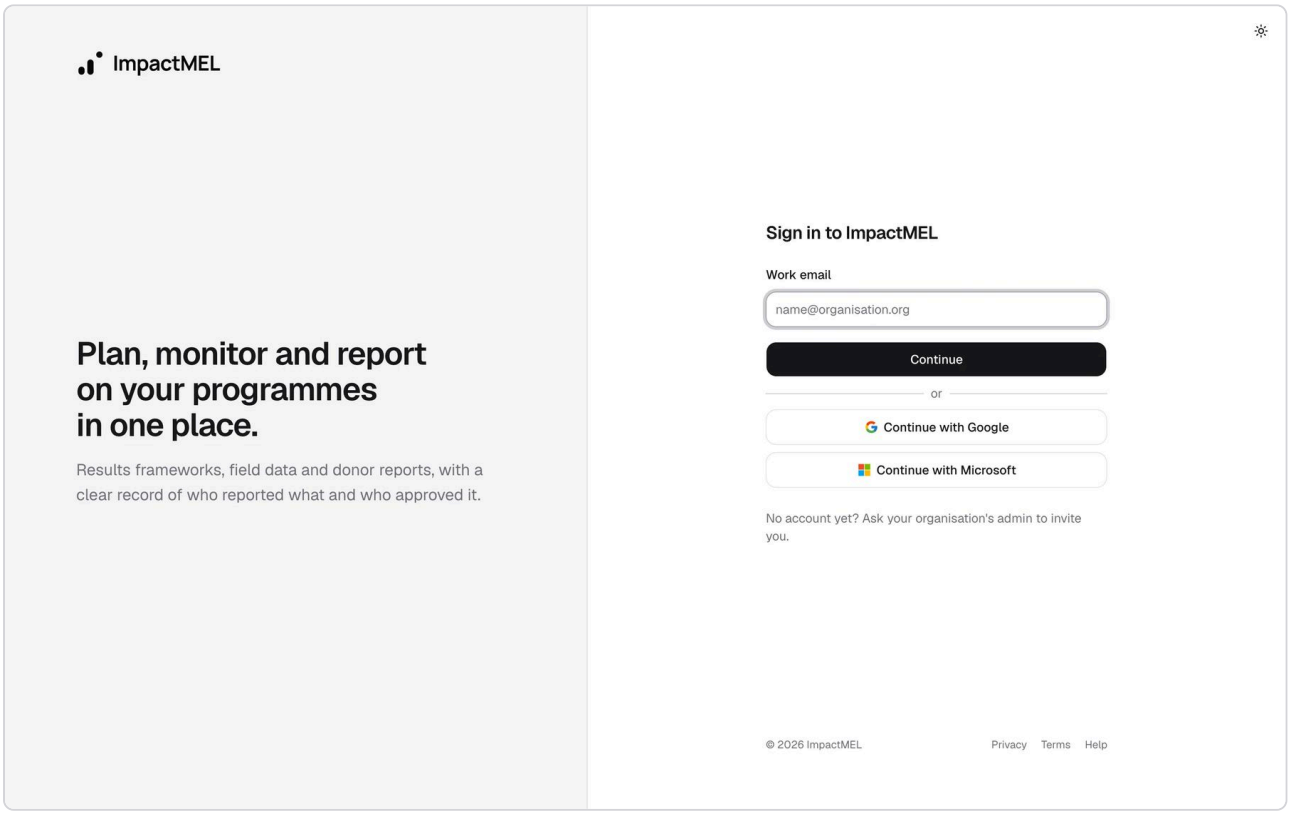


Figure 2.2 The sign-in page.

1. Enter your work email and choose **Continue**.
2. Enter your password, or choose **Continue with Google** or **Continue with Microsoft**.

3. If you belong to more than one organisation, choose the one you want.

Microsoft work accounts are accepted when Microsoft confirms that the email domain belongs to your organisation. Otherwise ImpactMEL asks you to use your password.

Forgotten password

Choose **Forgot password?** on the sign-in page and enter your email. The reset link works once, for one hour.

Organisations on their own server

Some organisations run ImpactMEL on their own servers. If yours does, use the address your administrator gave you, or choose **Find its address** on the sign-in page.

3 Set up your workspace

After sign-up, ImpactMEL takes the owner through four short steps: your role, your logo and currency, your reporting calendar, and your team. Each step can be skipped and changed later.

The set-up opens with **Welcome**. Choose **Get started**, or **Skip for now** to go straight to your home page.

3.1 Your role

Choose the role closest to your job: Director or senior manager, M&E officer, Programme or project manager, Field officer or data collector, Finance officer or accountant, System administrator, or Something else. Your home page follows this choice. As the person who created the workspace, you are its **owner** and keep full access whatever you choose here.

3.2 Make the workspace yours

- **Upload logo.** PNG, JPG, WebP or SVG, up to 2 MB. The logo appears in the sidebar and on every report and public page.
- **Country.** ImpactMEL suggests one from your time zone.
- **Currency.** The reporting currency for budgets and spending.

3.3 How often do you report?

Choose your **reporting frequency** (monthly, quarterly, every six months or yearly) and the month your **financial year starts in**. ImpactMEL shows a preview of your periods and creates them when you continue. You can add or change periods later. See Reporting periods.

3.4 Invite your team

Add colleagues by email and choose the access each one gets: Admin, Director, M&E officer, Programme manager, Finance officer, Field officer or Viewer. Choose **Add another** for more rows, then **Send invites and finish**. Individual plans do not have this step.

3.5 After set-up

Administrators see a **Getting started** card on their home page with the next things to do: invite your team, add your logo, set your reporting calendar and check what each role can do.

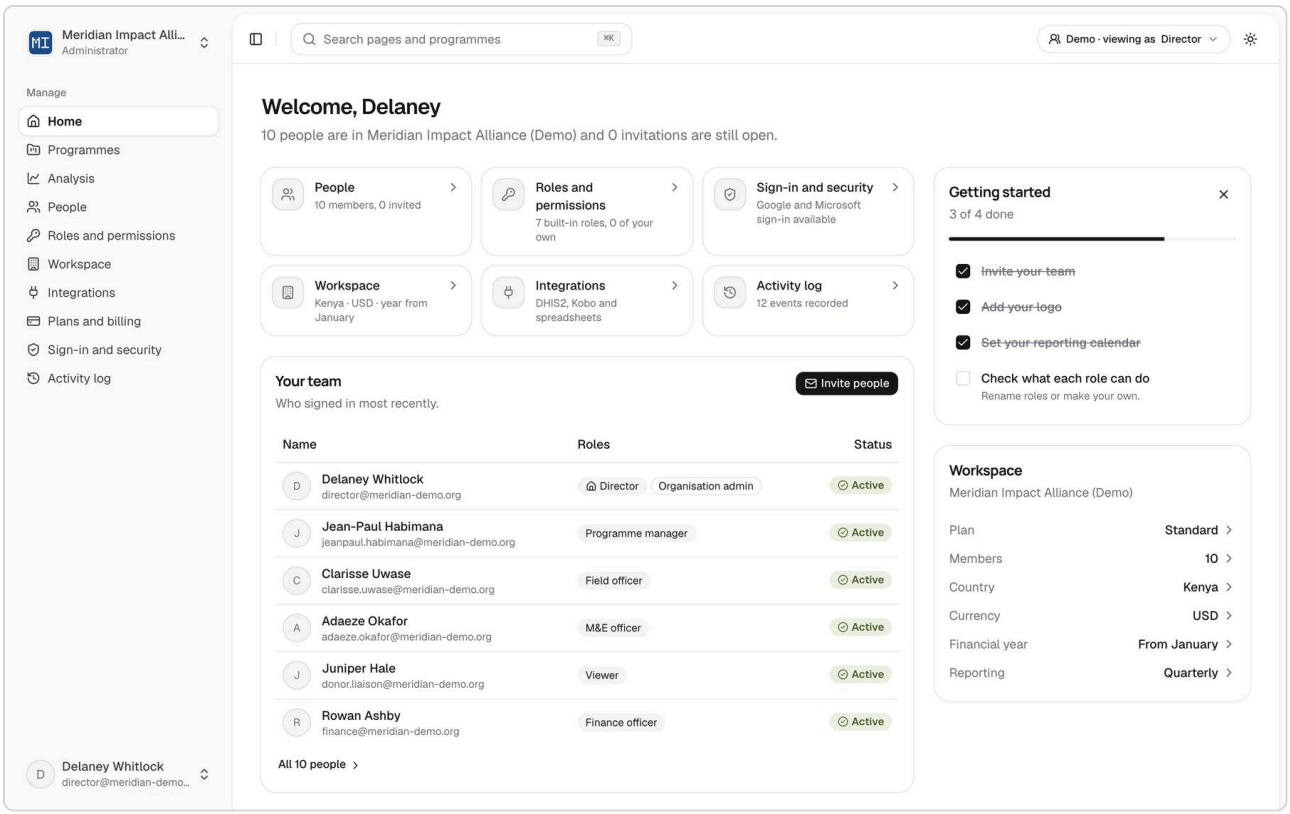


Figure 3.1 The administrator's home page with the Getting started card.

In a new workspace with no programmes yet, M&E officers and programme managers see a **Get started** panel instead, with these steps in order:

1. Create your first programme. See Programmes and projects.
2. Build its results framework. See Results framework.
3. Add indicators and targets. See Indicators, baselines and targets.
4. Invite your team. See Invite your team.
5. Collect your first figures. See Collecting data.

All workspace settings can be changed later under **Workspace**. See Administration.

4 Invite your team

People join a workspace by invitation. Each invitation carries the roles the person will have. Invitations are sent by email and last 7 days.

4.1 Invite people

You need permission to manage people. By default that is the Organisation admin.

1. Open **People** in the sidebar.
2. Choose **Invite people**.
3. Enter one or more email addresses, separated by commas. Everyone in one invitation gets the same roles.
4. Tick the roles they should have. The description under each role says what it can do.
5. Choose **Send invitation**.

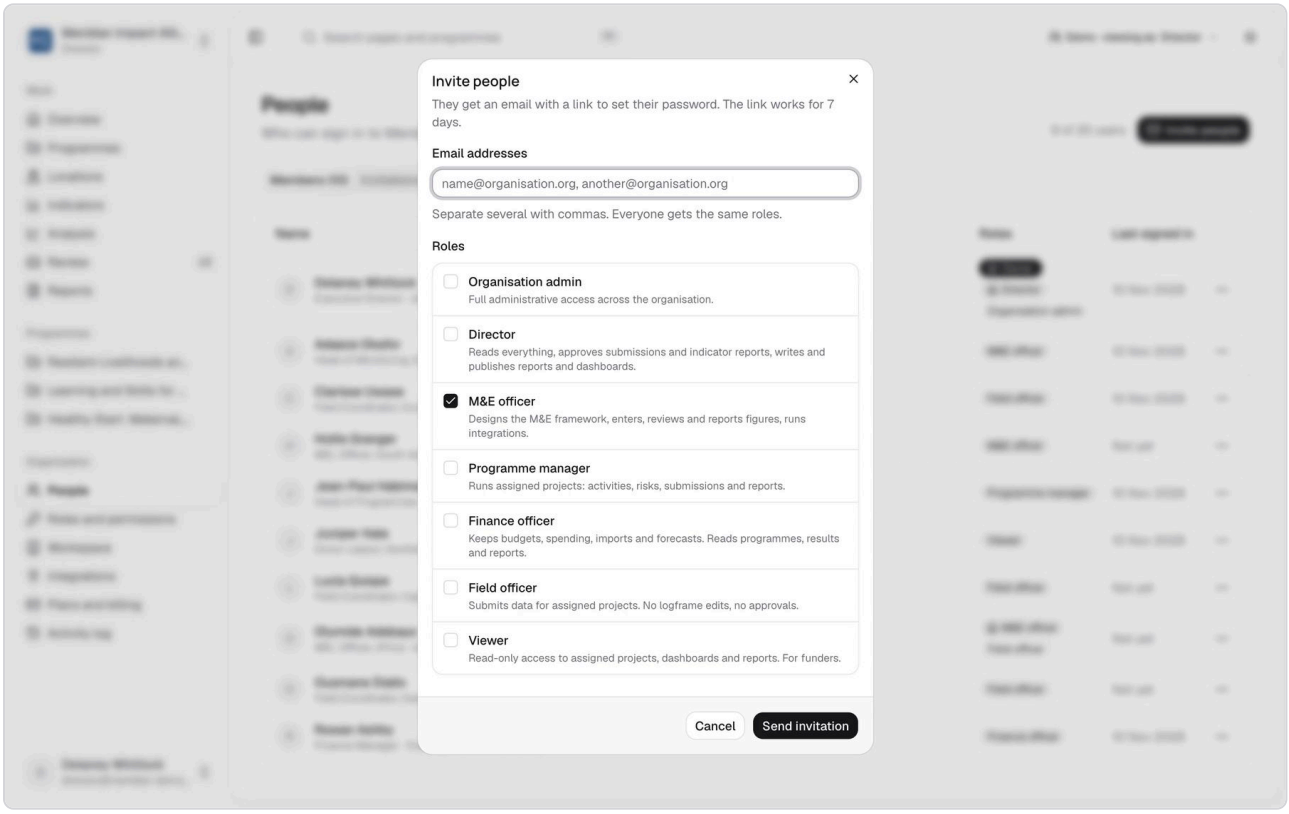


Figure 4.1 Inviting people and choosing their roles.

Only the owner can give someone the Organisation admin role. Other administrators can only give access they hold themselves.

4.2 Manage invitations

The **Invitations** tab on the People page lists invitations that have not been accepted. For each one you can:

- **Send again**, if the email was missed.
- **Copy link**, to send it another way.
- **Cancel invitation**, if it was sent by mistake.

4.3 Accept an invitation

When someone invites you, you receive an email from ImpactMEL.

1. Open the link in the email.
2. If you are new to ImpactMEL, enter your first name, last name and a password of at least 8 characters.
3. Choose **Accept and continue**.

If you already have an ImpactMEL account with the same email, sign in and choose **Accept and continue**. If you are signed in with a different email, sign out first.

An invitation that has expired, been withdrawn or already been used shows a message saying so. Ask the person who invited you to send it again.

4.4 Which role to give

Person	Role
Head of organisation, country director	Director
Head of MEL, M&E officer	M&E officer
Project or programme manager	Programme manager
Enumerator, data collector, field staff	Field officer
Finance manager, accountant	Finance officer
Board member, external reviewer, donor contact	Viewer
IT or office administrator	Organisation admin

A person can hold more than one role. See Roles at a glance.

5 Finding your way

Every person sees a short sidebar built for their role, a search bar that reaches any page they can open, and a user menu for their profile and settings.

5.1 The sidebar

The sidebar has up to three groups:

- **Work** holds the pages for your role, such as Home, Programmes, Review or Reports.
- **Programmes** or **My projects** lists the programmes or projects you work on, so you can open them in one click.
- **Organisation** lists the workspace pages your permissions open, such as People or Workspace.

Items you do not have permission for are hidden, not greyed out. Choose the panel icon at the top to collapse the sidebar to icons.

5.2 Search

Press ⌘ K on a Mac or Ctrl K on Windows, or choose **Search pages and programmes** at the top. Type the name of a page, programme or project and press Enter. Search only lists what you are allowed to open, including pages that are not in your sidebar, such as **Risks**.

5.3 Home pages link to their detail

Every number and row on a home page opens the page behind it, already filtered. For example, "12 at risk" opens the Indicators page showing those 12 indicators.

5.4 The user menu

Choose your name at the bottom of the sidebar.

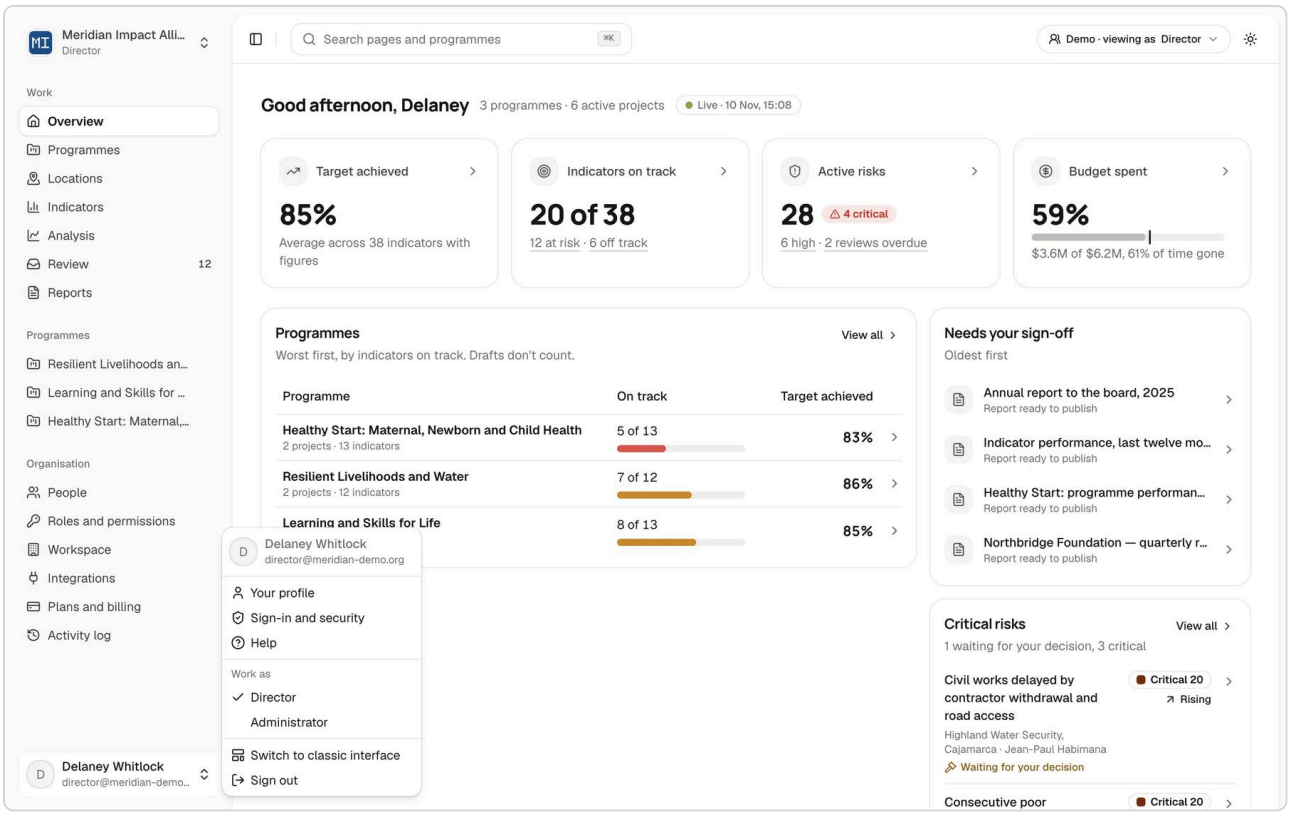


Figure 5.1 The user menu, with Work as for people who hold more than one role.

- **Your profile.** Your photo, name and job title, and the roles you hold.
- **Sign-in and security.** Your sign-in methods and password.
- **Help.** Opens this documentation.
- **Work as.** Appears only if you hold more than one role. It changes your home page and menu to that role. It does not change your permissions: you can always do everything your roles allow together.
- **Switch to classic interface.** Opens the previous ImpactMEL interface. Your choice is remembered, and you can switch back from the same menu or from your profile.
- **Sign out.**

5.5 Light and dark

Choose the sun icon at the top right to switch between light and dark.

5.6 On a phone

ImpactMEL works in a phone's browser. The sidebar becomes a menu button, and pages stack into one column. Field officers have a phone-first filling page for forms. See Collecting data.

PART

Roles

6 Roles at a glance

A role is a set of permissions. ImpactMEL comes with seven built-in roles. Each opens on its own home page with its own menu, so people see the work that is theirs first.

6.1 The built-in roles

Role	Home page shows	Can
Organisation admin	Your team, invitations, workspace and setup shortcuts	Everything, including people, roles, workspace settings, integrations and billing
Director	The portfolio, indicators at risk, risks, reports to sign off	Read everything, approve figures, judge results, approve budgets, publish reports, decide on risks
M&E officer	Review queue, reporting periods, programme performance, deadlines	Build frameworks, indicators and forms, review and approve figures, close periods, write and publish reports
Programme manager	This week's activities, deadlines and project progress	Manage their projects, activities, budgets and risks
Field officer	Figures to correct or send, and forms to fill	Send figures and form responses, correct returned figures
Finance officer	Spending this period, explanations due, sign-offs waiting	Set up budgets, record spending, write variance explanations
Viewer	A read-only overview of the portfolio	Read results, dashboards and published reports

Funders have their own workspace with separate roles. See Viewer and funder and Funder workspace.

6.2 Rules that always apply

- **The owner.** The person who creates the workspace is its owner and keeps full access. Nobody can remove or demote the last owner. Ownership can be transferred from the People page.
- **Several roles.** A person can hold several roles. Their access is everything those roles allow together. Their home page follows the role chosen as **Opens on**, and they can change it with **Work as** in the user menu.
- **No self-promotion.** Only owners can make someone an owner or Organisation admin. Anyone else who manages people can only give access they already have, never to themselves.
- **Assigned projects.** Field officers and other roles limited to their projects see only the projects they are assigned to. Someone with no project assignment sees an empty portfolio.
- **Individual plan.** On the Individual plan, the one person holds every role and approves their own work.

6.3 Changing what a role can do

Administrators can change the permissions of any role, including the built-in ones, and create new roles. See Roles and permissions.

7 Organisation admin

The Organisation admin looks after the workspace: who is in it, what each person can do, how the workspace is set up, and how it is paid for.

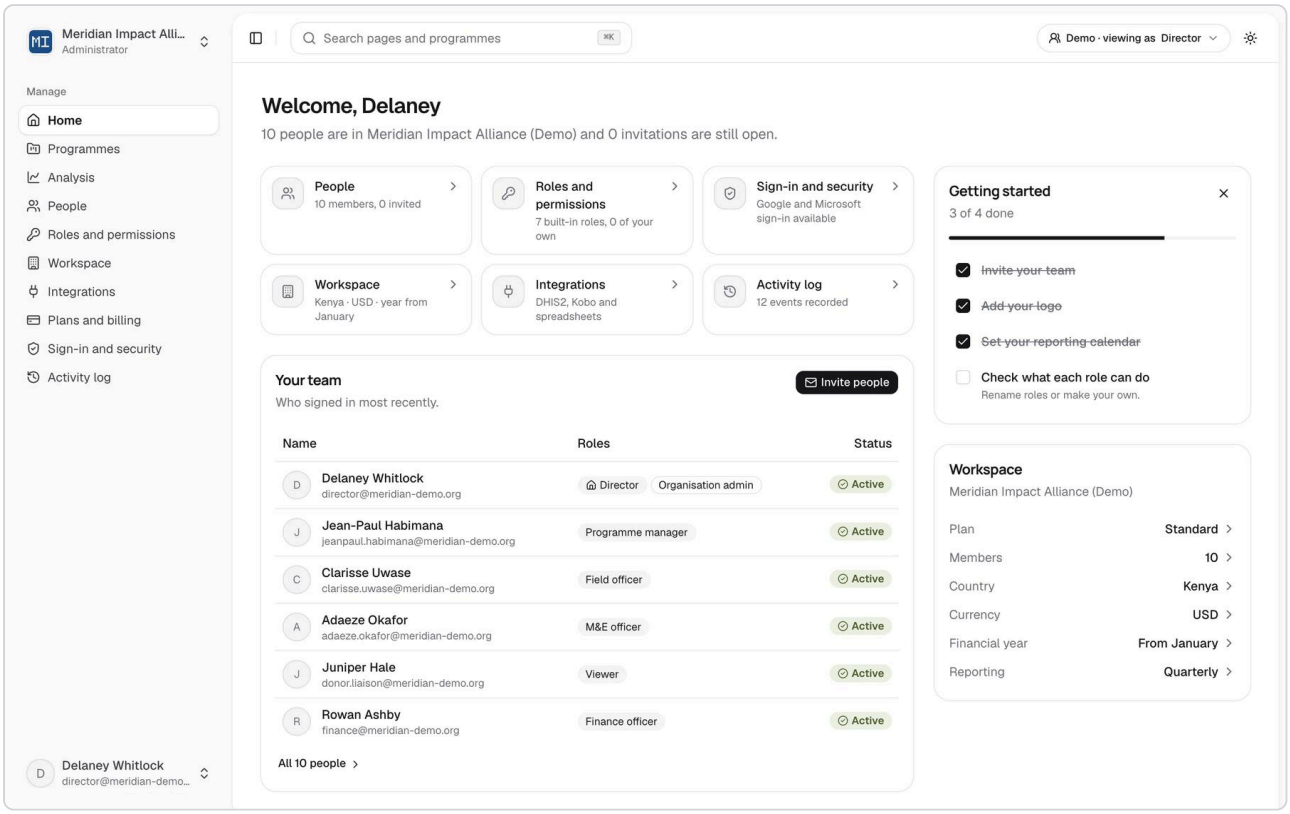


Figure 7.1 The Organisation admin home page.

7.1 Home page

- **Shortcut cards** for People, Roles and permissions, Sign-in and security, Workspace, Integrations and Activity log, each with a short status.
- **Your team**, listing members and their roles, with **Invite people**.
- **Workspace**, a summary of your plan, country, currency and reporting calendar.
- **Getting started**, a checklist for a new workspace.

7.2 Menu

Home, Programmes, Analysis, People, Roles and permissions, Workspace, Integrations, Plans and billing, Sign-in and security, Activity log.

7.3 Common tasks

- Invite people and change their roles
- Create or change a role

- Change the logo, currency or reporting calendar
- Switch AI features on or off
- Connect KoboToolbox or DHIS2
- See who changed what
- Change plan or payment method
- Transfer ownership

The admin role holds every permission, so an admin can also do the work of any other role.

8 Director

The Director sees the whole portfolio on one page: how close each programme is to its targets, which indicators and risks need attention, and which reports are waiting for sign-off.

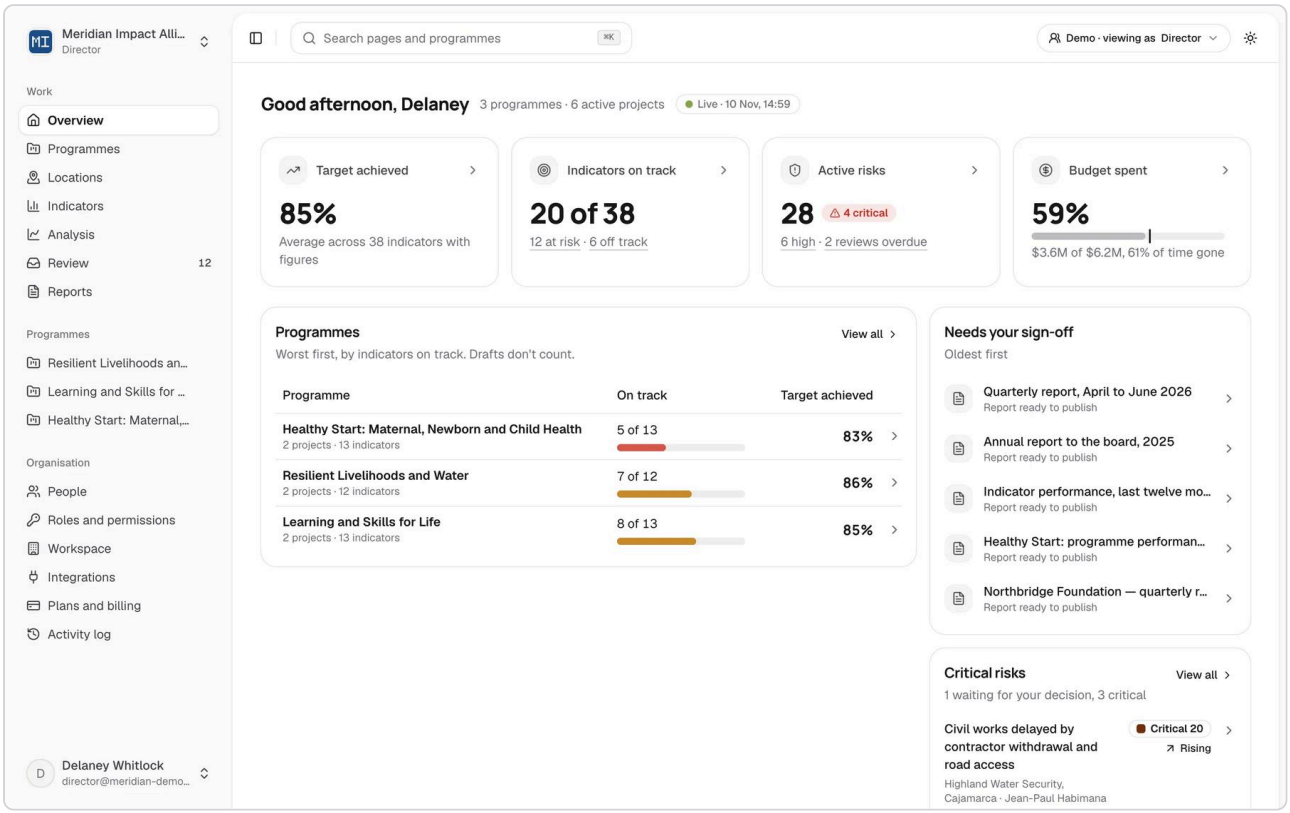


Figure 8.1 The Director's Overview.

8.1 Overview page

- **Target achieved.** The average progress across all indicators with approved figures.
- **Indicators on track.** How many are on track, at risk and off track, against targets that have fallen due.
- **Active risks.** The count, with critical and high risks and overdue reviews.
- **Budget spent.** Spending to date against approved budgets and time gone.
- **Programmes**, worst first by indicators on track. Drafts do not count.
- **Needs your sign-off.** Reports ready to publish, budgets to approve and risk decisions.
- **Critical risks** and **Coming up** (the next deadlines).

Every number opens the list behind it.

8.2 Menu

Overview, Programmes, Locations, Indicators, Analysis, Review, Reports. Directors also see the workspace pages their permissions open.

8.3 What a Director does

- Approve or return figures, including as second approver where a project needs two.
- Record a performance judgement for a result.
- Approve a budget version and sign off spending periods.
- Decide on an escalated risk.
- Publish a report and create a read-only link for a funder.

9 M&E officer

The M&E officer builds the measurement system and keeps the data trustworthy: the results framework, indicators and targets, forms, the review queue, reporting periods and reports.

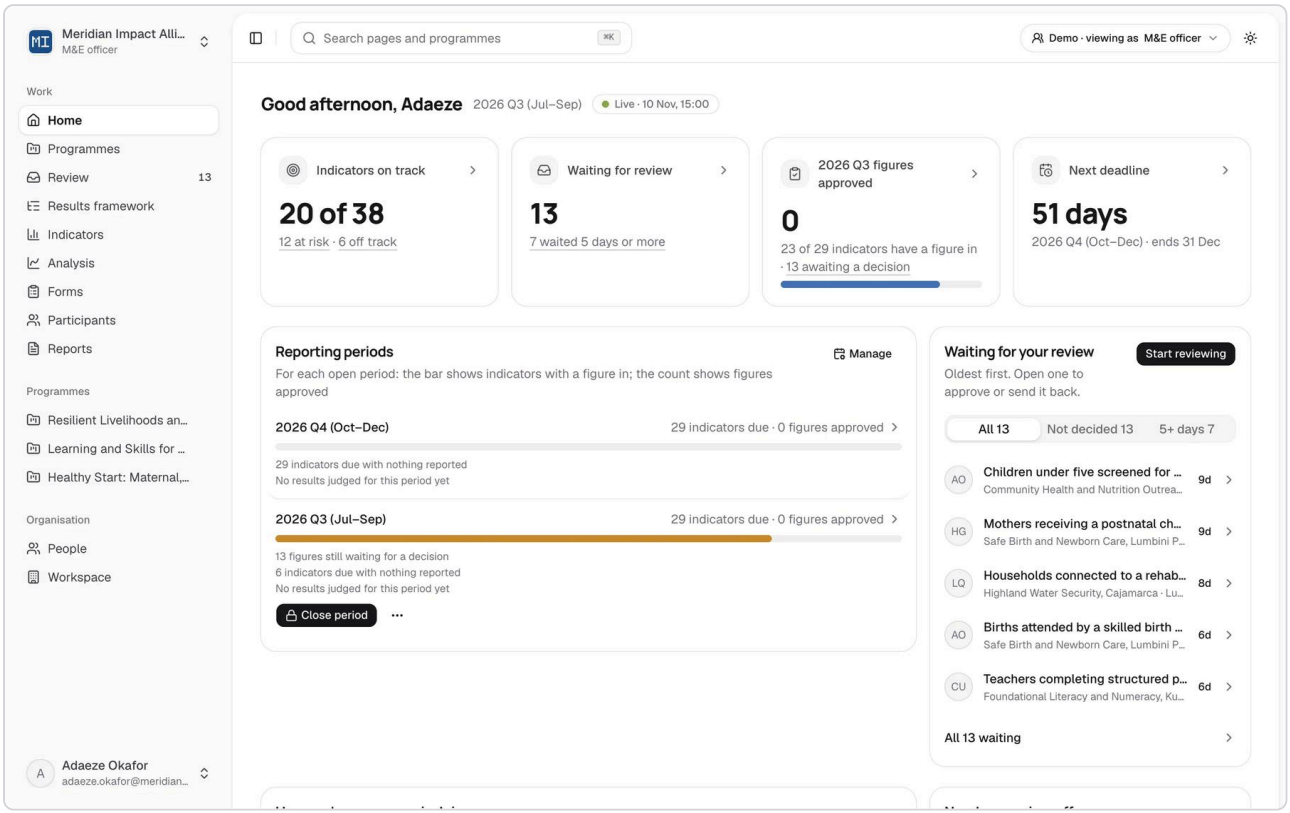


Figure 9.1 The M&E officer's home page.

9.1 Home page

- **Indicators on track**, **Waiting for review**, **figures approved** for the current period, and **Next deadline**.
- **Reporting periods.** For each open period, how many indicators have a figure in and how many are approved, with what is outstanding and a **Close period** button. **Manage** opens all periods.
- **Waiting for your review**, oldest first, with **Start reviewing**.
- **How each programme is doing**, **Due soon**, indicators behind target, and risks.

9.2 Menu

Home, Programmes, Review, Results framework, Indicators, Analysis, Forms, Participants, Reports. Integrations open from Forms, and the activity log opens from Review's **History** tab.

9.3 Common tasks

- Build the results framework
- Define an indicator with baseline and targets
- Build and publish a form
- Review, approve or return figures
- Close and lock a reporting period
- Assemble and publish a report
- Build a dashboard and share it

10 Programme manager

The Programme manager runs projects day to day: activities, deadlines, budgets and risks, with progress against targets always in view.

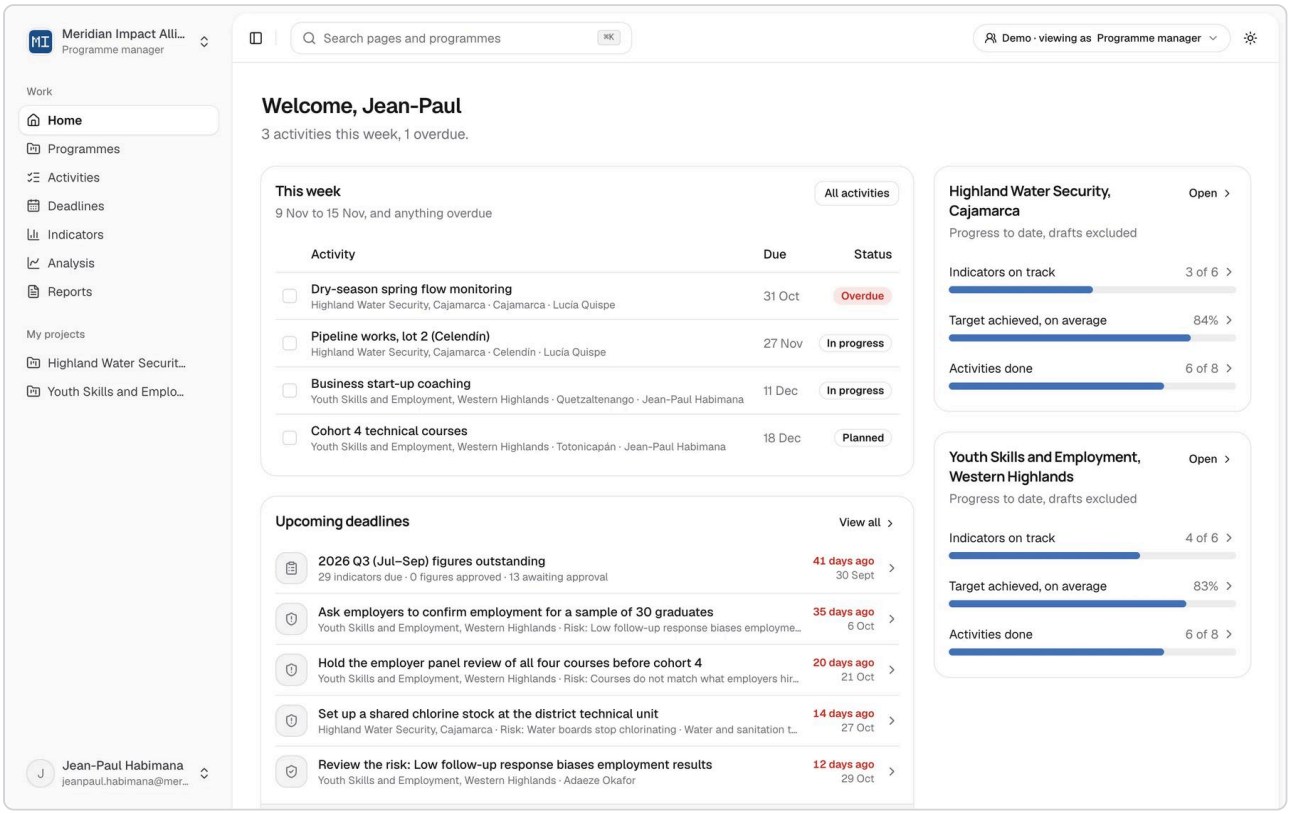


Figure 10.1 The Programme manager's home page.

10.1 Home page

- **This week.** Activities due this week and anything overdue. Tick an activity to mark it done, or open **All activities**.
- **Upcoming deadlines.** Reporting periods, activity end dates, risk actions and reviews, soonest first.
- **Project cards** for up to three of your projects, showing indicators on track, average progress and activities done. Drafts are excluded.

10.2 Menu

Home, Programmes, Activities, Deadlines, Indicators, Analysis, Reports, and **My projects**, which lists the projects you manage, or the ones you are on if you manage none.

10.3 Common tasks

- Add and update activities

- Check deadlines
- Keep the project budget and record spending
- Add and review risks
- Read progress on your indicators

11 Field officer

The Field officer collects and sends figures. Their home page is a task list: figures returned for correction first, then drafts to send, then forms to fill.

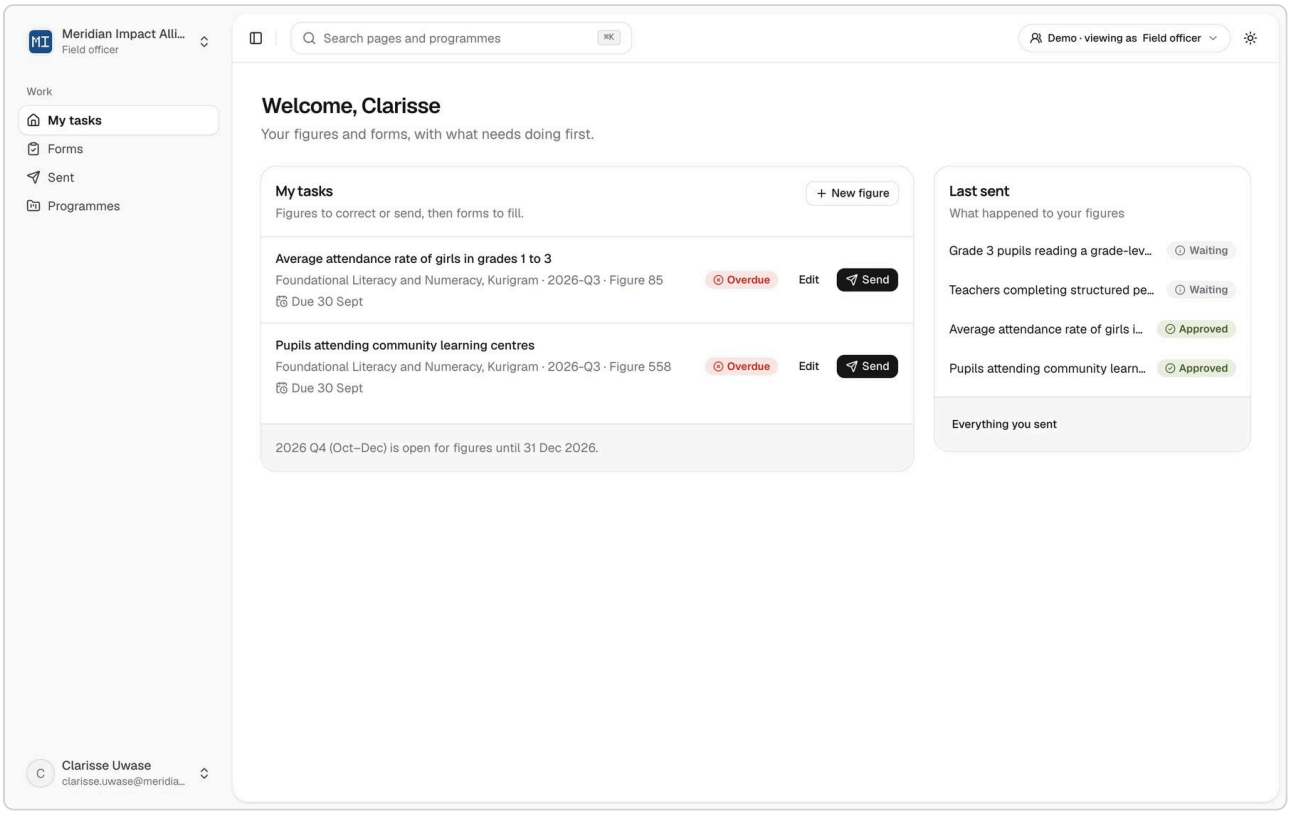


Figure 11.1 The Field officer's home page, My tasks.

11.1 My tasks

- **Returned** figures come first, with the reviewer's reason and a **Correct** button.
- **Draft** and **Overdue** figures you have started, with **Edit** and **Send**.
- **To fill** forms your organisation has published, with **Fill**.
- **New figure** starts a figure for one of your indicators and an open period.
- The footer says which reporting period is open.
- **Last sent** shows what happened to your recent figures.

11.2 Menu

My tasks, Forms, Sent, Programmes. Field officers see only the projects they are assigned to.

11.3 Common tasks

- Fill a form on a phone
- Enter and send a figure

- Correct a returned figure
- See what you sent

12 Finance officer

The Finance officer keeps budgets and spending in ImpactMEL alongside results, so reports carry money and results together. ImpactMEL is a control layer over your accounting system, not a replacement for it.

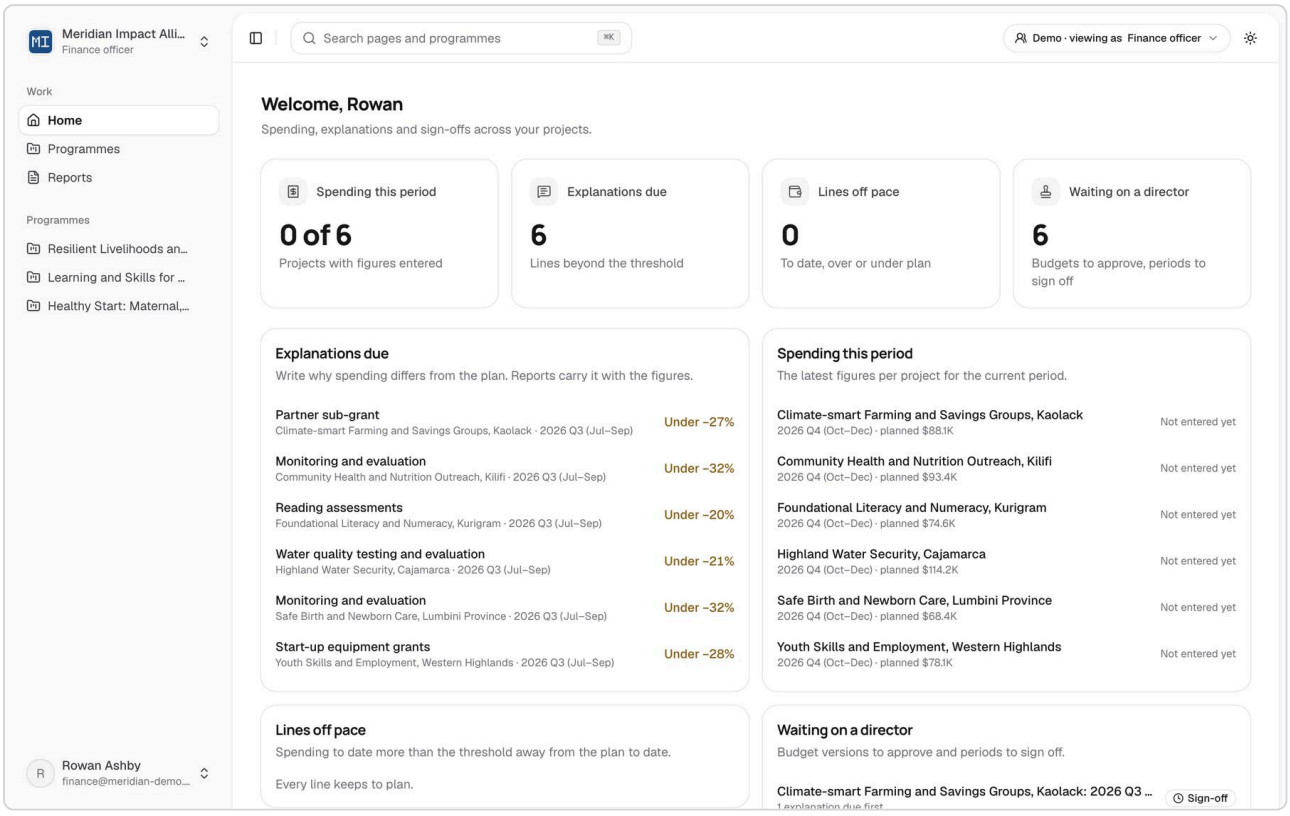


Figure 12.1 The Finance officer's home page.

12.1 Home page

- **Spending this period.** Projects with spending entered for the current period.
- **Explanations due.** Budget lines beyond the variance threshold that still need an explanation.
- **Lines off pace.** Lines spending more or less than plan to date.
- **Waiting on a director.** Budget versions to approve and spending periods to sign off.

12.2 Menu

Home, Programmes, Reports. The finance officer can read programmes, results and reports, but not forms, figures or people.

12.3 Common tasks

- Set up a project budget
- Record or import spending

- Write a variance explanation
- Send a budget version for approval

13 Viewer and funder

Viewers read results without changing anything. Funders who work with several organisations have a separate funder workspace.

13.1 Viewer

The Viewer role is for board members, external reviewers and donor contacts inside your workspace. Viewers see an Overview like the Director's, without approvals, for the programmes and projects they are assigned to.

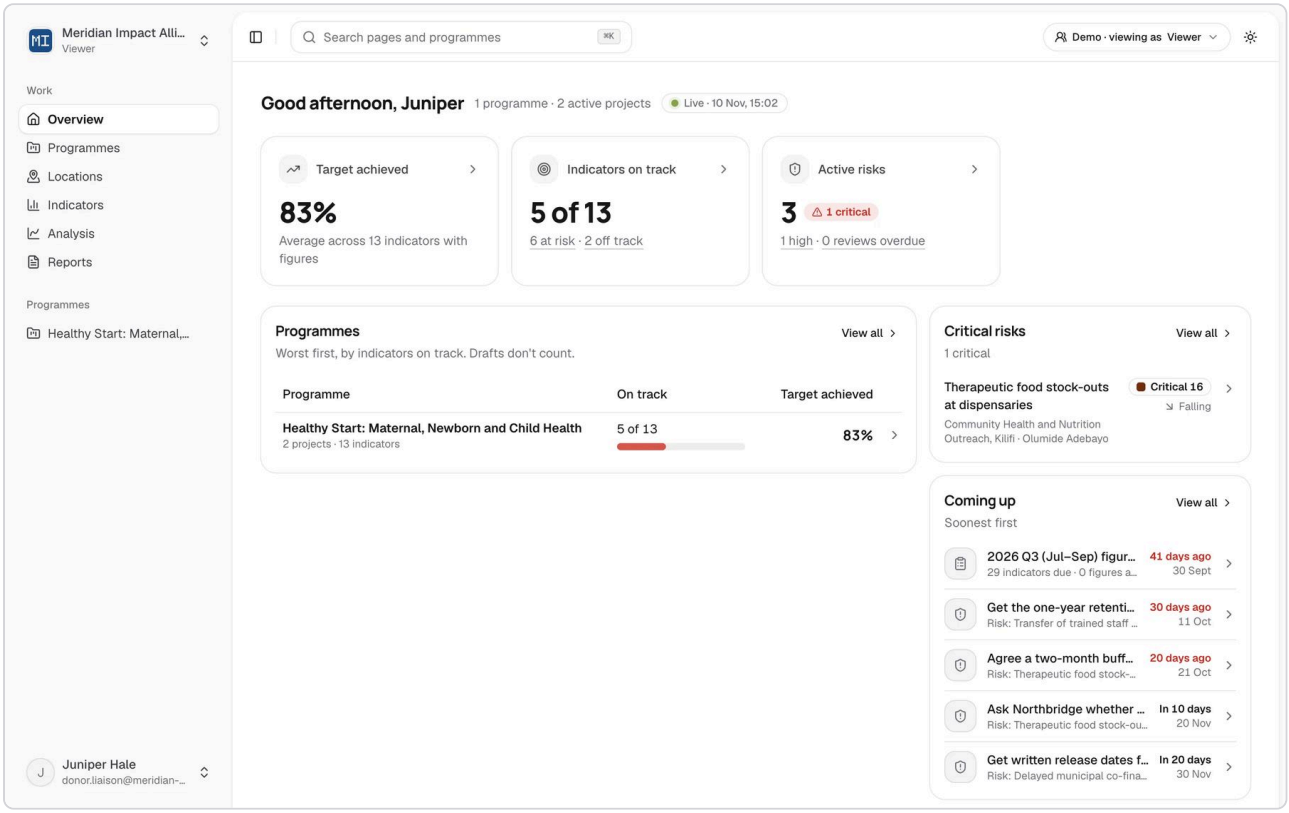


Figure 13.1 The Viewer's Overview.

Menu: Overview, Programmes, Locations, Indicators, Analysis, Reports. Viewers can read published reports and dashboards, and cannot change anything.

13.2 Sharing without an account

You do not need to make someone a Viewer to show them results. You can send:

- a read-only report link, which opens one published report with its downloads; or
- a public dashboard link, which shows a dashboard's approved figures and expires when you choose.

13.3 Funder workspace

A funder organisation can have its own ImpactMEL workspace. It has its own roles (Funder admin, M&E lead, Programme officer and Board viewer) and its own menu: **Portfolio**, **Grantees**, **Requests** and **Reports**. Funders see only what each grantee chooses to share with them. See Funder workspace.

PART

Plan

14 Programmes and projects

A programme groups related projects, usually under one strategy or donor. Projects are where indicators, activities, budgets and teams live. Programme pages roll their projects up.

Who can do this: anyone with programmes or projects permission can read; Organisation admins, M&E officers and Programme managers can create and edit by default.

14.1 The Programmes page

Open **Programmes** in the sidebar. Each programme shows its projects, a timeline, budget and spending, framework status, indicators on track, locations and overall status.

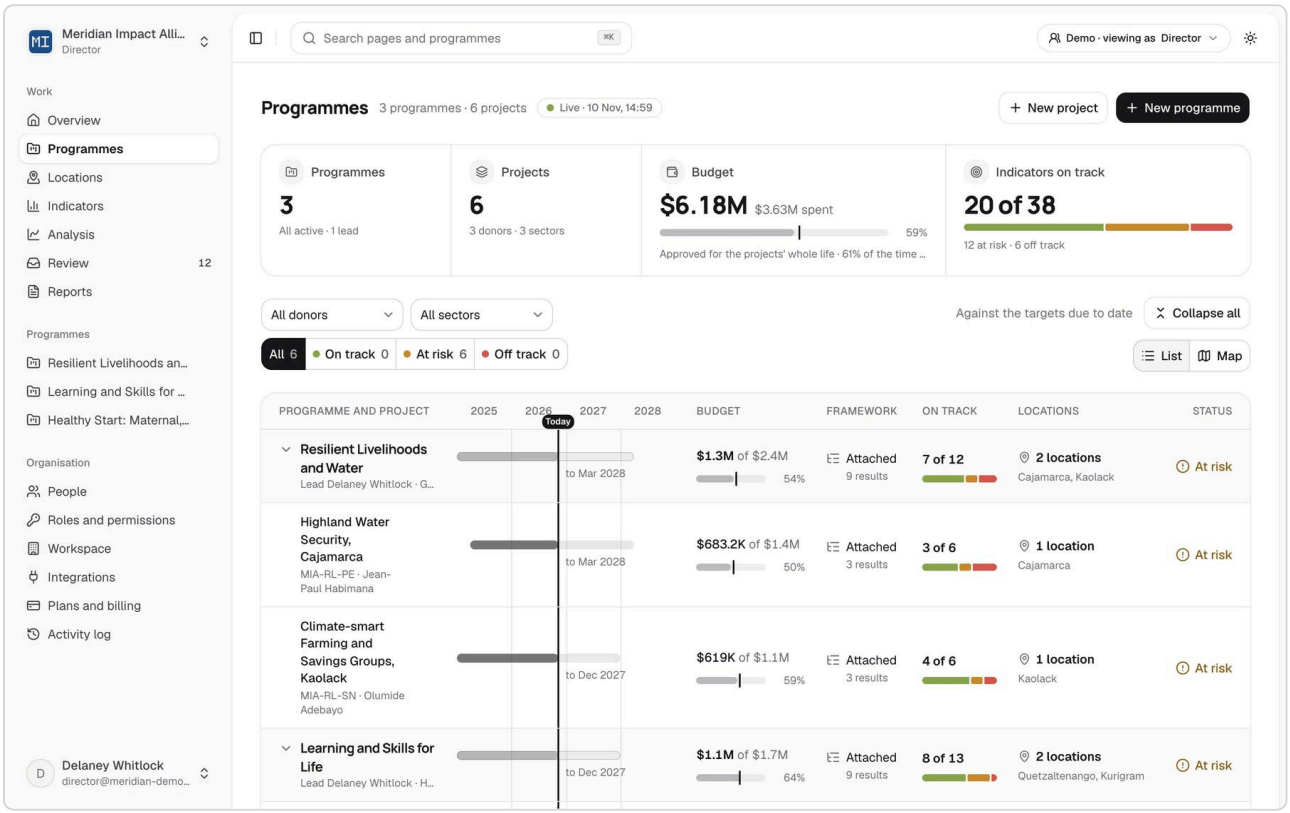


Figure 14.1 The Programmes page: every programme and its projects on one screen.

- Filter by donor, sector or status (**On track**, **At risk**, **Off track**).
- Switch between **List** and **Map** to see where projects work.
- **Expand all** or **Collapse all** shows or hides each programme's projects.

14.2 Create a programme

1. On the Programmes page, choose **New programme**.
2. Enter the name, code, status (**In the pipeline**, **Active** or **Closed**), donor, sector, start and end dates, and a description.

3. Save.

14.3 Create a project

1. Choose **New project** on the Programmes page or on a programme page.
2. Choose the programme, then enter the name, code, start and end dates, approved budget for the project's whole life and its currency.
3. Choose the **Project manager** and the team, and add locations.
4. Save.

14.4 The programme page

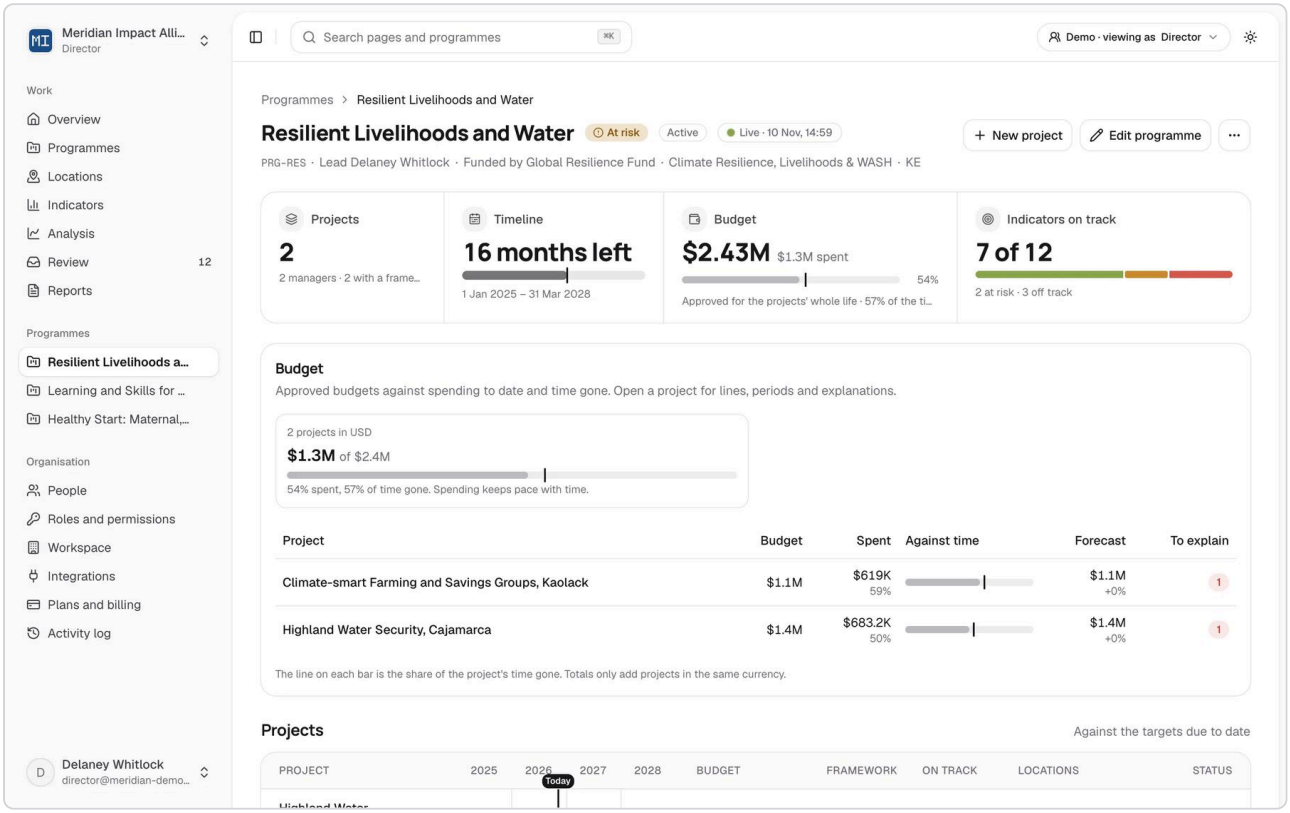


Figure 14.2 A programme page, with its budget roll-up and projects.

A programme page shows totals for projects, timeline, budget and indicators on track, then the programme budget roll-up, the projects table, a description, risks and what is due soon. Use **Edit programme** to change its details.

14.5 The project page

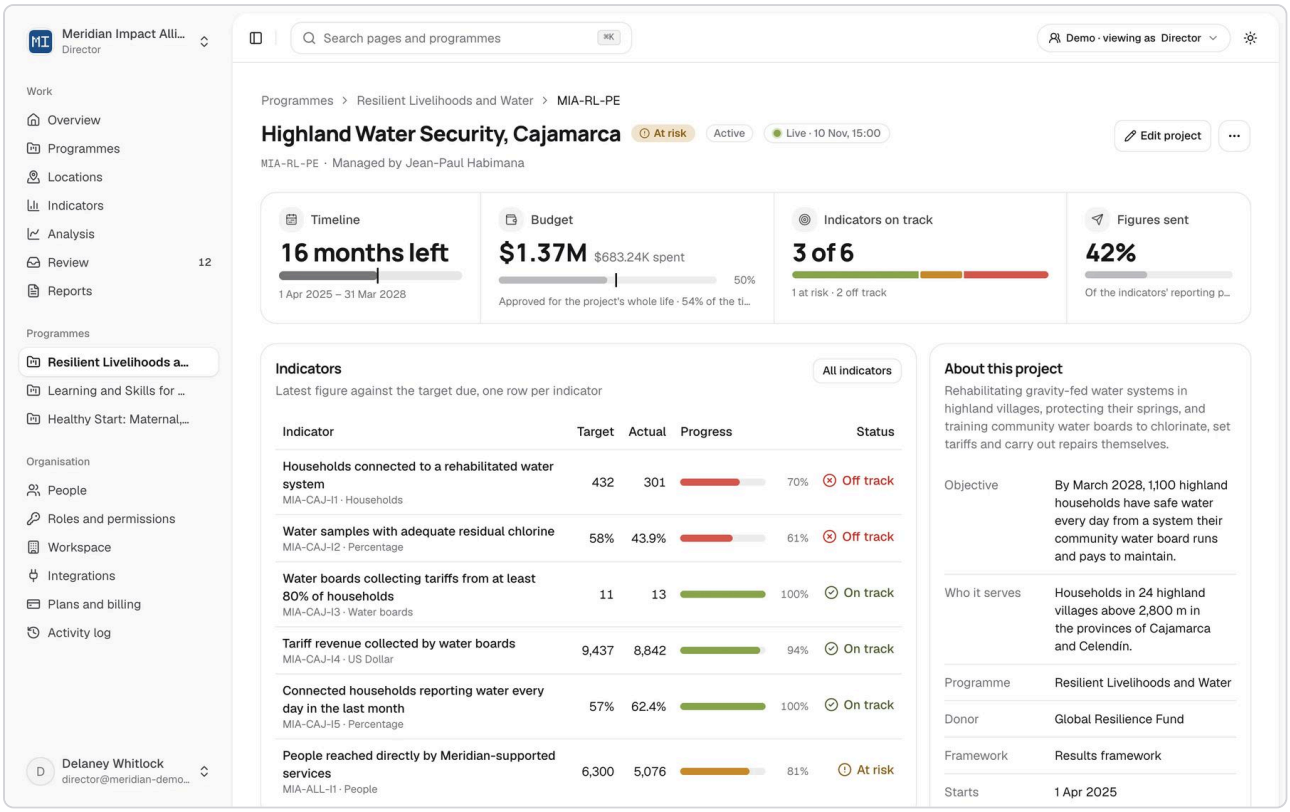


Figure 14.3 A project page: indicators, budget, activities, risks and registers in one place.

The project page has two columns.

- **Main column:** Indicators, Budget, Activities, Risks, and the registers: Stakeholders and target groups, Period narratives, Evaluations and Documents. See Participants and registers.
- **Side column:** About this project, Team, Locations, Reports and shortcuts.

Project status can be Planning, Active, On hold, Completed or Cancelled.

Places

In **Edit project**, under locations, choose **Add a place**. A place can be new, one already used by another project, or an administrative area you search for. You can add latitude and longitude or click the map, choose the coverage (one site, district, region, whole country and so on), and mark one place as the project's main location.

14.6 Copy a programme or project

From the **...** menu, choose **Start a programme from this one** or **Start a project from this one**. The copy takes the results framework and indicators. Targets, periods, figures, budgets and judgements are not copied. For a programme you can also copy its projects, risks and evaluations; for a project, its places, team, target groups, stakeholders and open risks.

14.7 Delete a programme or project

From the ... menu, choose **Delete**. ImpactMEL first lists everything that would be deleted with it. Larger deletions ask you to type the name to confirm. Deletion cannot be undone, and ImpactMEL refuses it where approved figures, final judgements or published reports would be lost.

15 Results framework

The results framework sets out what each programme intends to achieve, as a chain from impact to outcomes to outputs. Indicators are linked to the results they measure, so progress rolls up the chain.

Who can do this: M&E officers and Organisation admins build the framework. Directors and M&E officers record performance judgements.

15.1 Open the framework

Open **Results framework** in the sidebar. Choose the programme, and optionally a project and a reporting period. The summary shows how many results there are at each level, how many indicators are linked, and how results stand against the chosen period's targets.

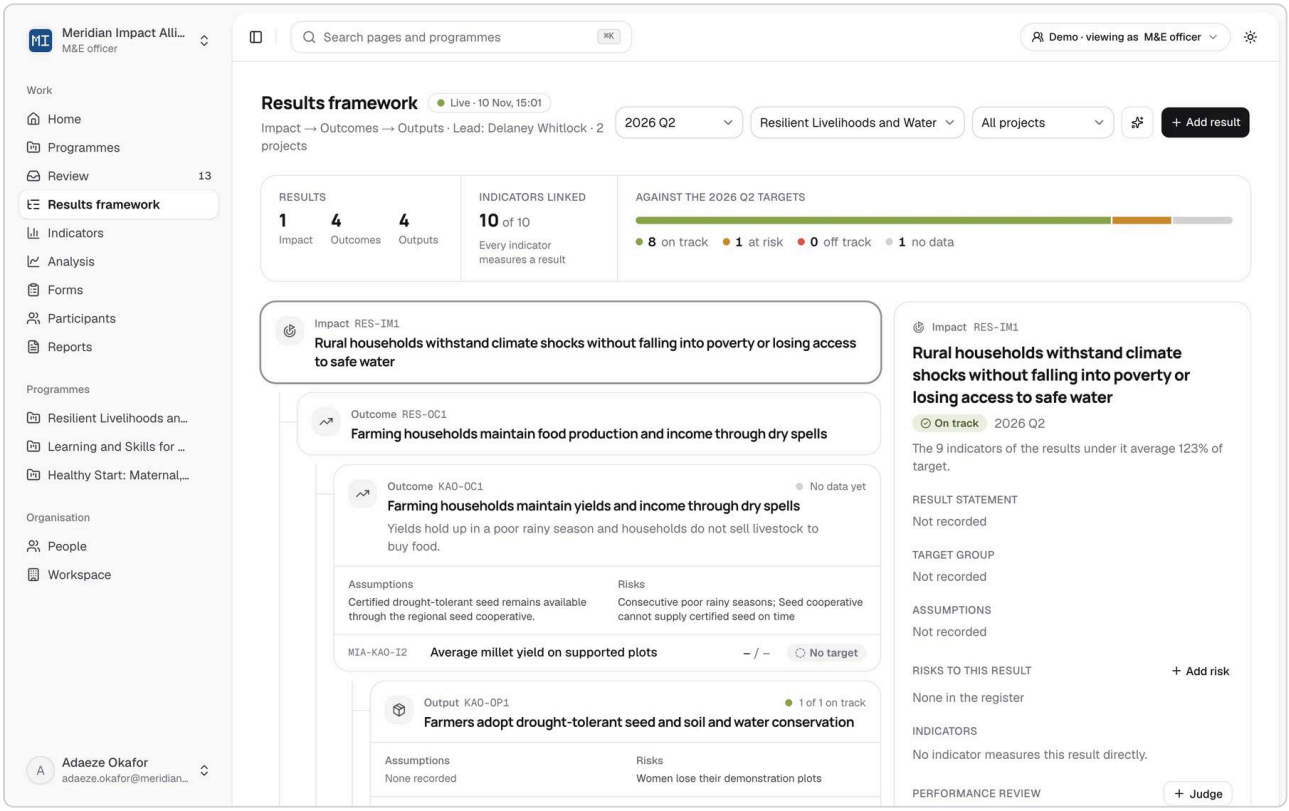


Figure 15.1 The results framework: impact, outcomes and outputs, with linked indicators and status.

The framework is a chain of **Impact**, **Outcome** and **Output** results. It is used for results frameworks and logframes alike: each result can carry its assumptions, risks and target group.

15.2 Add a result

1. Choose **Add a result**. In an empty framework, choose **Build the framework**.
2. Choose the project and level, and which result it **contributes to**. Outputs sit under an outcome.
3. Enter the title, code and result statement, and optionally assumptions, risks and target group.

4. Save.

15.3 Link indicators

Open a result and use **Indicators that measure this result**, then **Save links**. Each indicator measures one result. Linking an indicator to another result moves it, with its targets and figures.

15.4 Performance judgements

Figures show how far an indicator moved. A judgement records whether the result was achieved, and why. Open a result and choose **Judge**.

- Choose the period, or **Whole plan, at the end**.
- Choose a rating: **Over-achieved**, **Achieved**, **Partially achieved**, **Not achieved** or **Too early to judge**.
- Write the reason. ImpactMEL shows **What the figures say** beside it. You can add evidence and **What happens next**.
- **Save draft** or **Record as final**. A final judgement can be reopened as a draft with **Reopen as draft**.

Judgements appear in reports under "Review of results".

15.5 Draft a framework from a proposal

If AI features are on, M&E officers can choose **Draft from a proposal**.

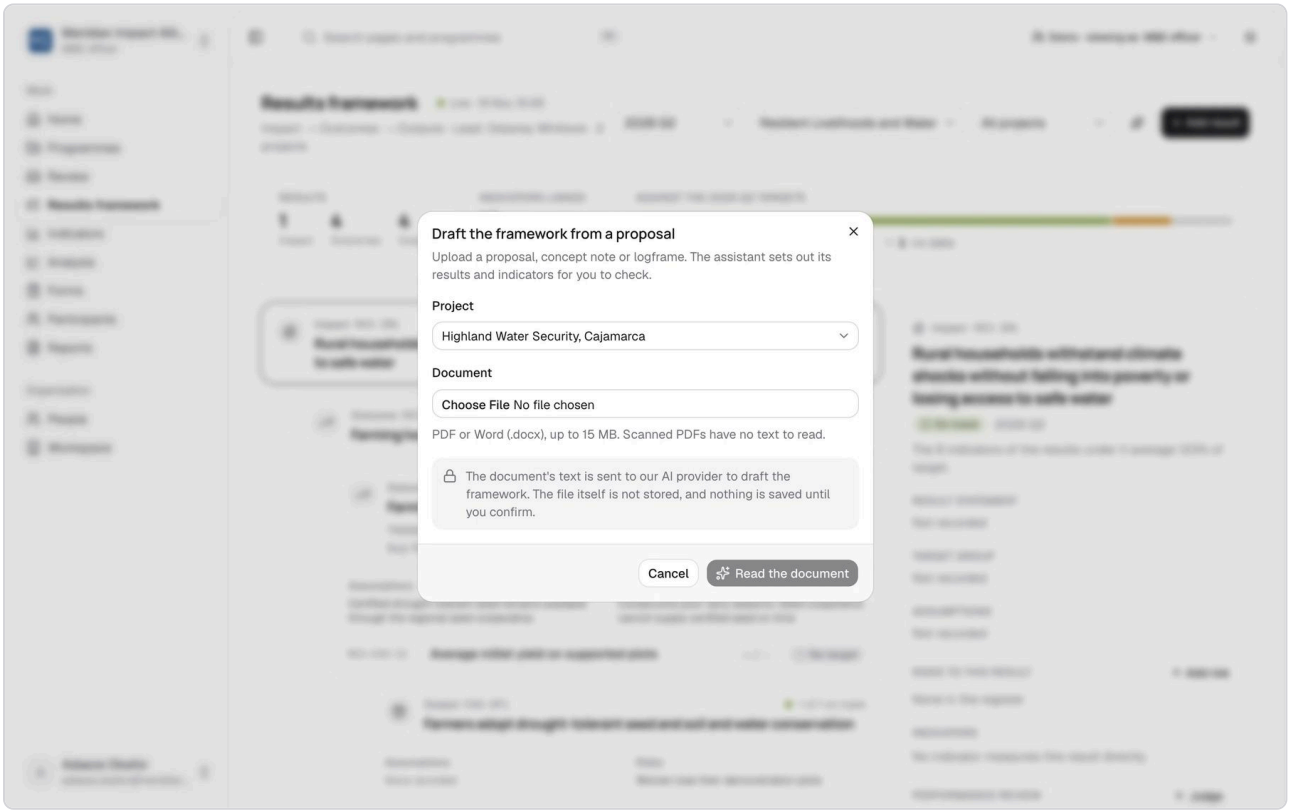


Figure 15.2 Drafting a framework from a proposal document.

1. Choose the project and upload a PDF or Word document up to 15 MB. Scanned PDFs do not work, because they hold no text.
2. Choose **Read the document**.
3. ImpactMEL proposes results and indicators, each with the sentence it came from. For each one choose **Yes, add it** or **Leave it out**.
4. Choose **Add results and indicators**.

Anything the document did not make clear is saved on the indicator under **To confirm with your team**, as a question rather than a fact. The document itself is not stored. See AI features.

16 Indicators, baselines and targets

An indicator is defined once, with its unit, method and source. It has a baseline, a target for each reporting period, and figures that are approved through review. Progress and status are worked out from those, the same way on every screen and in every report.

Who can do this: M&E officers and Organisation admins create and edit indicators. Everyone with indicator permission can read them.

16.1 The Indicators page

Open **Indicators** in the sidebar.

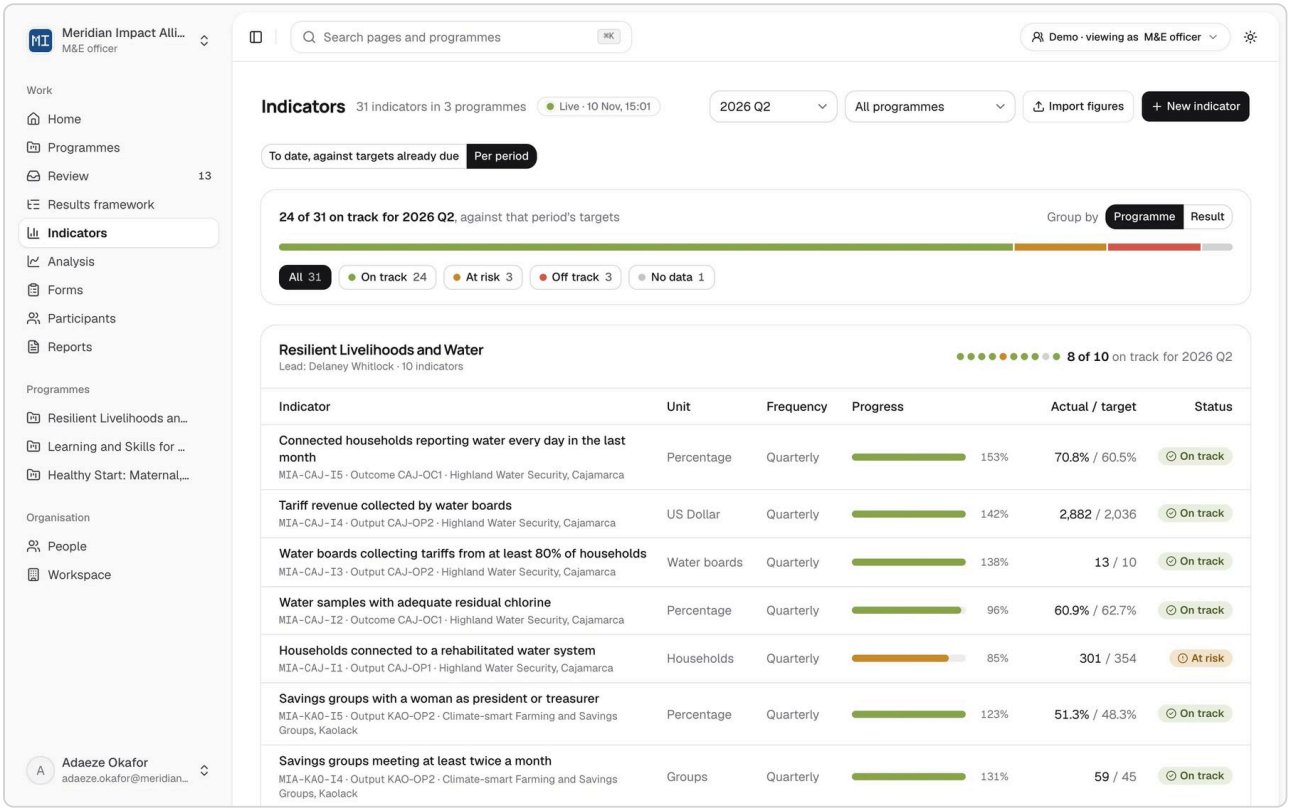


Figure 16.1 The Indicators page, grouped by programme, with progress and status.

- Filter by programme or project and by status: **On track**, **At risk**, **Off track** or **No data**.
- **Group by** programme or result.
- Count against **To date** (targets already due) or **Per period** (one period's targets).
- **Import figures** brings in figures from Excel. See Integrations.

16.2 Create an indicator

Choose **New indicator**.

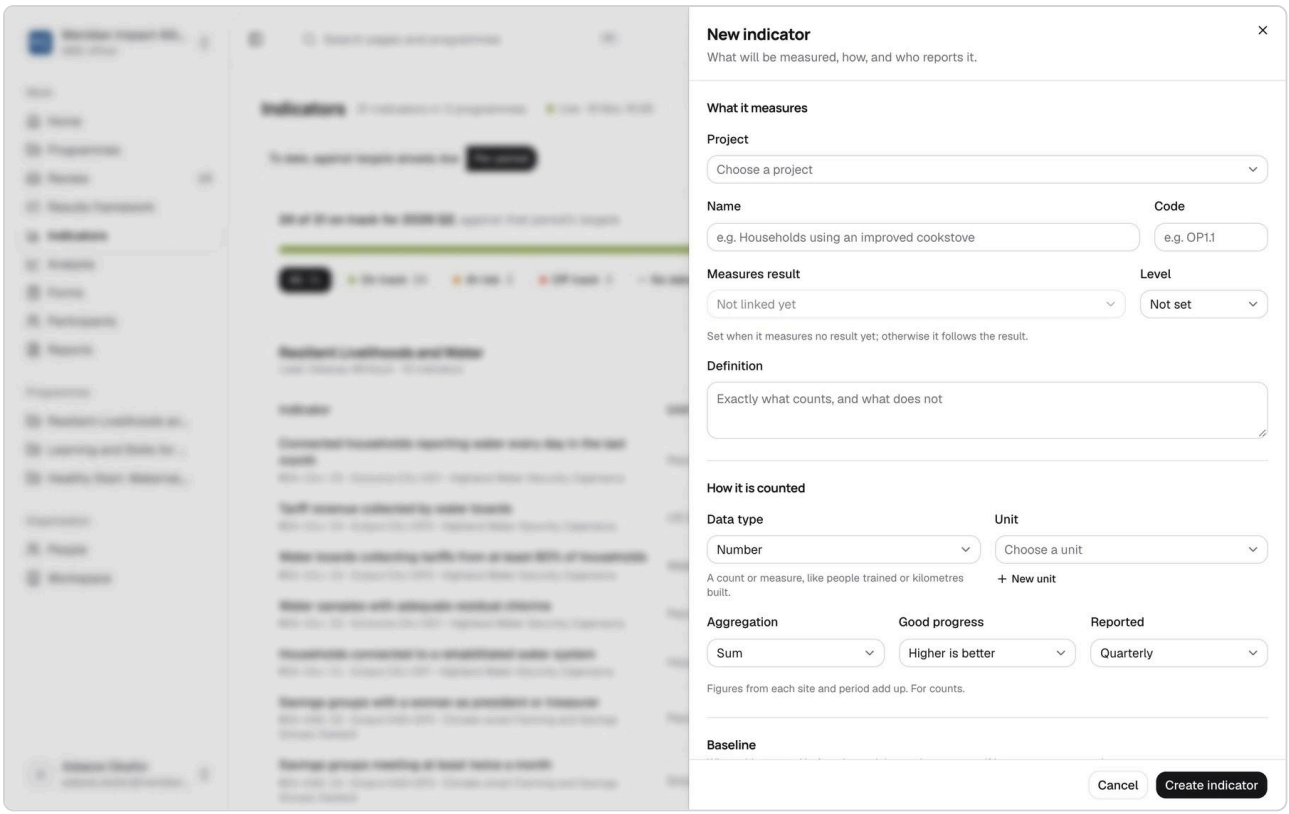


Figure 16.2 The New indicator panel.

Field	What to enter
Project, Name, Code	Where the indicator belongs and what it is called
Measures result	The result in the framework it measures
Level, Definition	Its level and exactly what counts and what does not
Data type	Number, Percentage, Currency, Text, or Yes or no
Unit	For example households, people, or US Dollar
Aggregation	How figures add up across periods and places: Sum, Average, Latest, Highest or Lowest
Good progress	Higher is better, Lower is better, or Within a range
Reported	Monthly, Quarterly, Twice a year, Each school term or Yearly
Numerator and denominator	For percentages
Baseline	The starting value and the date it was measured
Data source, Collection method, Means of verification, Responsible person	How the figure is produced and checked
Requires review	Figures count only once approved
Breakdowns	Disaggregation, such as sex or age group

16.3 Set targets

Open the indicator and choose **Edit targets** under **Targets by reporting period**. Enter a target for each period, with totals and targets per breakdown group if needed. Setting a target opens that period for collection on the indicator. You can **Stop taking figures** and **Start taking figures** again.

Targets are stored per reporting period, so a target can be for a quarter, a year or the whole grant. Reports print each target's period.

16.4 The indicator page

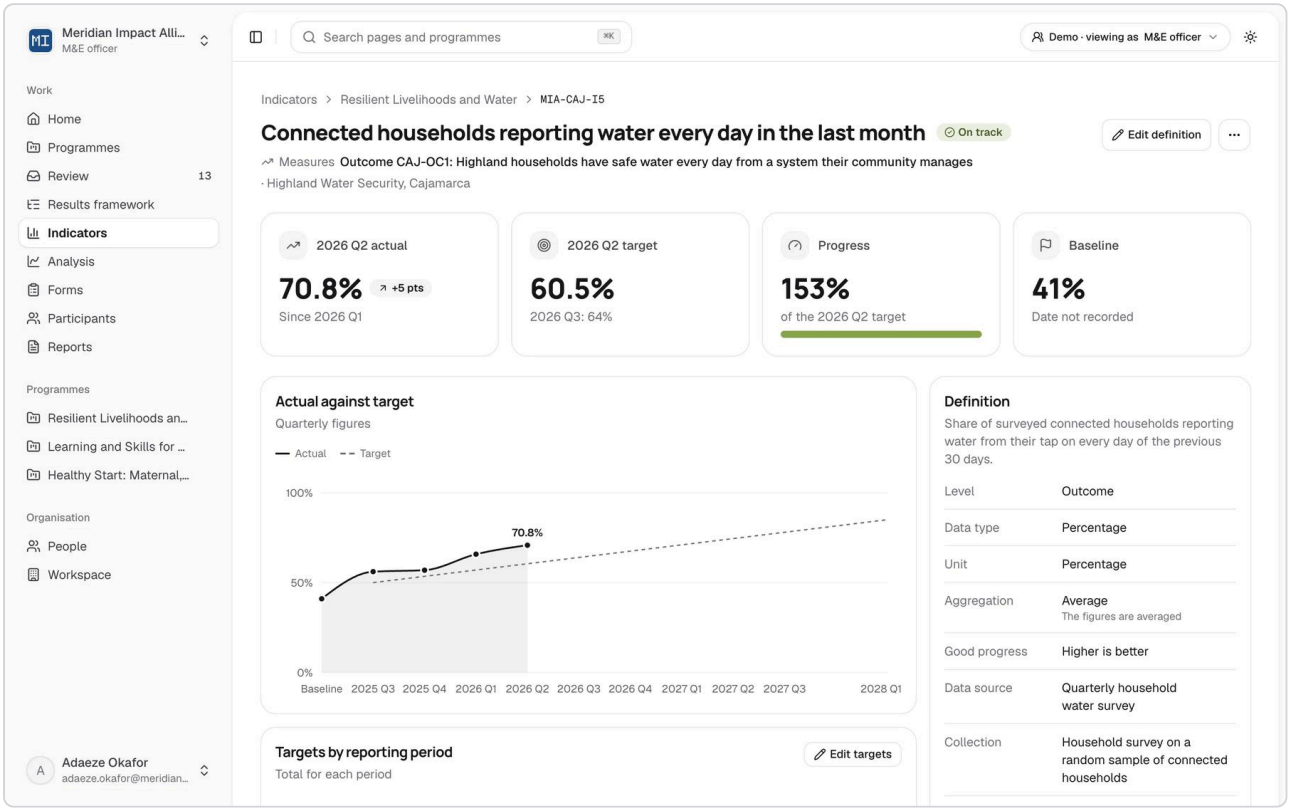


Figure 16.3 An indicator page: actual, target, progress and baseline, with the chart and definition.

The indicator page shows the latest actual, target, progress and baseline, a chart of actual against target, targets by reporting period, reported figures, disaggregation, the change history, and risks that watch this indicator.

16.5 Read progress

The progress formula

Where an indicator has a baseline, progress is the share of the planned change achieved:

> **Progress = (actual − baseline) ÷ (target − baseline)**

Without a baseline, progress is **actual ÷ target**. For indicators where lower is better, ImpactMEL turns the comparison round.

For example, an indicator with a baseline of 41%, a target of 60.5% and an actual of 70.8% has progress of (70.8 − 41) ÷ (60.5 − 41) = 153%.

Status thresholds

Status	Progress
On track	90% or more
At risk	70% to under 90%
Off track	under 70%

These are the defaults. Each organisation can have its own thresholds; there is no screen for this yet, so ask ImpactMEL support to change them for your workspace. Reports print the thresholds in use.

Which figures count

- Only approved figures count. Drafts and figures waiting for review do not.
- Only targets that have fallen due count in to-date views.
- Figures are totalled the way the indicator is defined: sum, average, latest, highest or lowest.
- An indicator without a target shows **No target**, and is not counted as off track.

The same rule applies on home pages, the Indicators page, programme pages, dashboards and reports.

16.6 Reuse indicators

To reuse a whole set of indicators, copy a programme or project with **Start a programme from this one**. The framework and indicators are copied, without figures or targets. See Programmes and projects.

16.7 Delete an indicator

From the **…** menu on the indicator page, choose **Delete** and type DELETE to confirm.

17 Reporting periods

Reporting periods are the calendar that figures and targets belong to. They are shared by every project in the workspace and identified by their start and end dates, so quarters, years and one-off periods can sit side by side.

Who can do this: Organisation admins set the reporting calendar. Organisation admins, Directors and M&E officers add, close, lock and reopen periods.

17.1 The reporting calendar

In **Workspace**, under **Reporting calendar**, choose the month your **financial year starts in** and how often **you report**: monthly, quarterly, every six months or yearly. Saving adds this year's missing periods and keeps the ones you already have.

17.2 Manage periods

On the M&E officer's home page, the **Reporting periods** panel shows each open period, with how many indicators have a figure in, how many are approved and what is outstanding. Choose **Manage** to see every period.

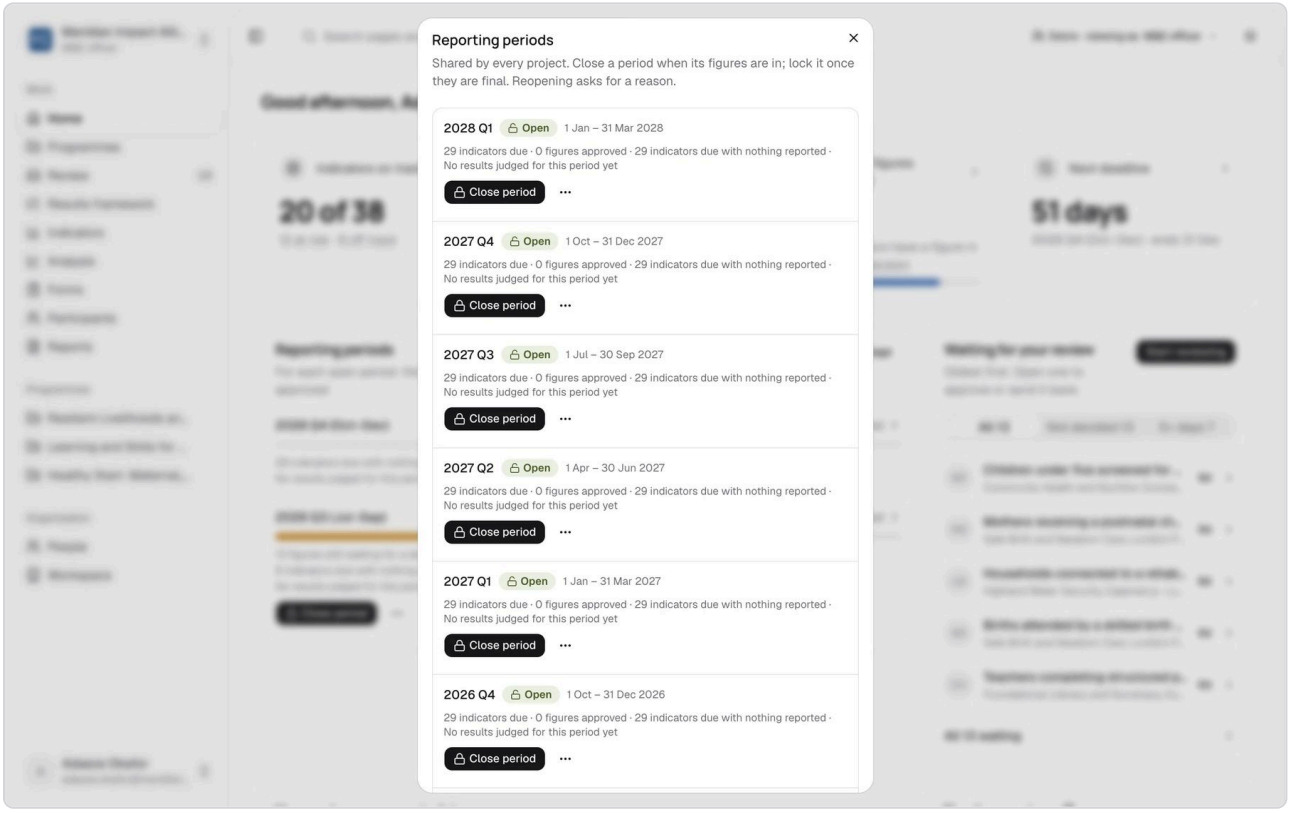


Figure 17.1 The Reporting periods dialog.

Add periods

Choose **Add reporting periods**, then:

- **Quarters**, **Months** or **Years**, with a **From** and **To** range; or
- **One period**, with a name, first day and last day.

The same dates always mean the same period, so two projects reporting on 1 April to 30 June share one period.

17.3 Close, lock and reopen

A period moves through three states:

State	What it means
Open	Figures can be entered, sent and corrected
Closed	No new figures can be entered. Figures already sent can still be reviewed
Locked	The figures are final

Before you close a period, ImpactMEL lists what is outstanding:

- figures still waiting for a decision;
- figures sent back and not yet resubmitted;
- indicators due with nothing reported;
- results not yet judged for the period.

When nothing is outstanding it says **Nothing outstanding; ready to close**.

- **Close period** stops new figures.
- **Lock** makes the figures final. Only a closed period can be locked.
- **Reopen** asks for a written reason. If a funder holds a shared copy of that period, ImpactMEL tells you a correction may follow.

A period can be renamed, have its dates changed or be deleted only while it is open. A period that holds figures cannot be deleted. The server refuses figures for a closed or locked period.

PART

Collect

18 Forms and the form builder

Forms collect data from the field. A form can be general, such as a site visit checklist, or write its answers straight into an indicator as a draft figure for review.

Who can do this: M&E officers and Organisation admins build and publish forms. Anyone with forms permission can see forms and export responses.

18.1 The Forms page

Open **Forms** in the sidebar.

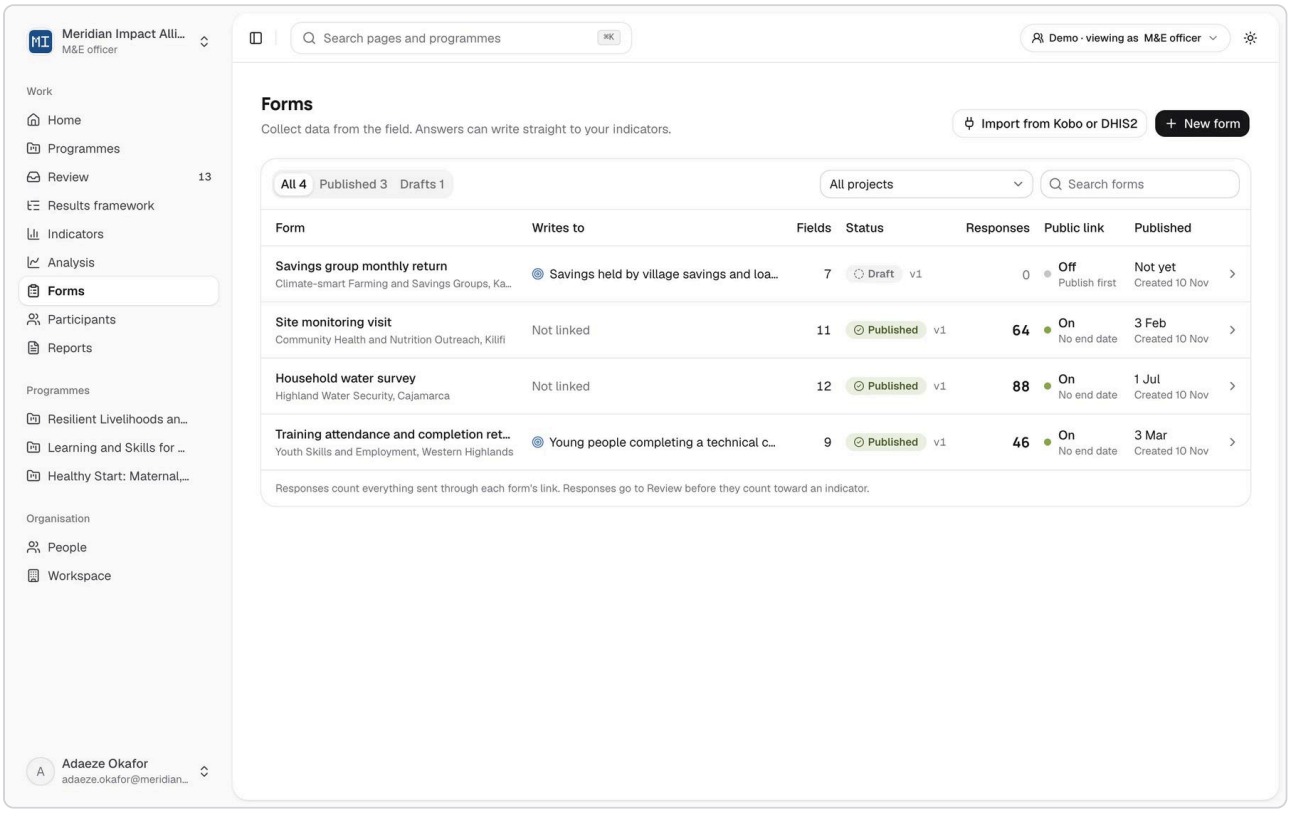


Figure 18.1 The Forms page: each form, what it writes to, its status, responses and public link.

Each row shows the project, the indicator the form writes to, the number of fields, its status and version, the number of responses and whether its public link is on. Use the tabs **All**, **Published** and **Drafts**, the project filter and search. **Import from Kobo or DHIS2** opens Integrations.

18.2 Create a form

Choose **New form**. If AI features are on, there are two tabs:

- **Describe it.** Write what the form should collect, in plain words, and choose **Draft with AI**. You see every question and its skip logic before anything is created. Choose **Draft again** to try once more, or **Create form** to keep it.
- **Start blank.** Enter a name, the project (or **Whole organisation, no project**) and a description.

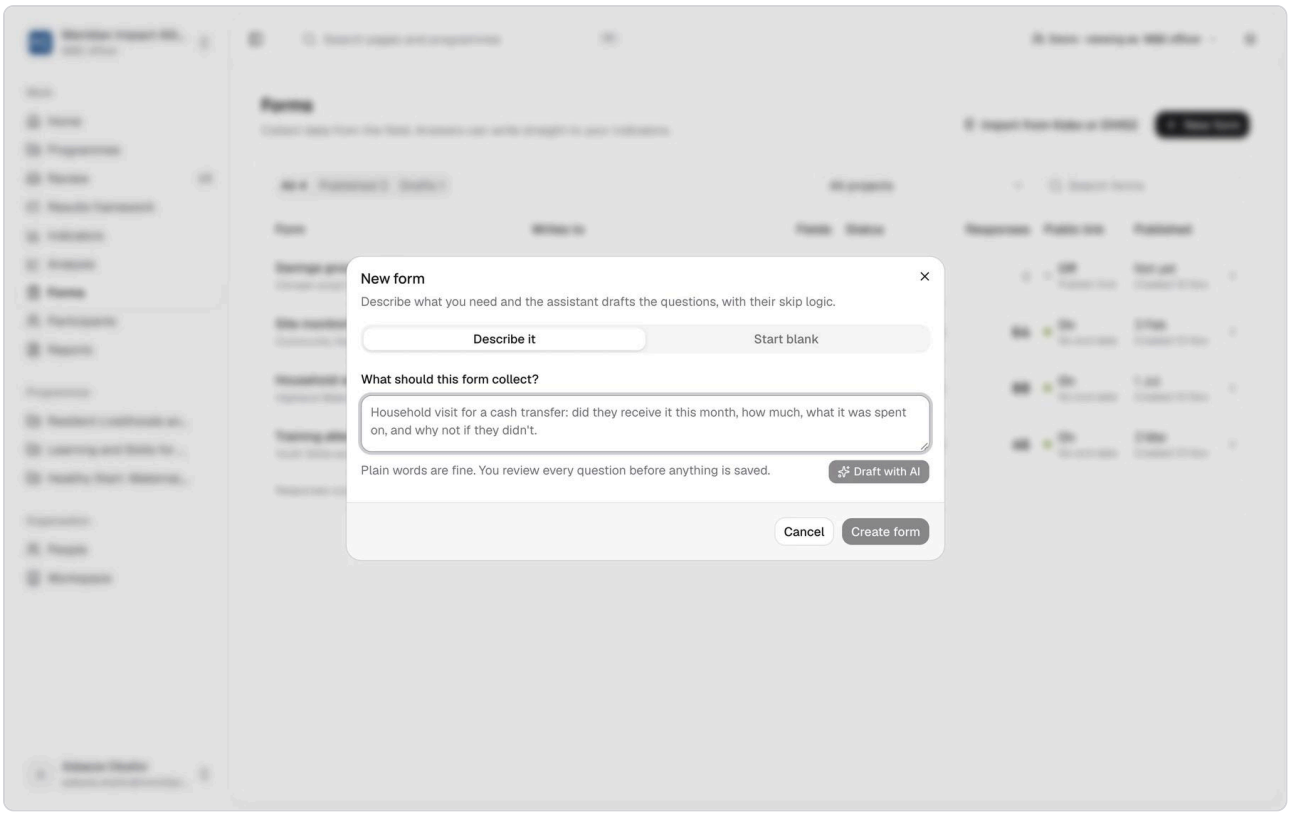


Figure 18.2 Describing a form for the AI assistant to draft.

18.3 The form builder

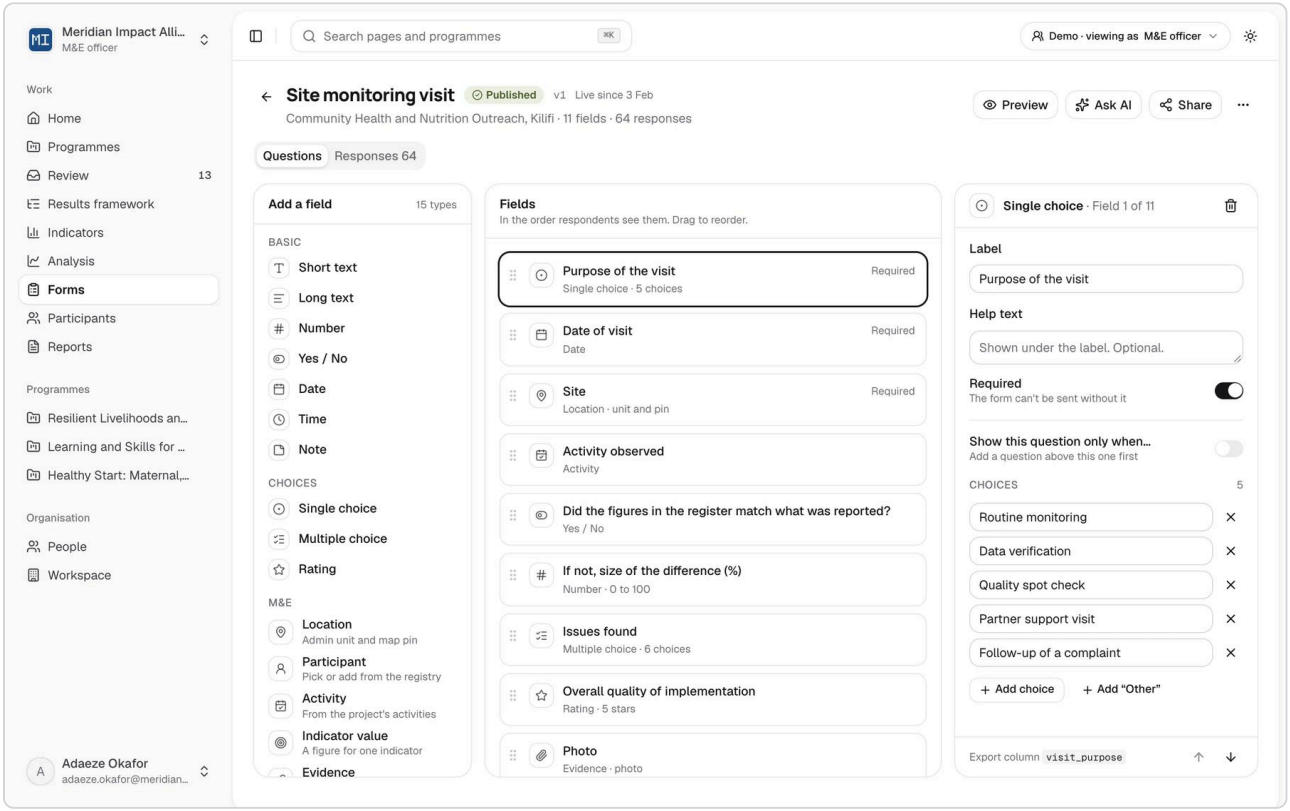


Figure 18.3 The form builder: field types on the left, the form in the middle, field settings on the right.

Drag a field type from **Add a field** into the form, or click it. Drag fields to reorder them. Select a field to change its settings on the right. Drafts save automatically.

Field types

Group	Types
Basic	Short text, Long text, Number, Yes / No, Date, Time, Note
Choices	Single choice, Multiple choice, Rating
M&E	Location, Participant, Activity, Indicator value, Evidence

Field settings

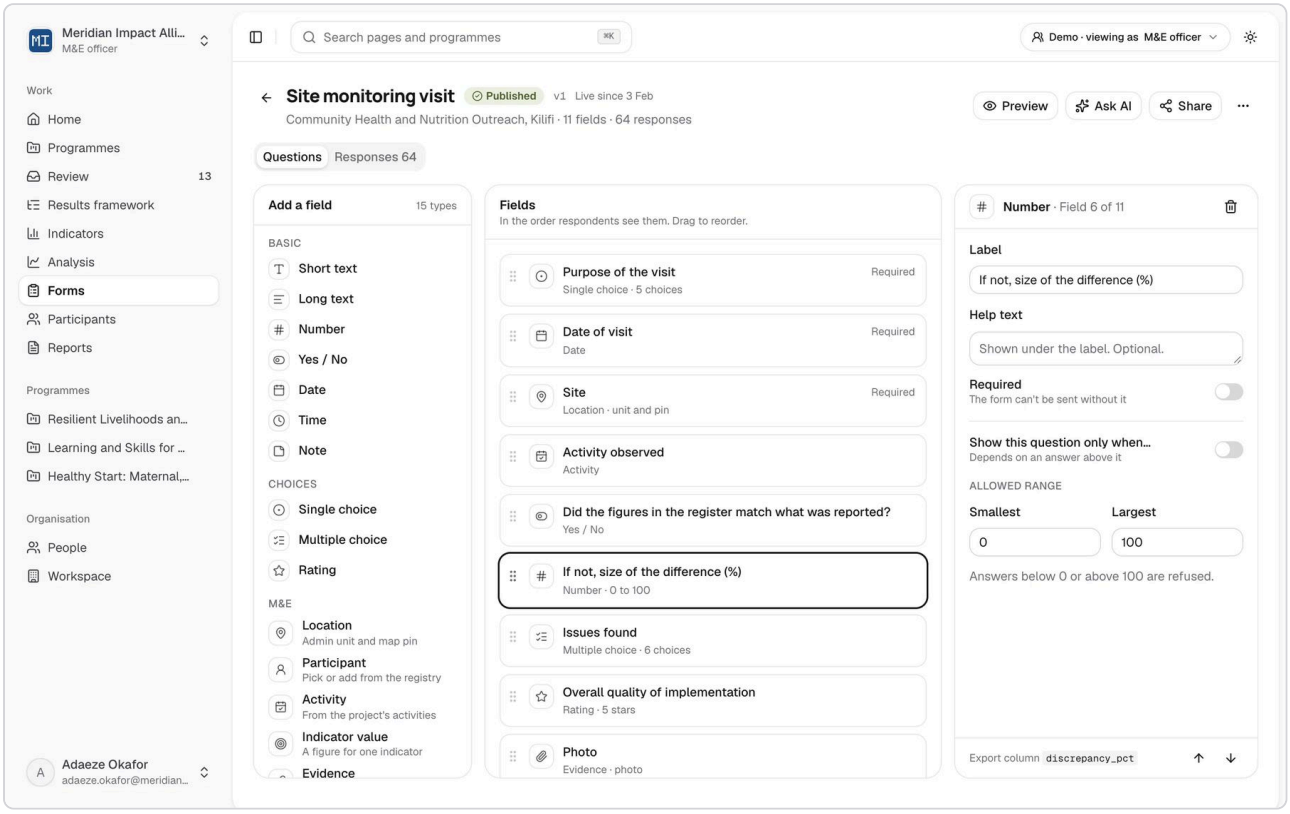


Figure 18.4 Field settings for a number field with an allowed range.

- **Label** and **Help text**.
- **Required.** The form cannot be sent without an answer.
- **Allowed range** for numbers and indicator values. Answers outside it are refused.
- **Pattern** for short text, for IDs and codes.
- **Number of stars** for ratings, from 2 to 10.
- **Add choice** and **Add "Other"** for choices. When someone picks Other, they must say what it is.
- **Export column**, the column name in exports.

Logic

Switch on **Show this question only when…** to show a question only when earlier answers call for it. Conditions can depend only on questions above, and combine as **all** or **any**. Answers to hidden questions are not sent, and the server checks the same rules.

Location

A **Location** field lets the person filling the form choose **Use my location** to record the phone's GPS position, with its accuracy, and type a place name or address.

Photos and files

An **Evidence** field accepts photos, PDF or Word documents, up to 10 MB per file, one file per question. Large photos are made smaller on the phone before upload.

Writing to an indicator

An **Indicator value** field writes its answer to the indicator you choose. Each answer arrives in Review as a draft figure. The person filling the form marks it **Counted** or **Estimated**, and an estimate needs a note on how it was made.

Ask AI

Ask AI in the builder suggests changes to the form from a plain request. Nothing changes until you choose **Apply**.

18.4 Publish

Choose **Publish**. ImpactMEL will not publish while any field needs attention, and lists the fields to fix. Changes to a published form are saved as a draft; they go live, as a new version, when you publish again. **Unpublish** in the **…** menu switches the form off.

18.5 Share a form

Choose **Share**.

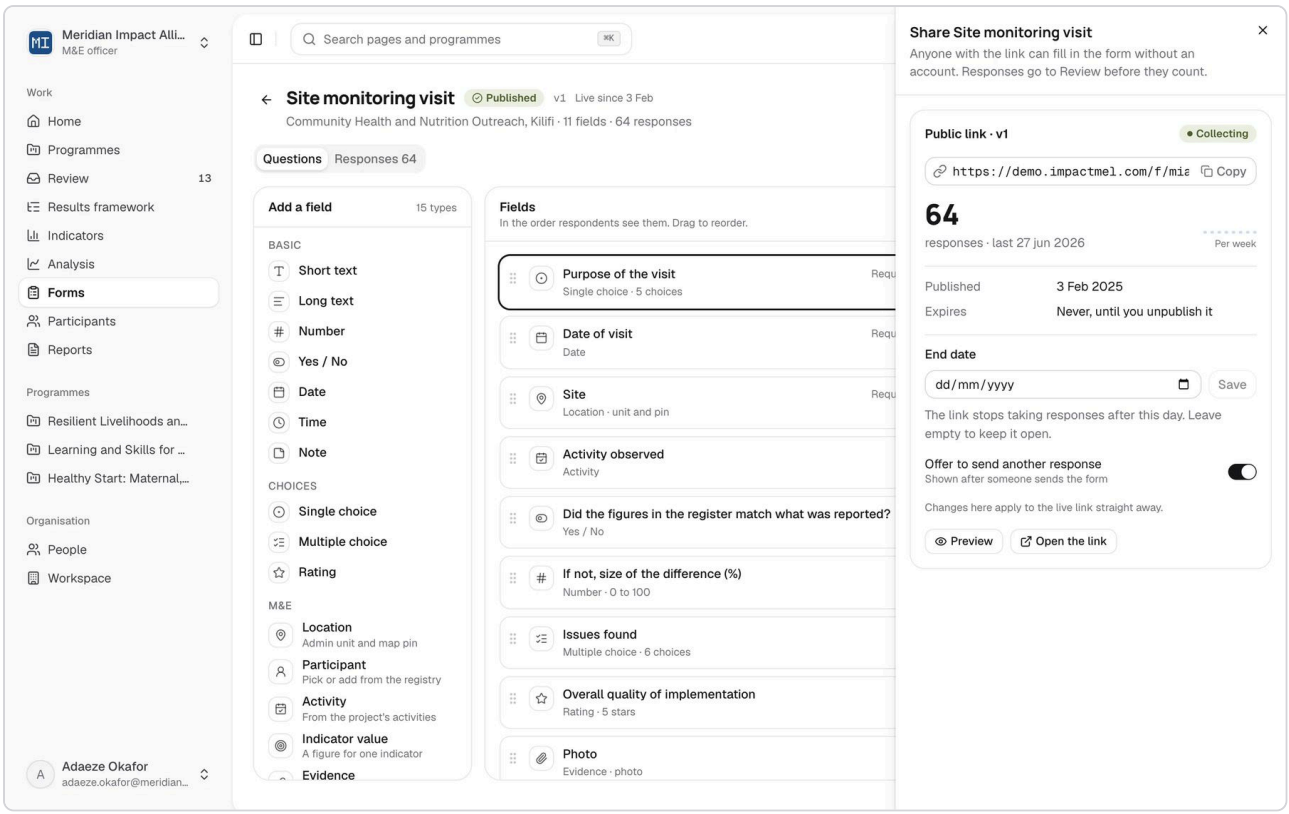


Figure 18.5 The Share panel: the public link, responses and end date.

- Each published form has one **public link**. Anyone with the link can fill in the form without an account. **Copy** it to send by email, SMS or a messaging app.
- Set an **End date** after which the link stops taking responses. Otherwise it stays open until you unpublish.
- **Offer to send another response** lets people fill the form again straight away.
- **Preview** and **Open the link** let you check it.

Unpublishing switches the link off. Publishing again reuses the same link.

18.6 Responses

The **Responses** tab lists every response.

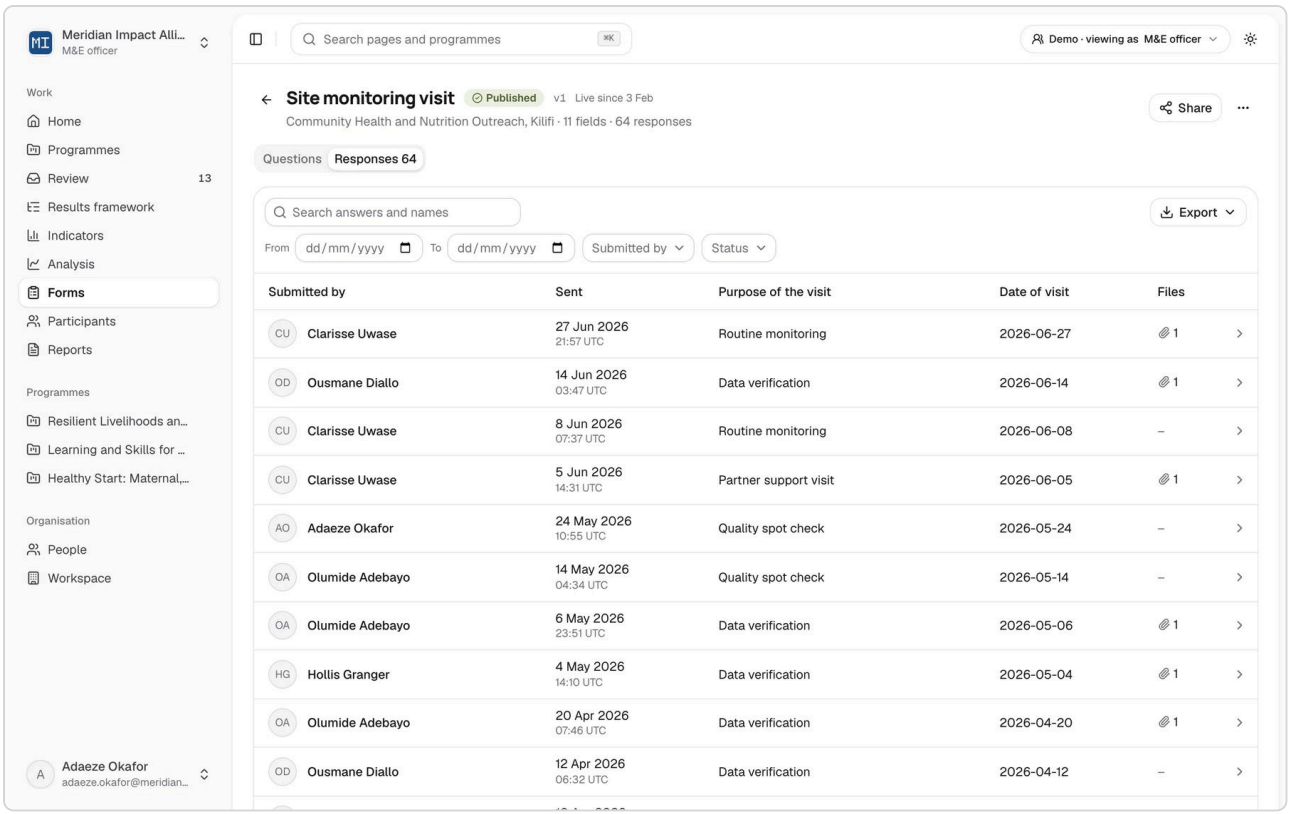


Figure 18.6 The Responses tab.

- Search answers and names, filter by date, project, who sent it, and whether it came from a signed-in member or the shared link.
- Open a response to see each answer, photos and a map of its location.
- **Export** to Excel or CSV. The export follows your filters.
- **Delete response** removes a response. A response already written into an indicator figure cannot be deleted; correct the figure through review instead. A copy of every deleted response is kept in the activity log.

18.7 Delete a form

From the **…** menu, choose **Delete form**. If the form has responses, you must confirm that they will be deleted for good.

19 Collecting data

Figures reach ImpactMEL in four ways: forms filled on a phone or computer, figures entered directly against an indicator, spreadsheet imports, and integrations. All of them arrive for review before they count.

19.1 Fill a form on a phone

Field officers open **Forms** in the sidebar to see every published form, and choose **Fill**. The form opens on its own page, designed for a phone. The same page opens from a form's public link, for partners without an account.

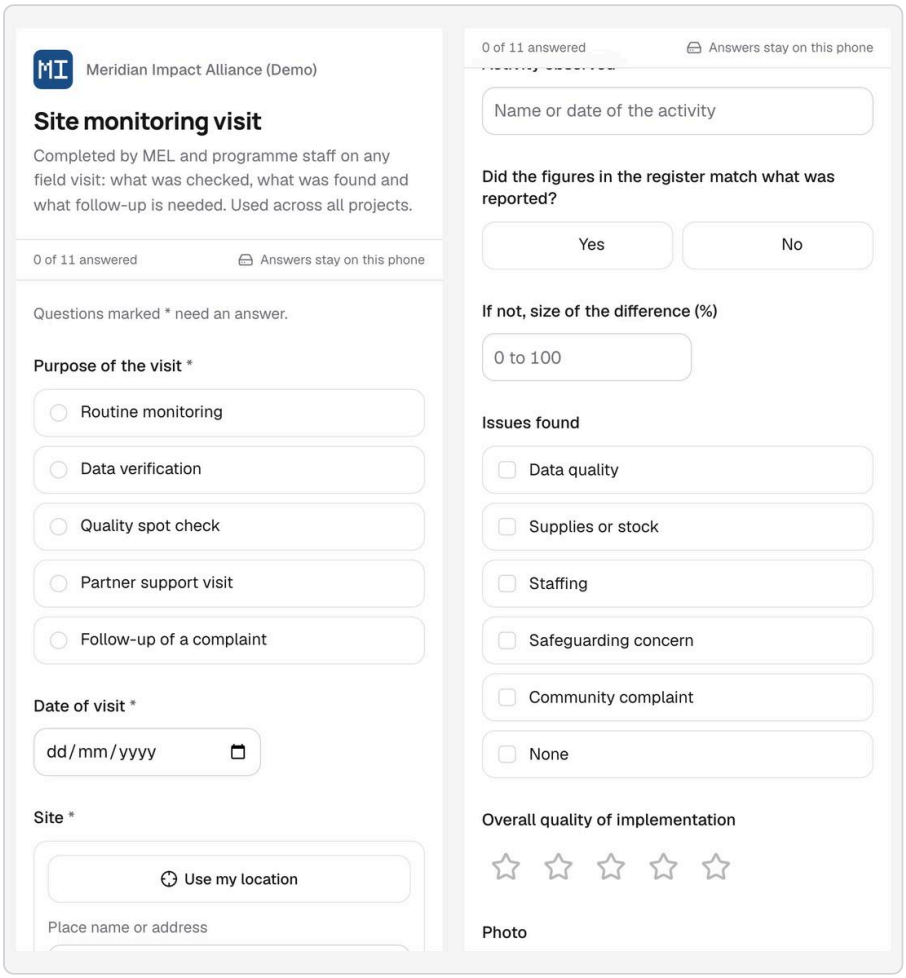


Figure 19.1 A form open on a phone.

- The organisation's logo and the form name are at the top, with a counter of answered questions.
- Questions marked * need an answer.
- Location questions offer **Use my location**. Evidence questions offer **Take a photo or choose a file**.
- Choose **Send response**. The page confirms with **Response sent**.

If you are signed in when you send, ImpactMEL records who sent it. Responses from the public link are recorded as sent through the shared link.

What happens without a connection

ImpactMEL forms work in the phone's browser. There is no app to install. Be clear with field teams about what this means:

- **Opening a form needs a connection.** The page cannot be opened, or installed, offline.
- **Once open, answers are kept on the phone.** They are saved in the browser as you type. If the page is closed and reopened on the same phone and browser, ImpactMEL offers the answers you started.
- **Sending waits for a connection.** If there is no connection when you choose **Send response**, the page says **Waiting for a connection… Keep this page open.** It tries again every 20 seconds and as soon as the phone reconnects. A response is never sent twice.
- **Limits.** One unsent response per form per phone. A photo chosen while offline is held only until the page is closed. Clearing the browser's data removes saved answers.

For long trips without coverage, use a tool built for offline collection, such as KoboToolbox, and bring the submissions in through the KoboToolbox integration.

19.2 Enter a figure

Field officers can enter a figure directly against an indicator.

1. On **My tasks**, choose **New figure**.
2. Choose the project, the indicator and the period. Only open periods without a figure from you are offered.
3. Choose **Start**, enter the values and any breakdown, mark estimates, and add evidence.
4. Choose **Send for review**, or **Save without sending** to finish later.

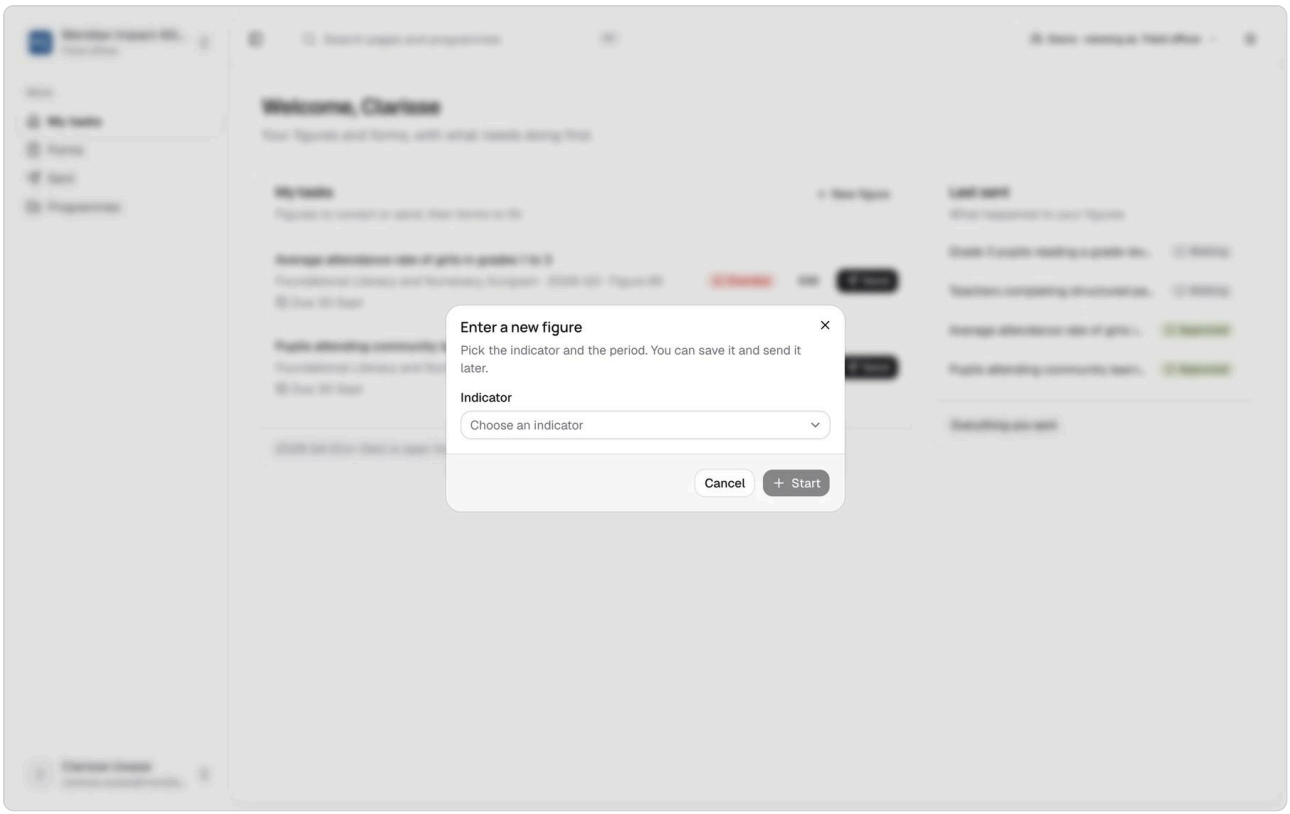


Figure 19.2 Starting a new figure.

19.3 Correct a returned figure

When a reviewer returns a figure, it appears first on **My tasks** with their reason.

1. Choose **Correct**.
2. The page shows the reason, the values, and what each value was before. Change the values, tick **Estimated** where needed, and add a note.
3. Add evidence under **Evidence** with **Add a file**: photos, PDF, Word, Excel or video, up to 50 MB.
4. Choose **Send again**.

Only the person who entered a figure can correct it. A closed period blocks changes, and approved figures are final.

19.4 See what you sent

Sent lists every figure you have sent, with tabs **All**, **Waiting**, **Returned** and **Approved**.

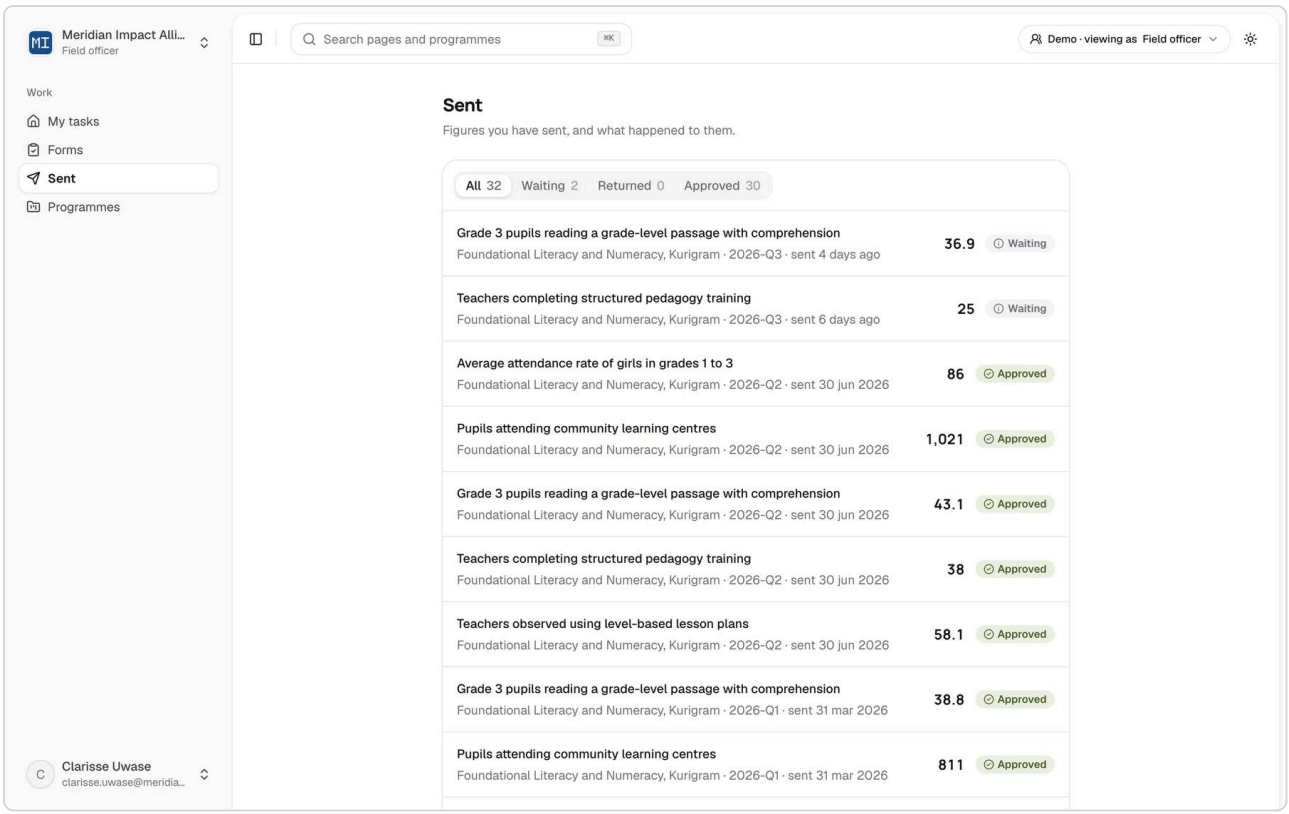


Figure 19.3 The Sent page.

19.5 Other ways in

- **Spreadsheets.** Import figures for many indicators at once from Excel or CSV. See Integrations.
- **KoboToolbox and DHIS2.** See Integrations.

Whatever the route, figures only count once approved in Review.

20 Participants and registers

The participant registry holds the people your activities reach and what each person attended. It is the source behind reach figures broken down by sex, age and disability. Projects also keep registers of stakeholders, evaluations, narratives and documents.

Who can do this: M&E officers and Organisation admins by default. Anyone with participants permission can read the registry.

20.1 The Participants page

Open **Participants** in the sidebar.

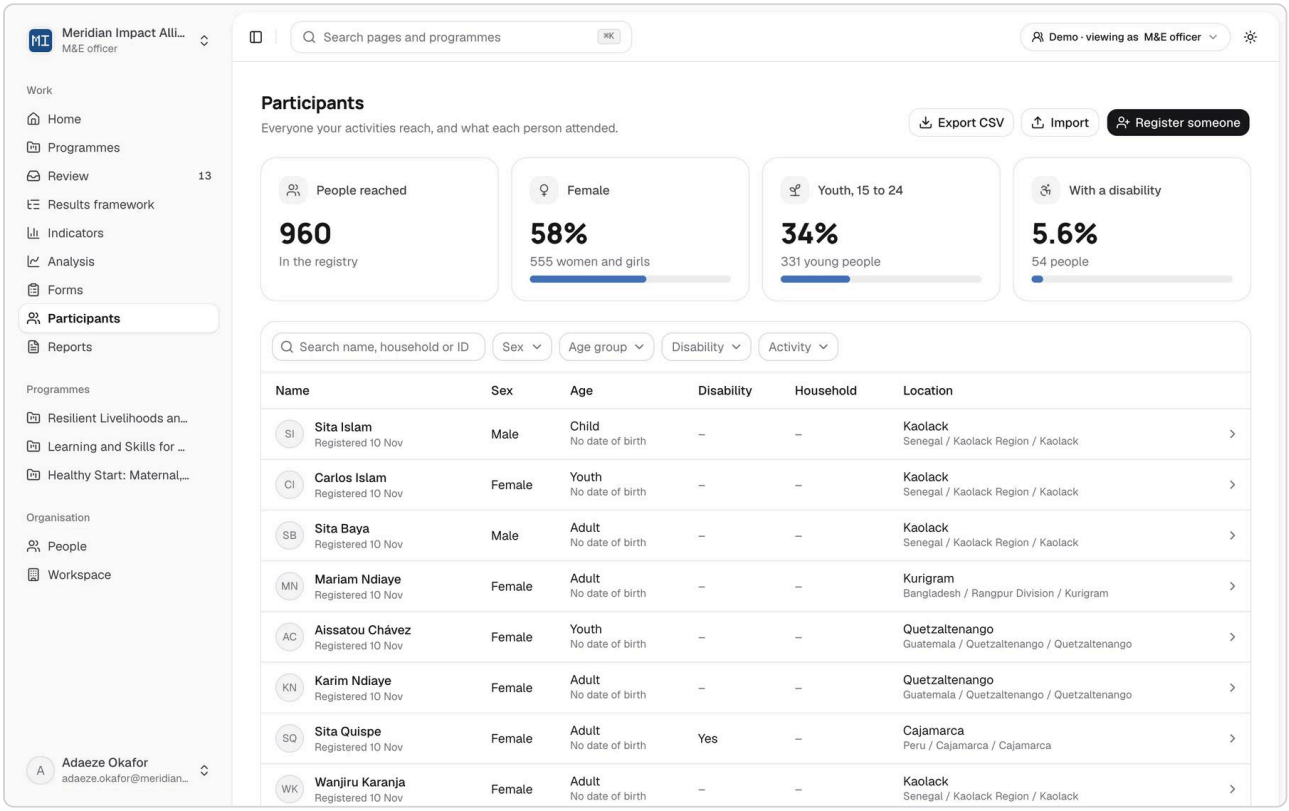


Figure 20.1 The Participants page, with reach broken down by sex, age and disability.

The tiles show people reached, the share who are female, youth aged 15 to 24, and people with a disability. Filter by sex, age group, disability and activity, or search by name, household or ID.

20.2 Register someone

Choose **Register someone**. Only the name is required. You can also record sex, date of birth, age group, disability and its type, phone, national ID, email, village or site, household code, and whether they head the household.

20.3 A participant's record

Open a person to see their details, the activities they are registered for and whether they attended, and their household. From here you can:

- **Register for an activity** and record attendance as Attended, Absent or Registered;
- add or remove household members;
- **Edit details**, or **Delete record**. A person with attendance cannot be deleted.

20.4 Import participants

Choose **Import** and upload a CSV or Excel file. Download the **Excel template** or **CSV template** first. Before anything is saved, the preview counts new people, duplicates and problems. A duplicate is the same national ID, or the same name, date of birth and village. Link household members with the **Household member of** column.

20.5 Export

Export CSV downloads the list as filtered.

20.6 Project registers

Each project page has four registers.

- **Stakeholders and target groups.** Stakeholders with their type, role, agreement and contact, placed on an influence and interest grid; target groups with an estimated size.
- **Evaluations.** Plan an evaluation (baseline to learning review) with its status, dates, evaluator and budget, then record findings, lessons learned, recommendations and the management response.
- **Period narratives.** One narrative per indicator per period, explaining what happened. Reports use them.
- **Documents.** Upload a file up to 50 MB or link one, typed as report, plan, evidence, photo or other, with tags.

21 Activities and deadlines

Activities are the work plan: trainings, distributions, meetings and construction, with dates, a responsible person and participant targets. The Deadlines page brings every date that matters into one list.

Who can do this: Programme managers and M&E officers create and update activities. Anyone with project permission can read them.

21.1 The Activities page

Open **Activities** in the sidebar.

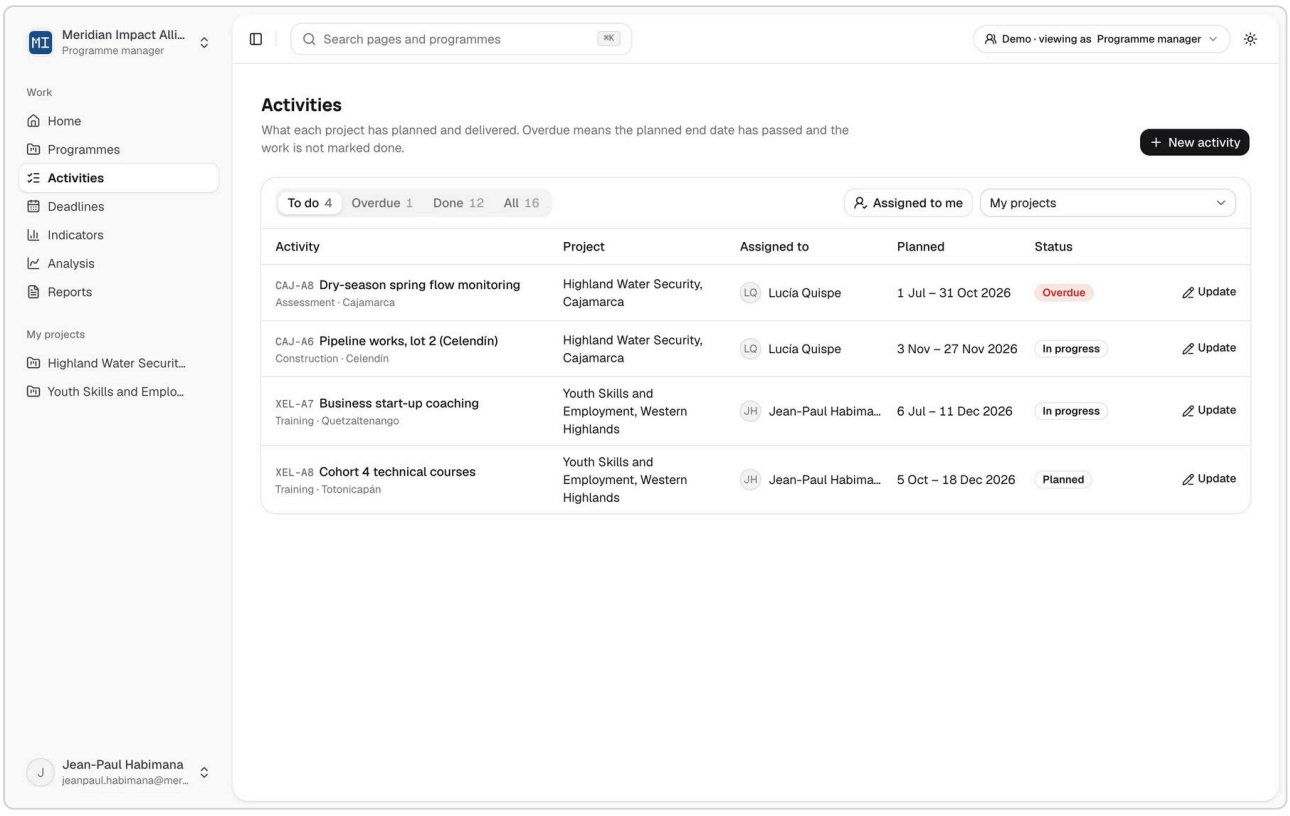


Figure 21.1 The Activities page.

Use the tabs **To do**, **Overdue**, **Done** and **All**, the project filter and **Assigned to me**. Overdue means the planned end date has passed and the work is not marked done. Choose **Update** on a row to change its status or progress. Programme managers can also tick activities done from their home page.

21.2 Add an activity

Choose **New activity** and enter:

- project, name, code and type (training, meeting, distribution, assessment, campaign, construction or other);

- planned start and end, status (planned, in progress, completed or cancelled) and percent complete;
- actual start and finish;
- description and venue;
- participant targets: total, women, men and youth;
- remarks, and who it is **assigned to**.

21.3 The activity page

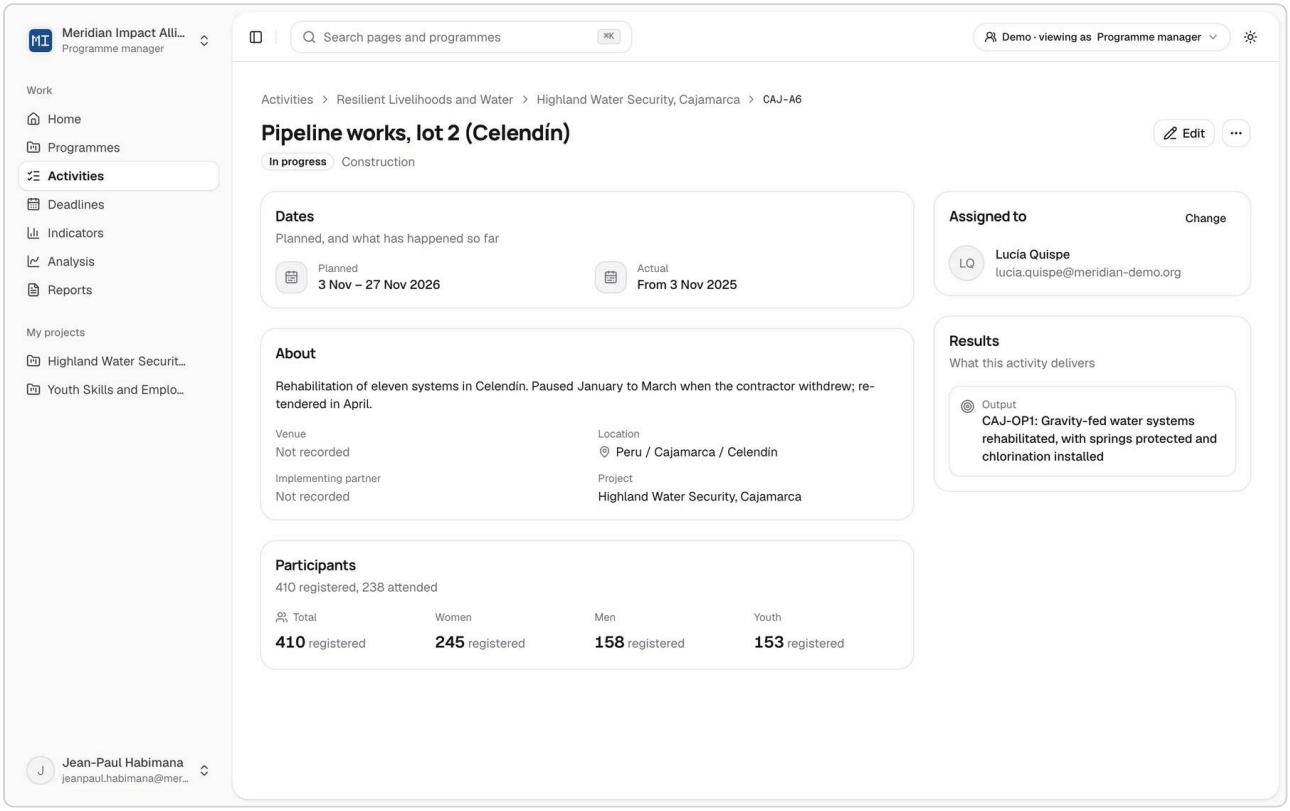


Figure 21.2 An activity page.

The activity page shows its dates, details, implementing partner, sub-activities, the result it delivers, and participants registered against target with the number who attended. Attendance is recorded on each participant's record. See Participants.

21.4 Deadlines

Open **Deadlines** in the sidebar.

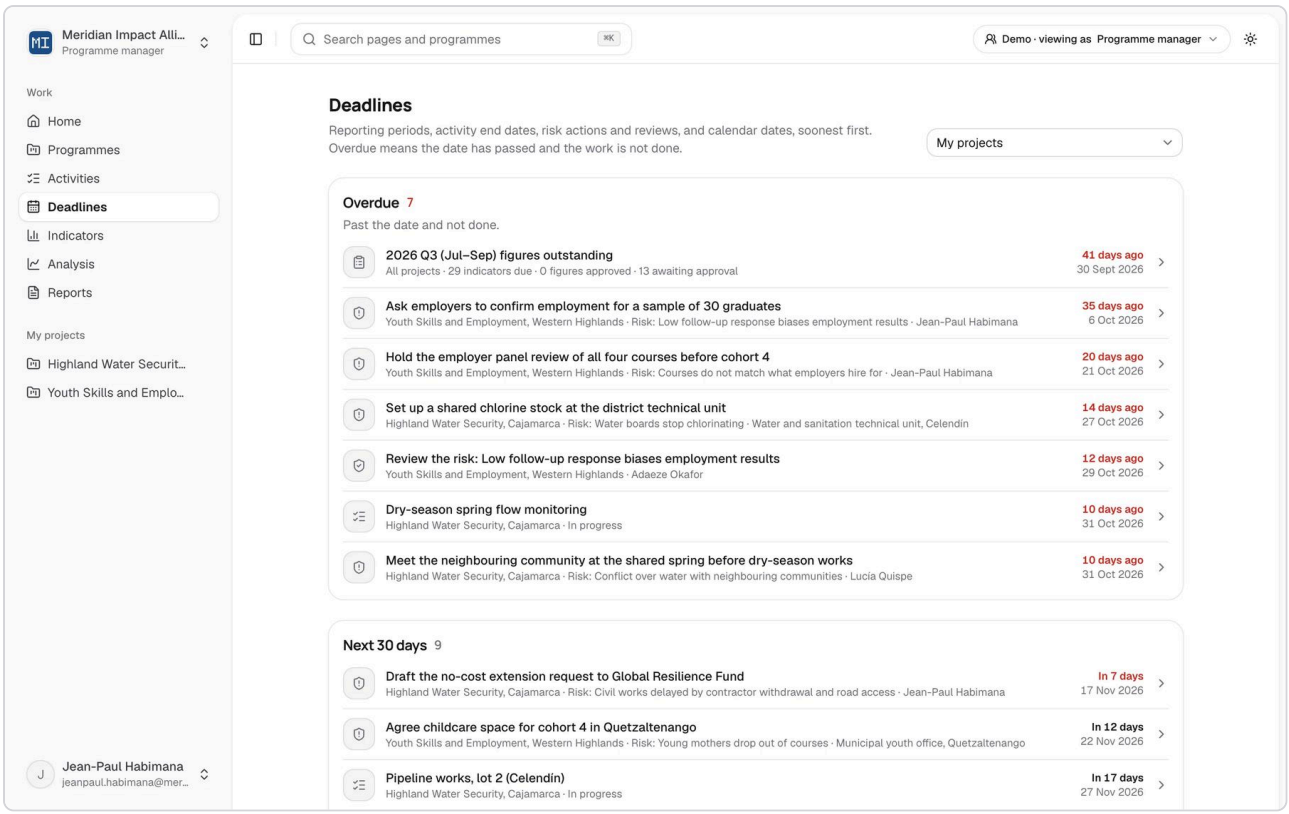


Figure 21.3 The Deadlines page.

Deadlines lists reporting periods with figures outstanding, activity end dates, risk actions and reviews, and calendar dates, grouped as **Overdue**, **Next 30 days** and **Later**. Filter by project.

PART

Check

22 Review and data quality

Every figure passes through one review queue before it counts. Reviewers see the figure beside its history, evidence and automatic checks, then approve it or return it with a reason. Approved figures are locked and feed dashboards and reports.

Who can do this: Organisation admins, Directors and M&E officers approve and return figures by default.

22.1 The review queue

Open **Review** in the sidebar. The number beside it is how many figures are waiting for you.

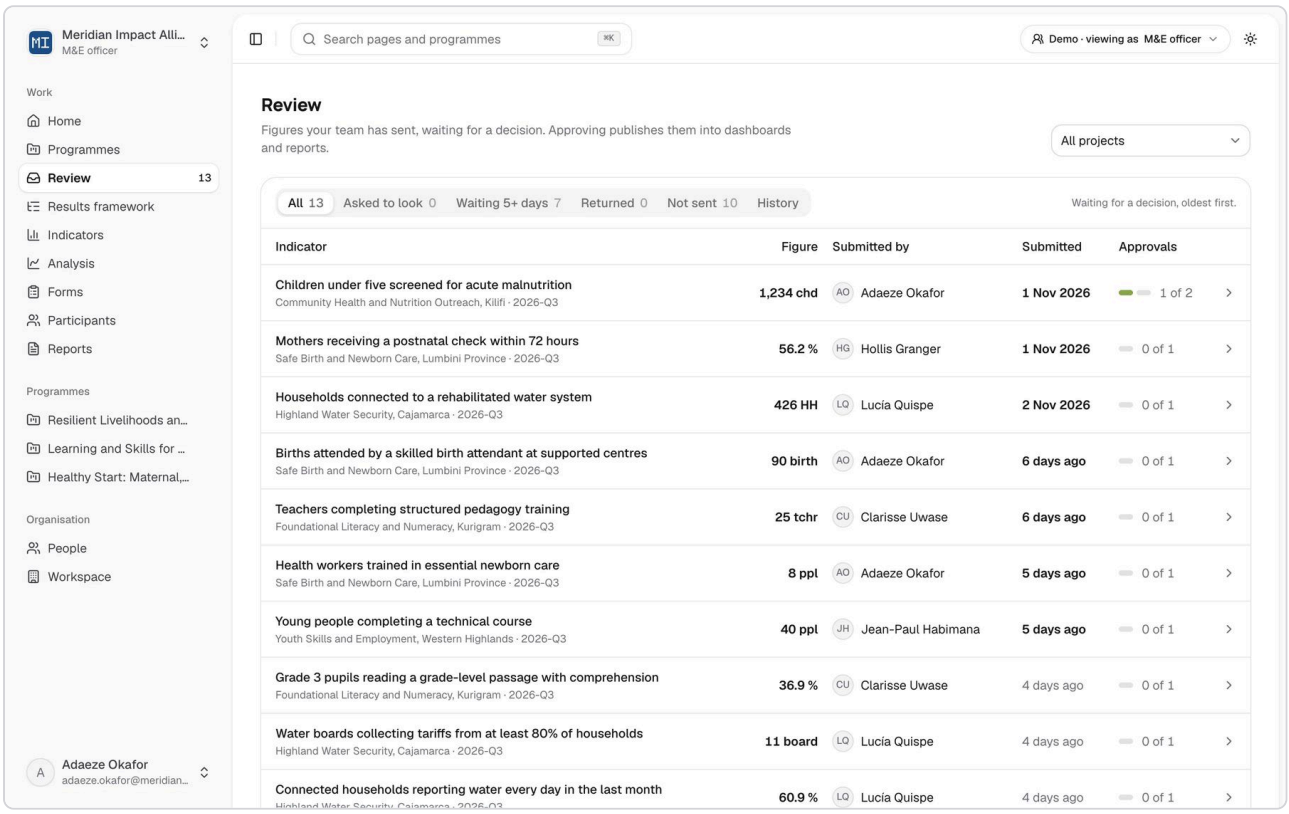


Figure 22.1 The review queue: figures waiting for a decision, oldest first.

Tab	Shows
All	Everything waiting for a decision
Asked to look	Figures a colleague asked you to look at
Waiting 5+ days	Figures waiting five days or more
Returned	Figures sent back, with the reason
Not sent	Drafts not yet sent, and who they are waiting for
History	Past decisions, from the activity log

Each row shows the indicator, project and period, the figure, who sent it, when, and how many approvals it has, such as "1 of 2".

22.2 Review a figure

Open a figure from the queue.

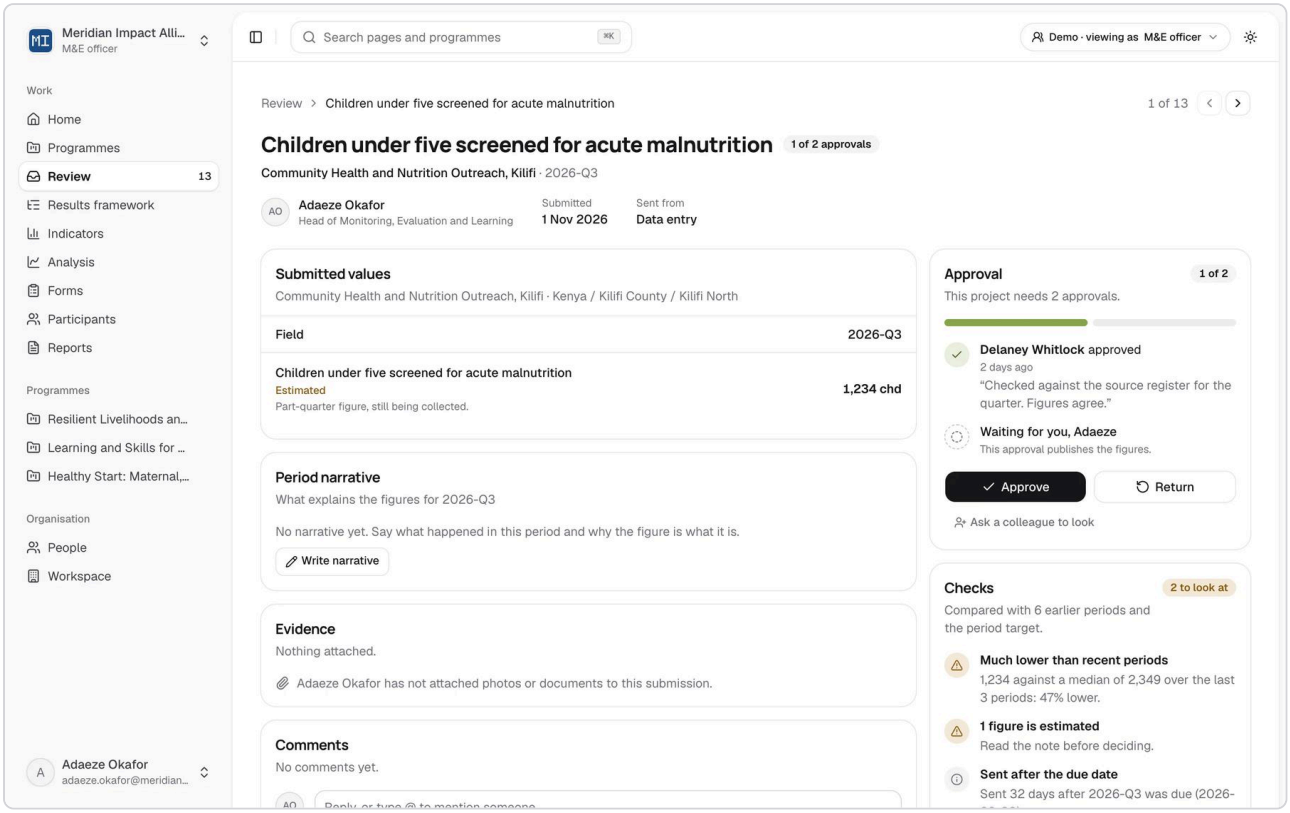


Figure 22.2 A figure under review: values, evidence, approvals and checks.

- **Submitted values**, with breakdowns, estimates and notes.
- **Period narrative**, what the team says happened.
- **Evidence**, photos and files attached by the sender. Photos open full size with the time they were taken.
- **Comments.** Reply, or type @ to mention someone.
- **Approval**, who has approved and who is still to decide.
- **Checks**, the automatic data-quality checks.
- **Audit trail**, every step in order, numbered by round.

Use the arrows at the top to move to the previous or next figure.

22.3 Automatic checks

ImpactMEL checks each figure against its definition and its history. Checks marked **Look at this** need attention; **Worth knowing** checks are for information.

- Percentage outside 0 to 100, or a value below zero
- Estimated without saying how

- Numerator larger than denominator, or a denominator of zero
- Breakdown that does not add up to the total
- Sent after the due date
- A running total that went down
- Much higher or lower than recent periods
- Out of line with a steady series
- The same figure as before
- Far above or far below the target

Comparisons use earlier approved figures only.

Explain with AI

If AI features are on and a check needs attention, **Explain with AI** writes a short explanation of what the checks found and questions you could ask the sender. It is marked **AI-drafted** and quotes only numbers from the submission. **Use as comment** puts the questions in the thread.

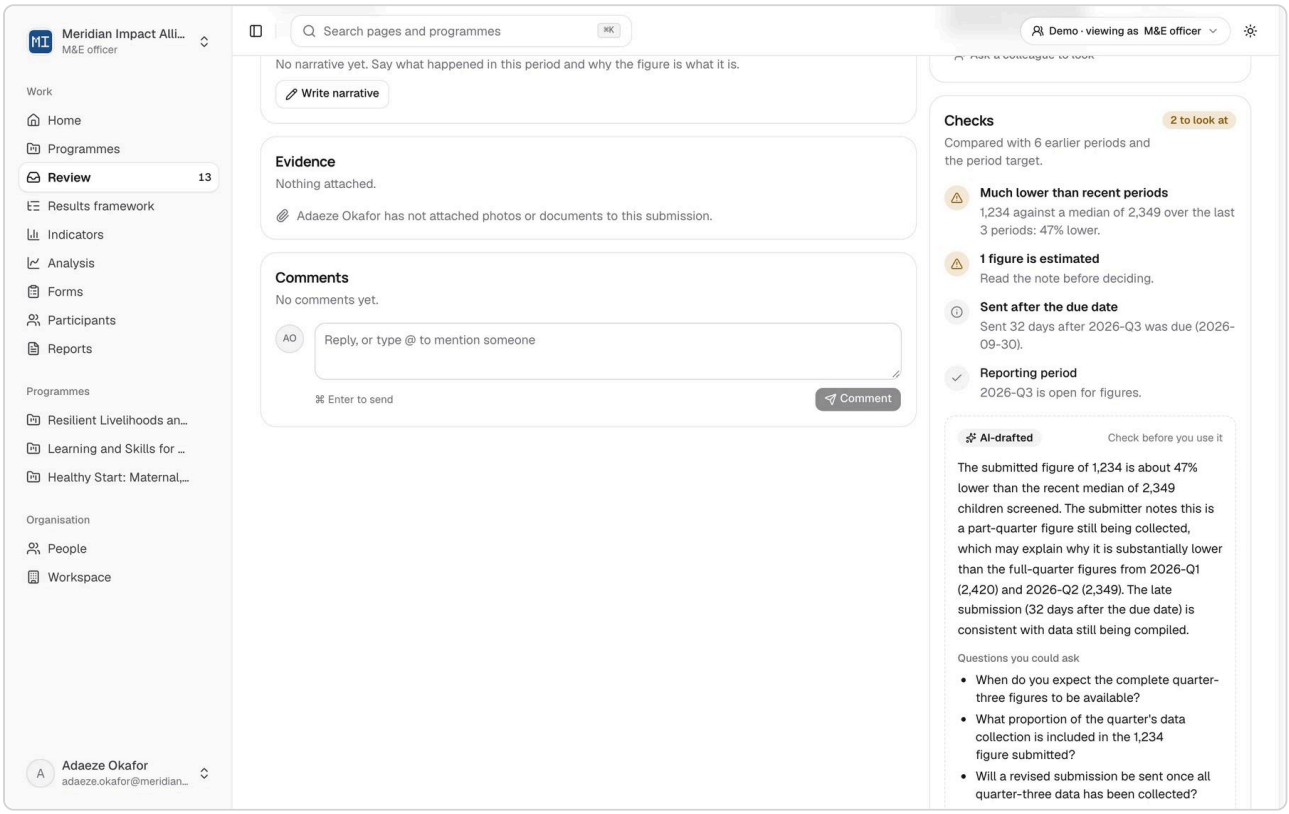


Figure 22.3 An AI explanation of the checks, with questions for the sender.

22.4 Approve

Choose **Approve**, add an optional note and confirm. Each approver decides once per round.

22.5 Return

Choose **Return** and say what needs to change. The sender is told by email and in ImpactMEL, and the figure appears first on their task list.

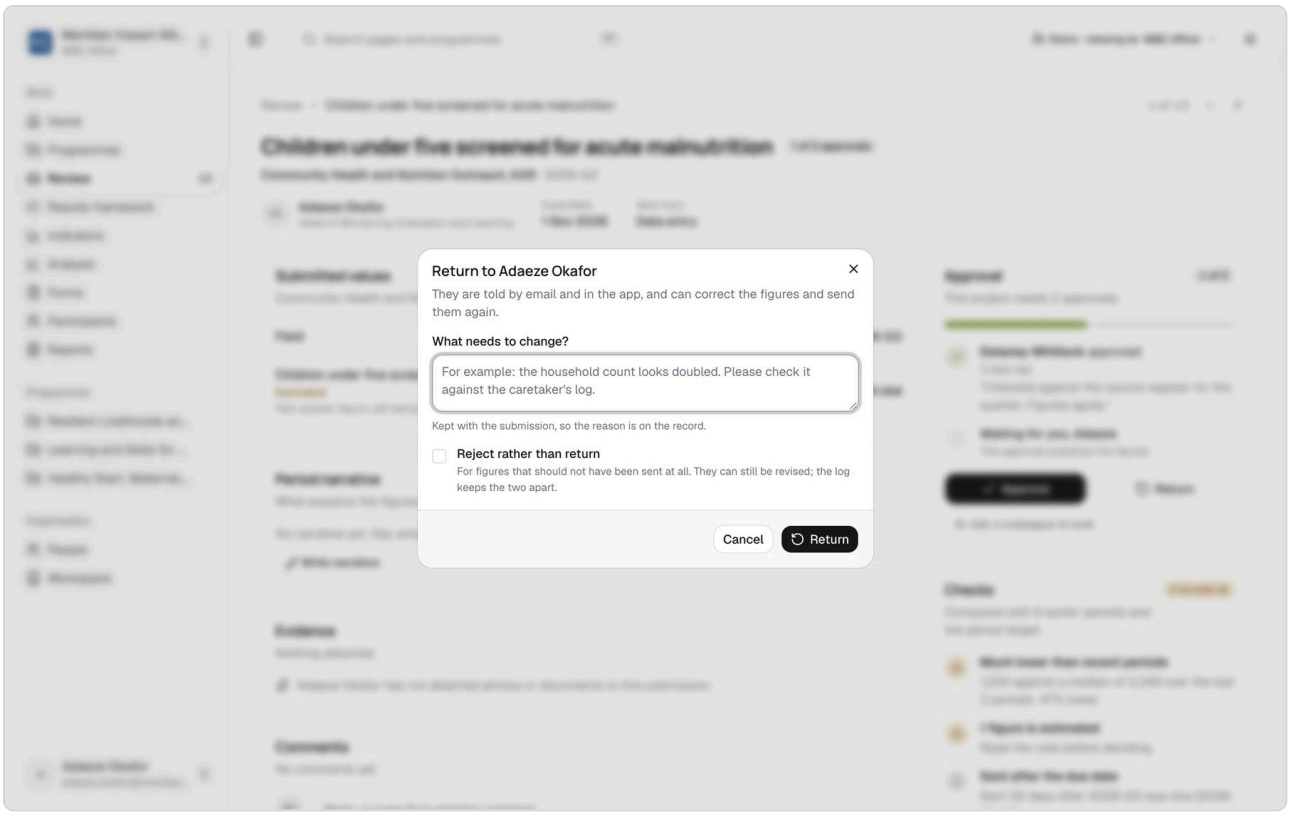


Figure 22.4 Returning a figure with a reason.

22.6 Ask a colleague

Choose **Ask a colleague to look** and pick someone who knows the site better. They are told straight away, and the figure appears under **Asked to look** for them.

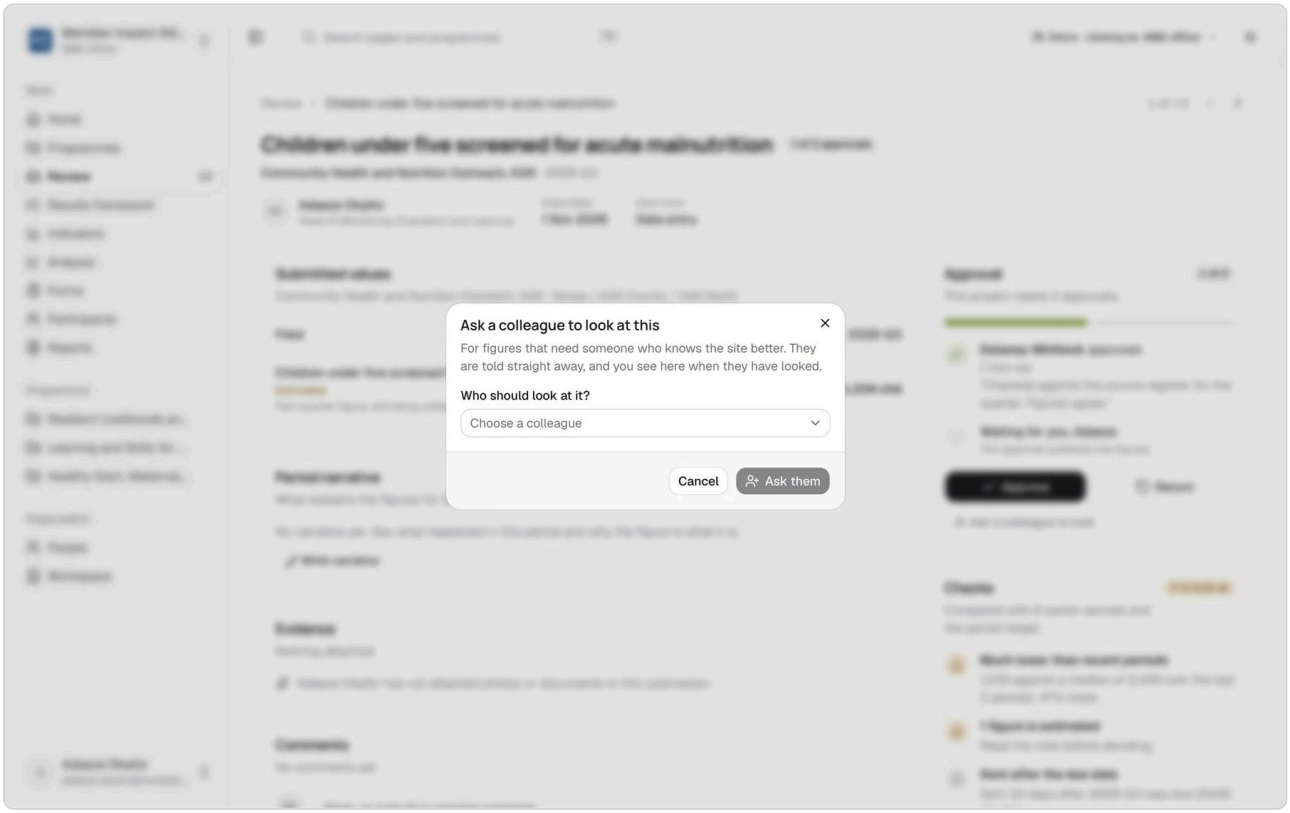


Figure 22.5 Asking a colleague to look at a figure.

22.7 Two approvers

A project can require two approvals before a figure is final. The queue then shows "1 of 2", and the figure is published after the second approval. Two approvals are set per project. There is no screen for this setting yet; ask ImpactMEL support to switch it on for a project.

22.8 After approval

An approved figure is locked. It counts in dashboards, progress and reports for its period, and cannot be edited or deleted, so check it before you approve. Every decision, comment and change stays in the figure's history and in the activity log.

22.9 Close the period

When a period's figures are reviewed, close and lock it. See Reporting periods.

23 Budgets and finance

ImpactMEL keeps each project's budget, funding and spending beside its results. It is a control layer over your accounting system: spending comes from your accounts, typed in or imported, and ImpactMEL tracks it against plan, asks for explanations and records sign-off.

Who can do this: Finance officers and Programme managers keep budgets and record spending. Directors approve budget versions and sign off periods. M&E officers can read budgets.

23.1 Where budgets are

The **Budget** section sits on each project page. Programme pages roll their projects up, and the Director's Overview shows overall spending.

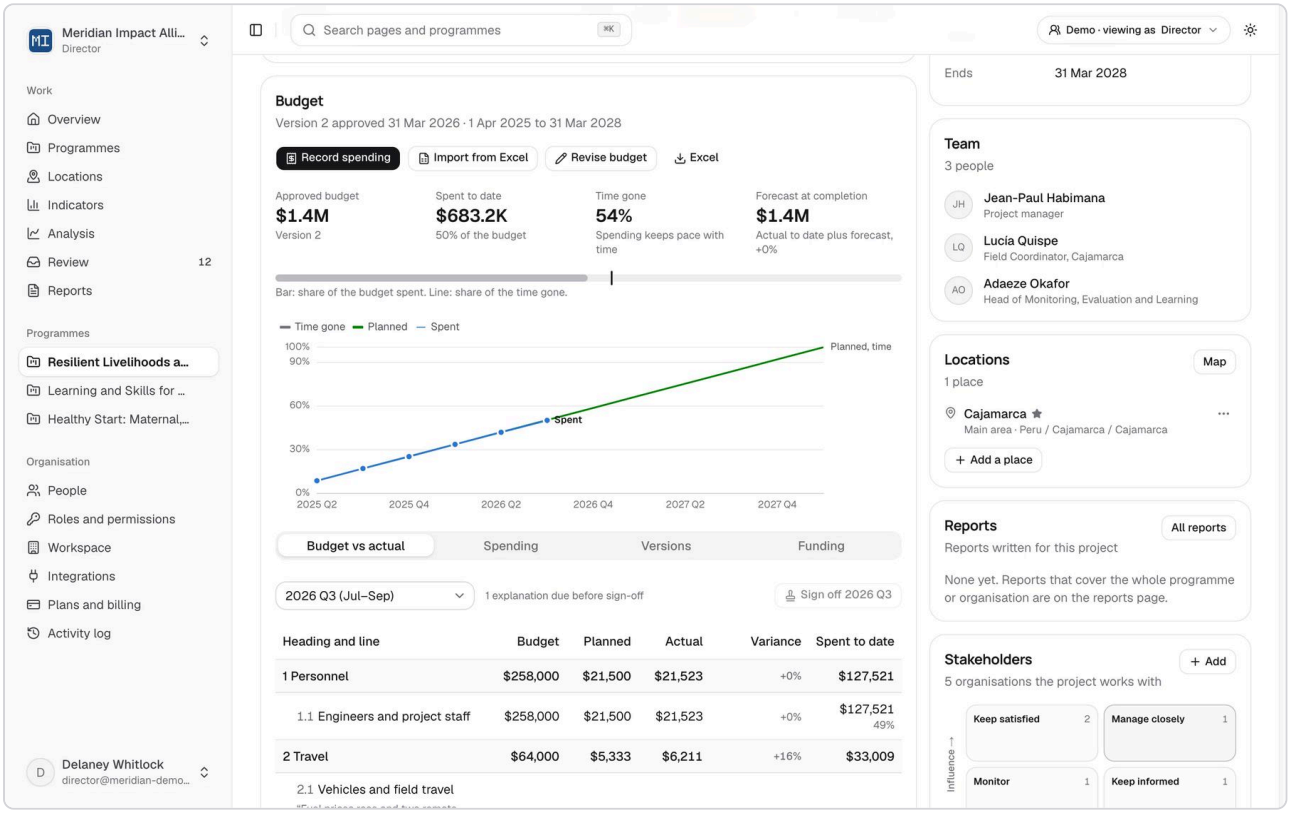


Figure 23.1 A project budget: approved budget, spent to date, time gone and forecast, with budget against actual by line.

The section has four tabs: **Budget vs actual**, **Spending**, **Versions** and **Funding**.

23.2 Set up a budget

1. On the project page, choose **Set up a budget**.
2. Choose the currency, and phase the budget by month, quarter, half-year or year. Both are fixed once a version is approved.

3. Add headings and lines. Each line can have a funding source and a phasing; **Spread evenly** divides it across periods. An indirect costs line can be calculated from the funding agreement's rate.

23.3 Funding

Under **Funding**, choose **Add funding** and enter the funder or source, agreement number, type (grant, cost share or in-kind), the committed amount, and whether it is the main agreement for this budget. Each agreement also sets:

- **Flexibility rule**, how far money can move between lines or headings, as a percentage;
- **Explain variance beyond (±%)**, the threshold that triggers an explanation, usually 10%;
- **Indirect cost rate (%)**.

23.4 Versions and approval

A draft budget is sent with **Submit for approval**. A Director chooses **Approve version** or **Return for changes**. Approved versions are read-only. **Revise budget** starts a new version and asks for a reason. A forecast is kept as its own version.

23.5 Record spending

- **Record spending.** Choose the line and period and enter the amount. If it was paid in another currency, enter the rate and its source. The rate is kept as entered.
- **Import from Excel.** Upload CSV or Excel ledger rows, up to 5 MB.
- **Correct a locked period** adds a dated adjustment rather than changing the original.

23.6 Variance explanations

Any line whose spending differs from plan by more than the agreement's threshold needs an explanation. Choose **Write explanation**. Lines without one appear in the Finance officer's **Explanations due** and in reports as "Explanation outstanding".

23.7 Sign off a period

When a period's spending is complete, choose **Sign off** for that period. This locks its figures, and reports state that spending was signed off.

23.8 Programme roll-up

The programme page shows each project's budget, spending, spending against time gone, forecast and lines to explain.

24 Risks

The risk register records what could stop the work, how serious it is now, who looks after it and what is being done. Risks link to results and indicators, appear in deadlines and on home pages, and can be included in reports.

Who can do this: Programme managers, M&E officers and Directors add and review risks. Directors decide on escalated risks. Organisation admins configure risk settings.

24.1 The Risks page

Open **Risks** from a home page tile, a project or programme page, or search.

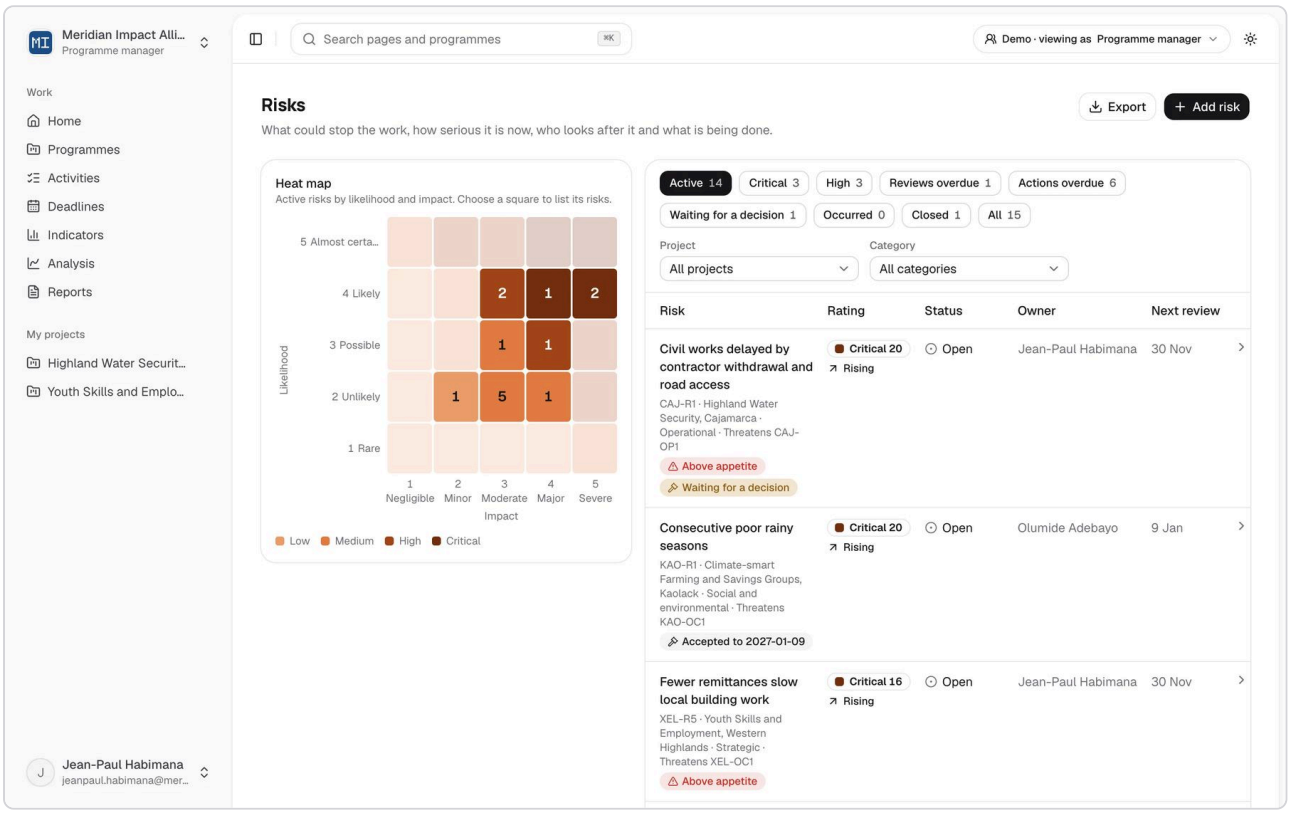


Figure 24.1 The Risks page: heat map and register.

- **Heat map.** Active risks by likelihood and impact. Choose a square to list its risks.
- **The risk register.** Filter by Active, Critical, High, Reviews overdue, Actions overdue, Waiting for a decision, Occurred, Closed or All, and by project and category.
- **Export** as an EU risk table or a risk matrix with logframe reference.

24.2 Add a risk

Choose **Add risk** and enter:

- where it applies (projects or a whole programme) and the risk in one line;

- cause, event and effect: **Because of**, **This could happen**, **Leading to**;
- category, likelihood from 1 (Rare) to 5 (Almost certain) and impact from 1 (Negligible) to 5 (Severe);
- owner, next review date and status;
- the result, indicator or assumption it threatens;
- the response (avoid, reduce, transfer, share, accept or fallback plan), what is already being done, and actions with a person and date;
- what happens if it occurs anyway, and a target rating;
- **Share with the funder**, off by default.

The score is likelihood times impact: Low 1 to 4, Medium 5 to 9, High 10 to 15, Critical 16 to 25. High and critical risks are reviewed monthly by default, others every three months.

24.3 Review a risk

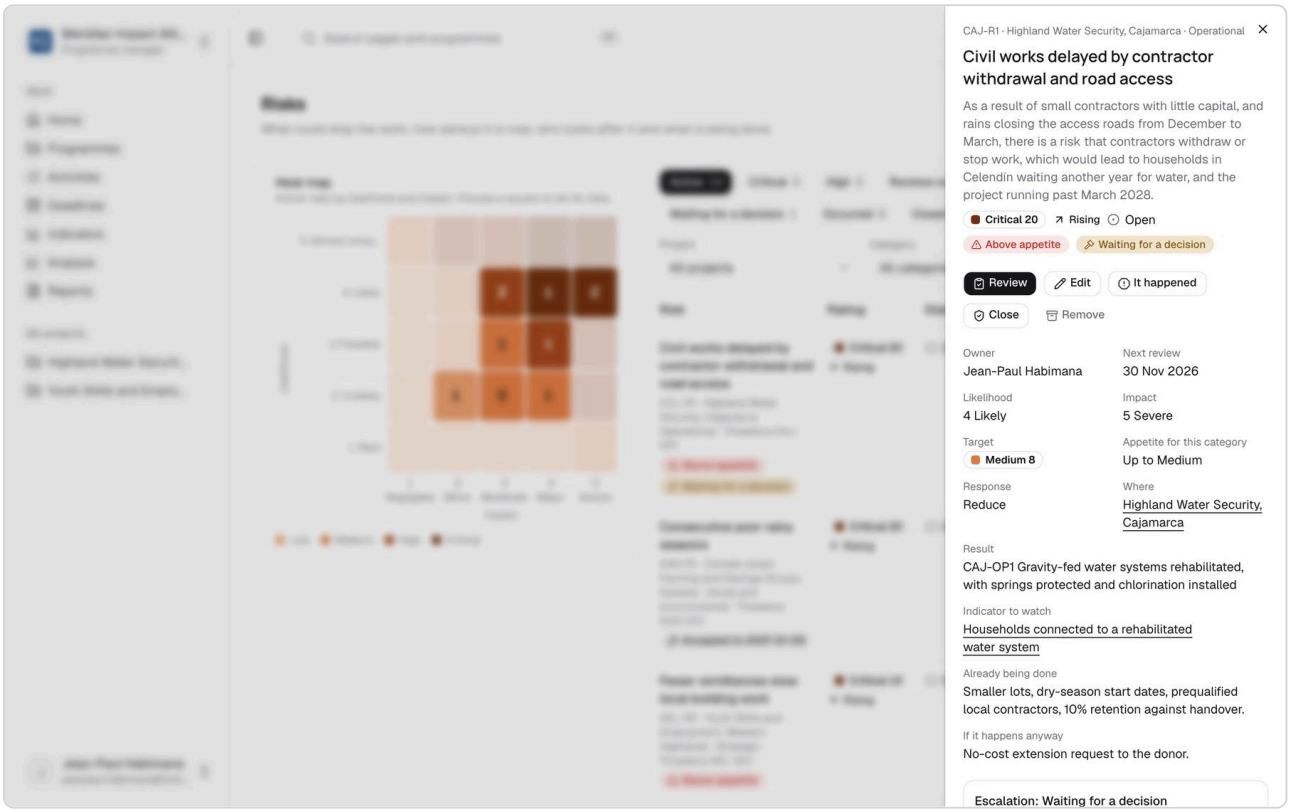


Figure 24.2 A risk's detail panel.

Open a risk and choose **Review** to record its current rating. The panel keeps a score history. Other actions: **Edit**, **It happened**, **Close** and **Remove**.

24.4 Escalate and decide

Escalate sends a risk to the Director. The Director chooses **Decide**: accept it, treat it further, or return it. Risks waiting for a decision show on the Director's Overview.

24.5 Risk settings

Organisation admins set the level names (Standard, EU, World Bank and UNDP, or Global Fund), categories and appetite in **Workspace**, under **Risks**. **Start from a donor's list** fills in a donor's categories.

PART

Report and share

25 Analysis and dashboards

Analysis turns approved figures into charts. Pick indicators and how to break them down, and ImpactMEL draws the clearest chart for them. Charts can be saved to dashboards that re-run with the latest figures each time they open.

Who can do this: anyone with indicator permission can analyse. M&E officers and Organisation admins save and share dashboards by default.

25.1 Build a chart

Open **Analysis** in the sidebar.

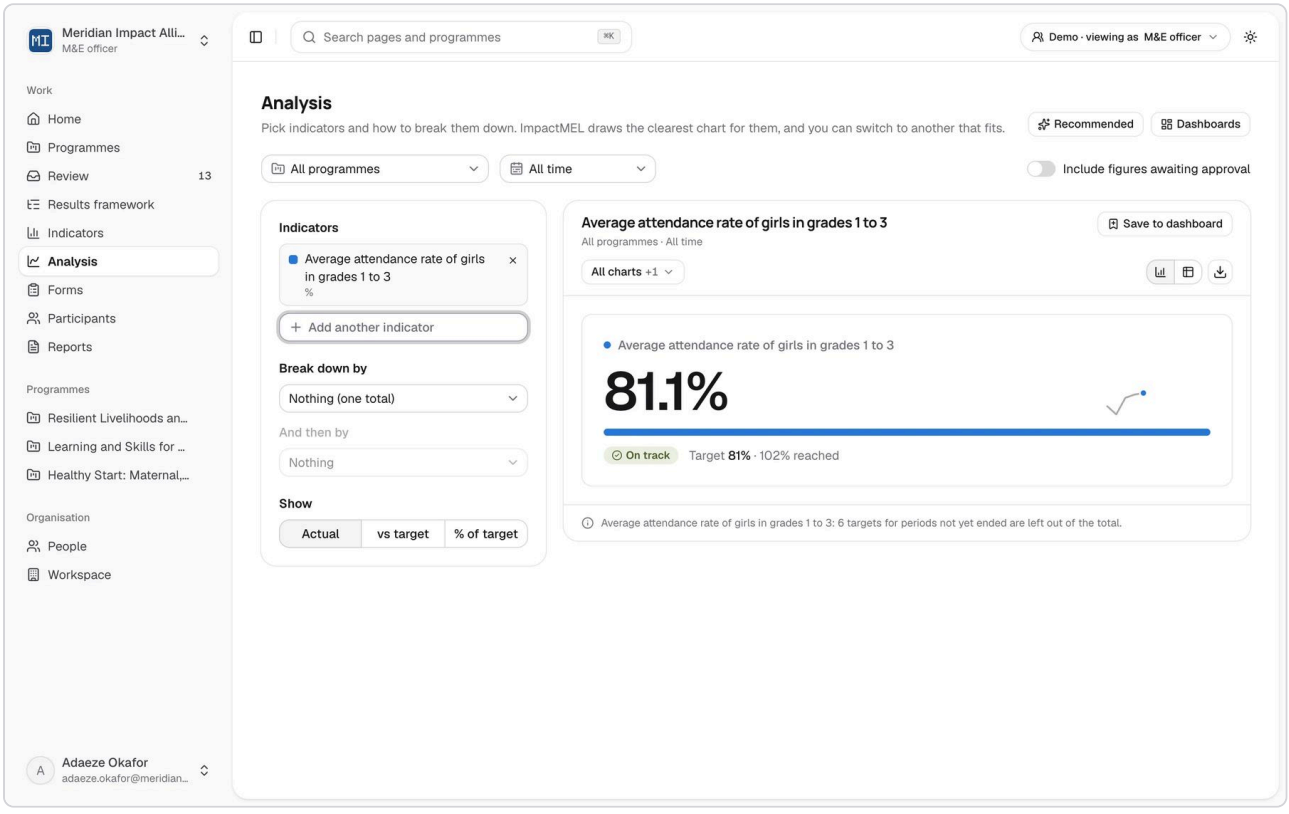


Figure 25.1 A chart built in Analysis.

1. Under **Indicators**, choose up to eight indicators.
2. Under **Break down by**, choose nothing (one total), period, project, location or a disaggregation such as sex. A single indicator can be broken down twice.
3. Under **Show**, choose **Actual**, **vs target** or **% of target**.
4. Filter by programme or project and period: this year, last four quarters, last 12 months, all time or a custom range.

ImpactMEL picks a chart. You can switch to another that fits: figures, line, area, bars, above or below target, progress to target, donut, treemap, grouped, stacked or 100% stacked bars, stacked area, heatmap, scatter, map, small multiples or a table.

Approved figures only are used, unless you switch on **Include figures awaiting approval**; those are drawn paler. Download a chart as an image (PNG) or its data as CSV.

25.2 Recommended dashboards

If AI features are on, **Recommended for you** offers ready-made dashboards built from your approved figures. Every chart is checked against those figures before it is shown. Choose **Preview** to look, and **Save dashboard** to keep one.

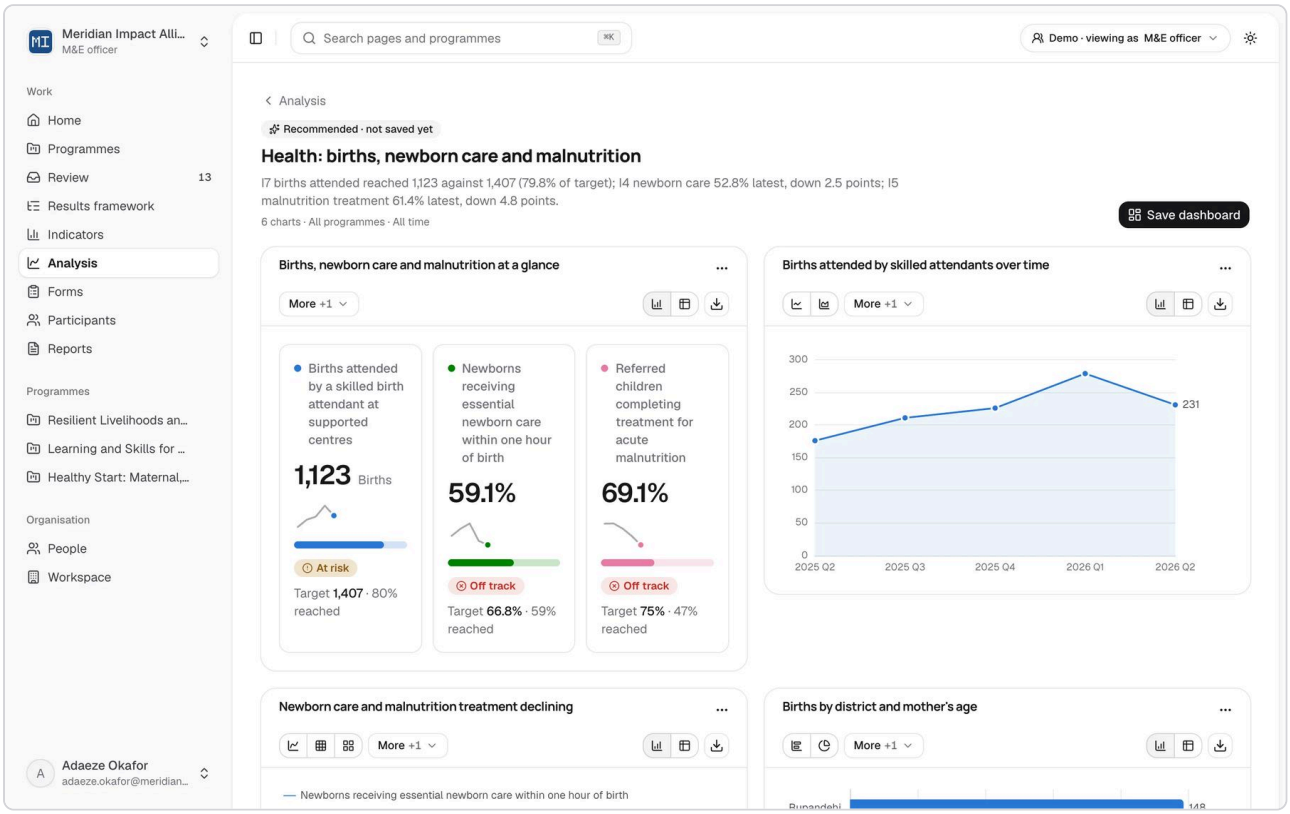


Figure 25.2 A recommended dashboard before saving.

25.3 Dashboards

Choose **Save to dashboard** on any chart, or open **Dashboards** from the Analysis page.

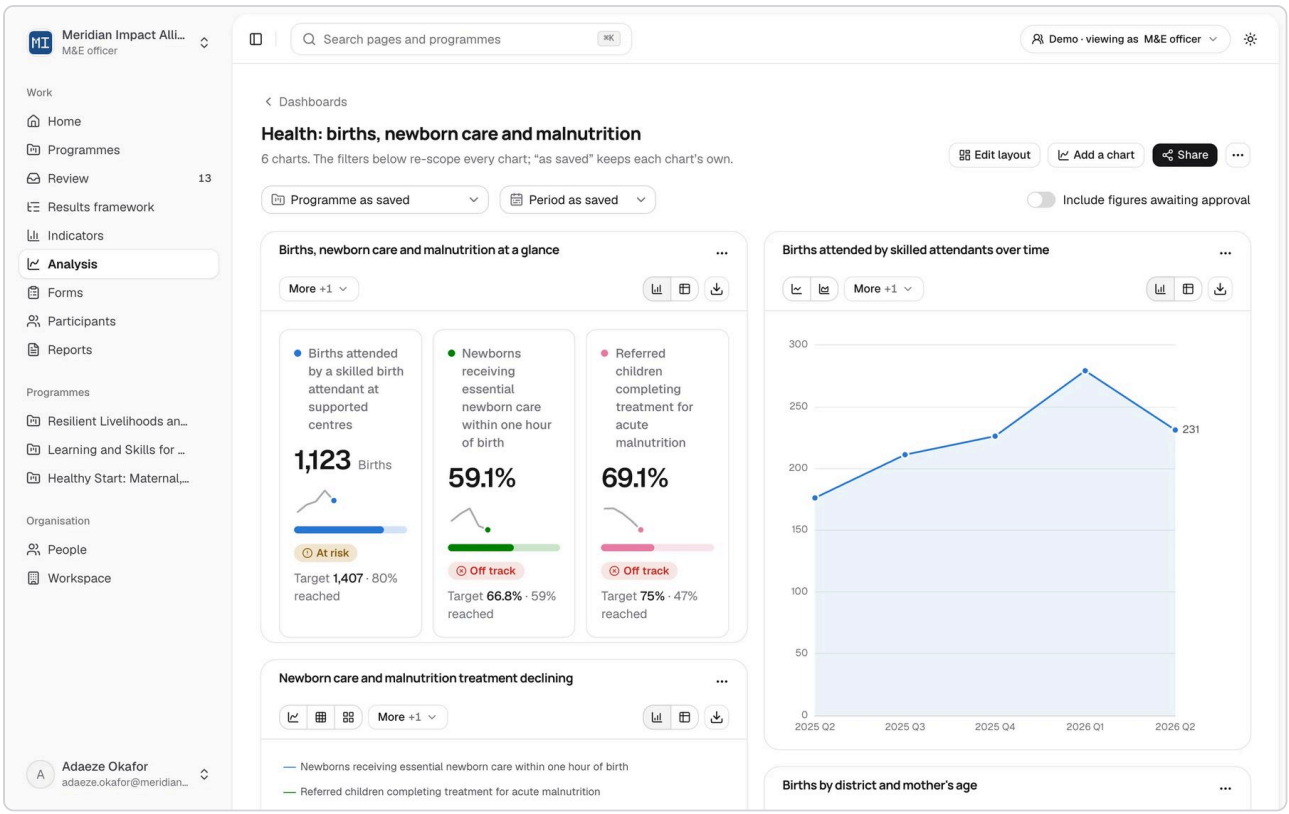


Figure 25.3 A saved dashboard.

- **Edit layout** lets you drag and resize charts on a computer.
- **Add a chart**, **Rename dashboard** and **Delete dashboard**.
- Dashboard filters re-scope every chart at once; **as saved** keeps each chart's own settings.

To share a dashboard outside your workspace, see Sharing dashboards.

25.4 Locations

Directors and Viewers have a **Locations** page: a map of where forms were received, participants registered and activities held, by place. District views need boundary data for each country; where it is not loaded, places show as points.

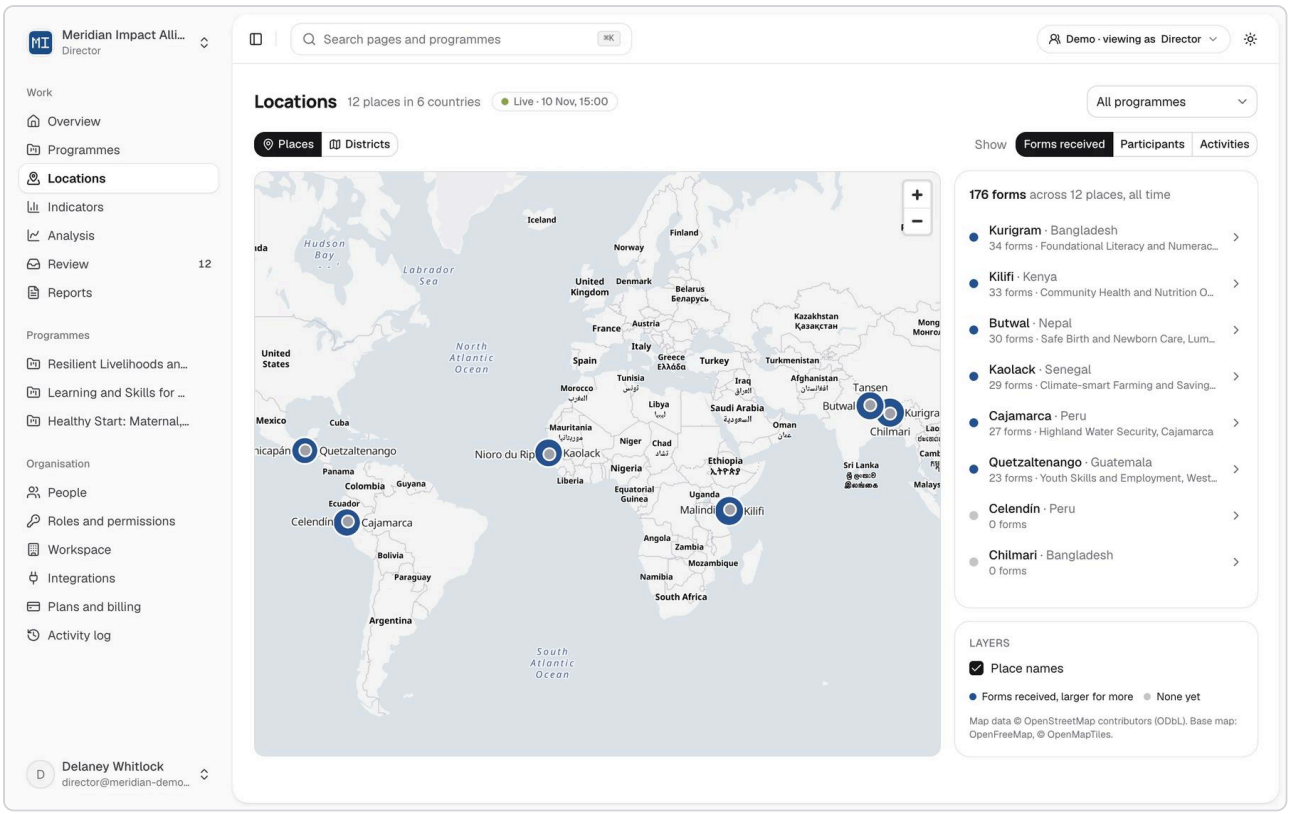


Figure 25.4 The Locations map.

26 Sharing dashboards

A dashboard can be shared with anyone through a public, read-only link. The link shows approved figures only, expires when you choose, and can be turned off at any time.

Who can do this: people who can save dashboards, by default M&E officers and Organisation admins. Roles limited to assigned projects cannot create public links.

26.1 Create a link

1. Open the dashboard and choose **Share**.
2. Under **Link stops working after**, choose 30 days, 90 days, 1 year or Never. The default is 90 days.
3. Choose **Create link**. The link is copied, ready to send.

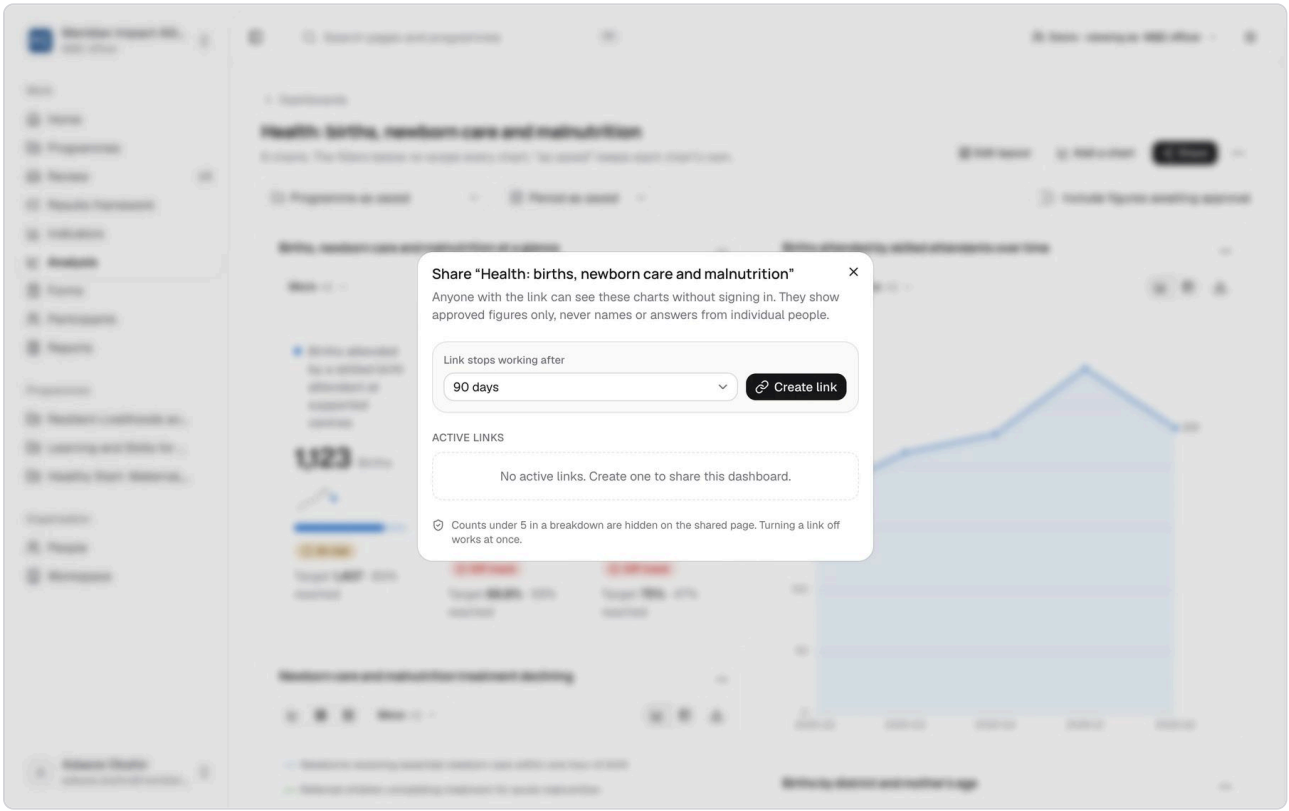


Figure 26.1 Sharing a dashboard: choose when the link expires.

The Share panel lists each active link with who made it, when, when it expires and how many times it has been viewed.

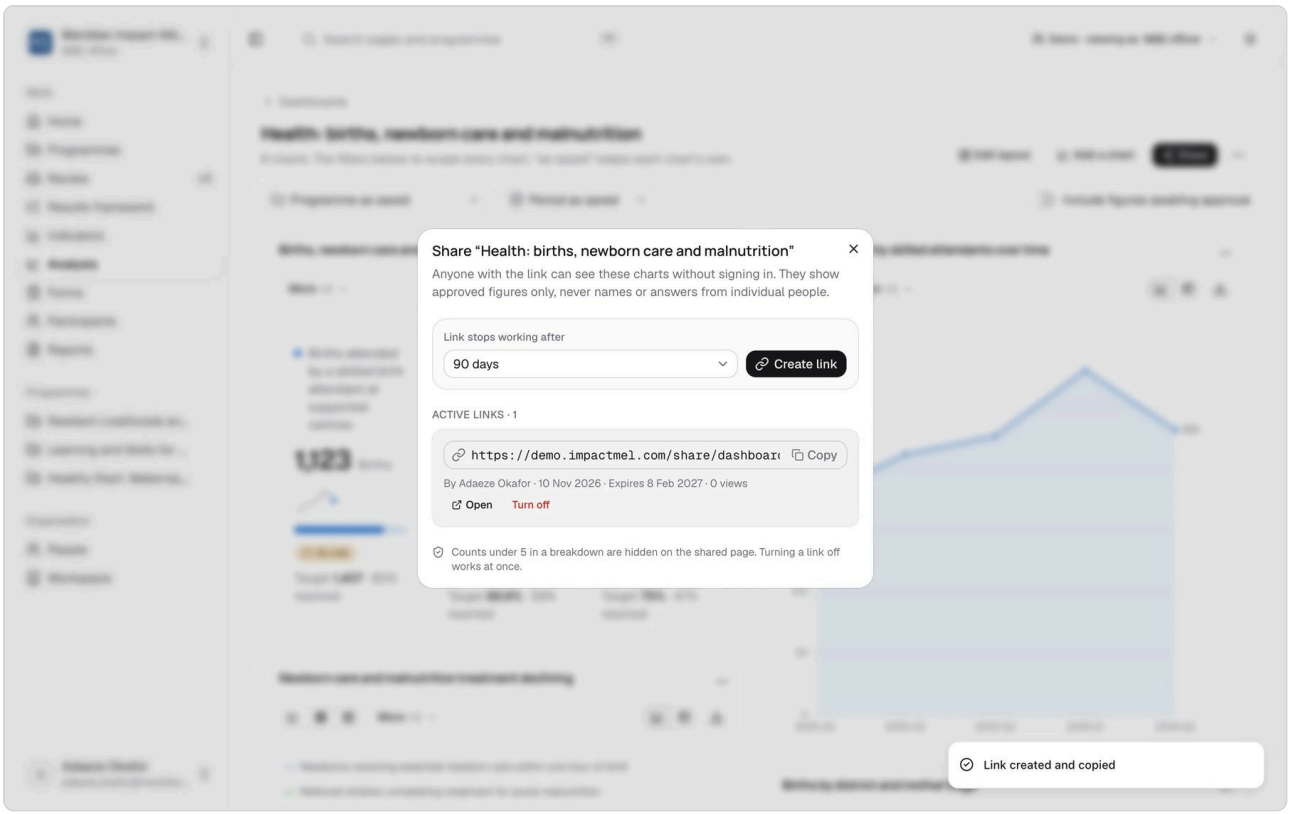


Figure 26.2 An active dashboard link.

26.2 Turn a link off

Choose **Turn off** beside the link and confirm. It stops working for everyone at once.

26.3 What the public sees

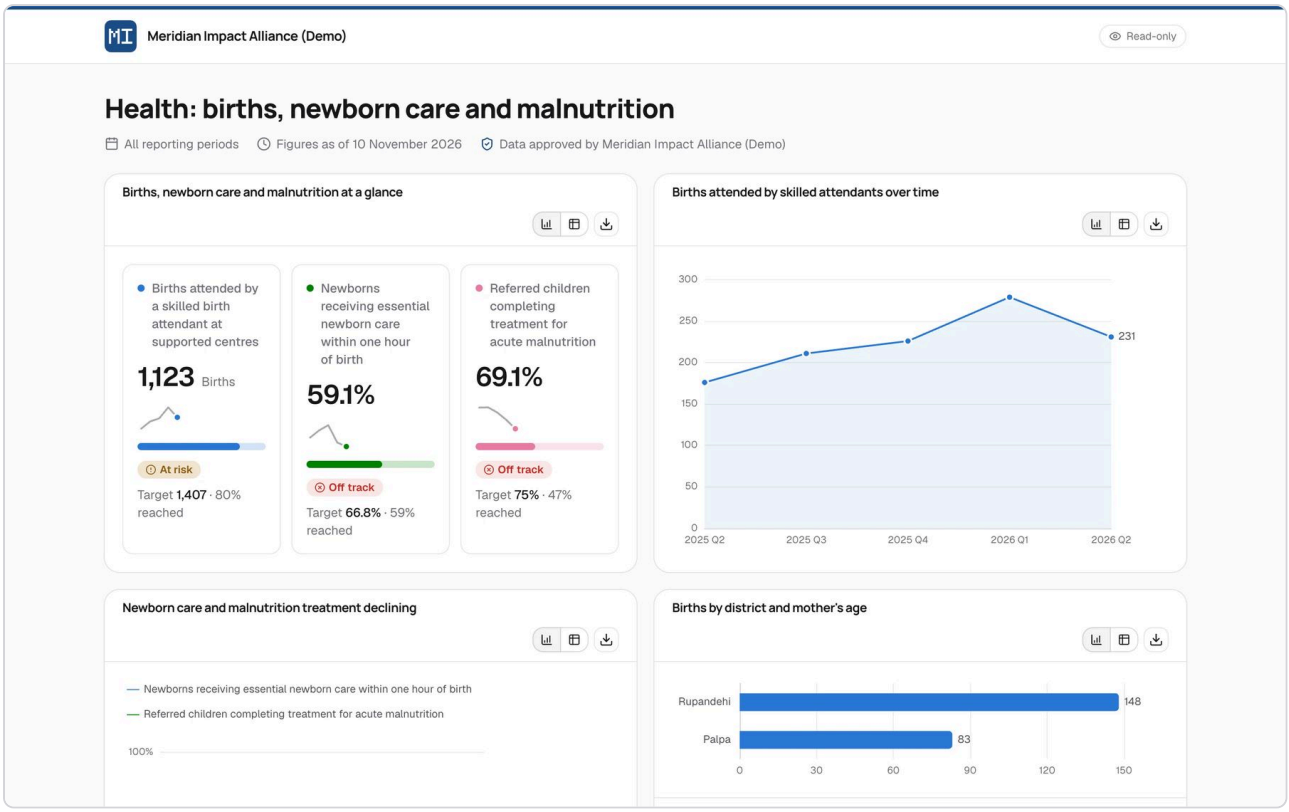


Figure 26.3 A shared dashboard as the public sees it.

- Your organisation's name and logo, the dashboard title and its charts.
- The period, the date the figures are as of, and "Data approved by" your organisation.

26.4 What the public does not see

- Figures awaiting approval.
- Internal notes and identifiers.
- Breakdown counts under 5, which are hidden to protect individuals. Charts that would reveal them switch to bars.

Figures on a shared dashboard refresh within about a minute of an approval.

27 Reports

Reports are assembled from approved figures, never typed. You choose a type, a scope and a period; ImpactMEL builds the report; you add the written parts, then publish it. Publishing locks the report and records a fingerprint, so a figure sent to a donor can be shown exactly as it stood on the day.

Who can do this: anyone with report permission can read and export reports. Directors and M&E officers write and publish them by default.

27.1 The Reports page

Open **Reports** in the sidebar.

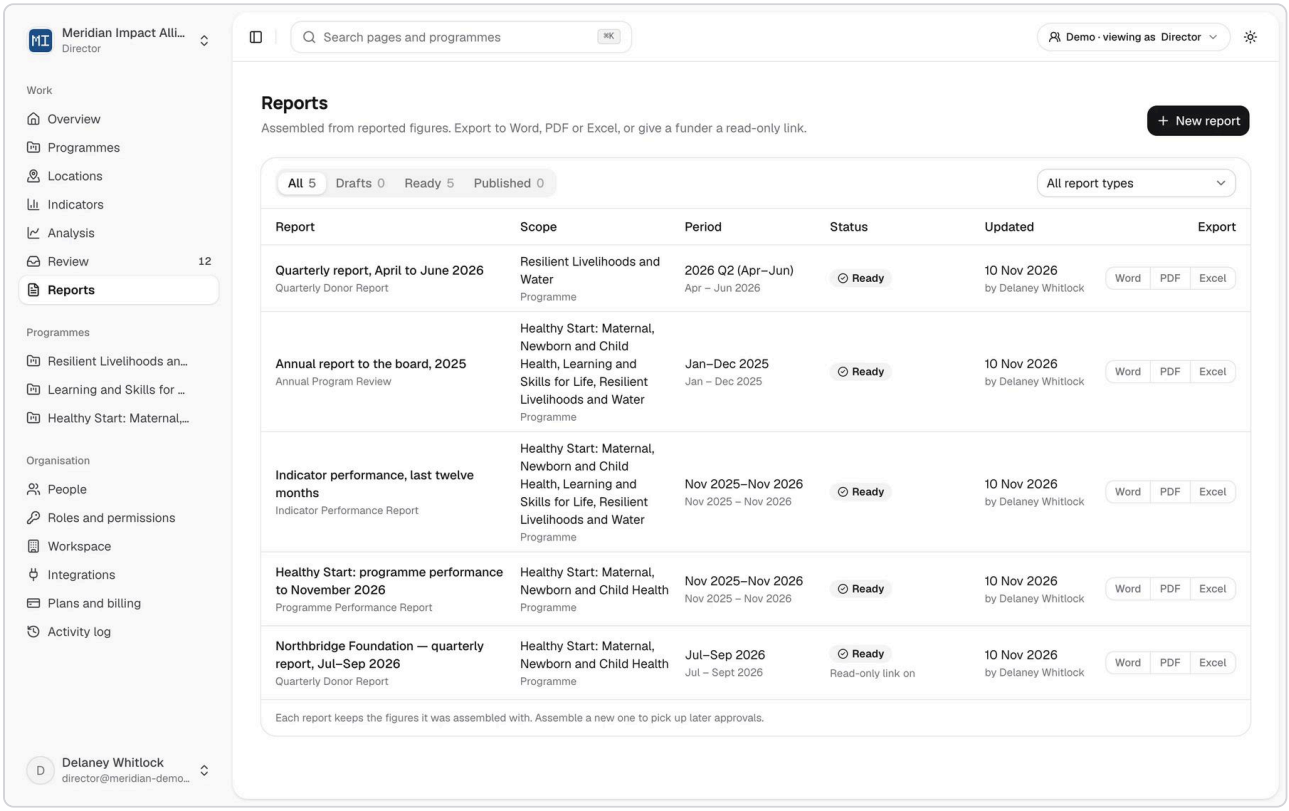


Figure 27.1 The Reports page.

Use the tabs **All**, **Drafts**, **Ready** and **Published**, and filter by type. Each row has **Word**, **PDF** and **Excel** downloads. If a funder has sent you requests, a **Funder requests** tab appears. See Funder workspace.

27.2 Report types

Type	Scope	Use it for
Quarterly Donor Report	One programme, or all	The regular report to a donor: results, money, risks and next steps

Type	Scope	Use it for
Annual Program Review	One programme, or all	The year in review for a board or donor
Programme Performance Report	One programme	How a programme's projects are performing
Results Framework Progress	One programme	Progress through the results chain
Indicator Performance Report	One project	Every indicator against its targets
Evidence Pack	One project	The figures with their evidence and verification
Activity Report	One project	What was delivered and who took part

27.3 Create a report

1. Choose **New report**.
2. Choose the report type and its scope.
3. Choose the periods **From** and **To**. They must be the same kind of period, for example two quarters.
4. Give it a title, or leave it blank to name it after the type and period.
5. Choose **Assemble report**.

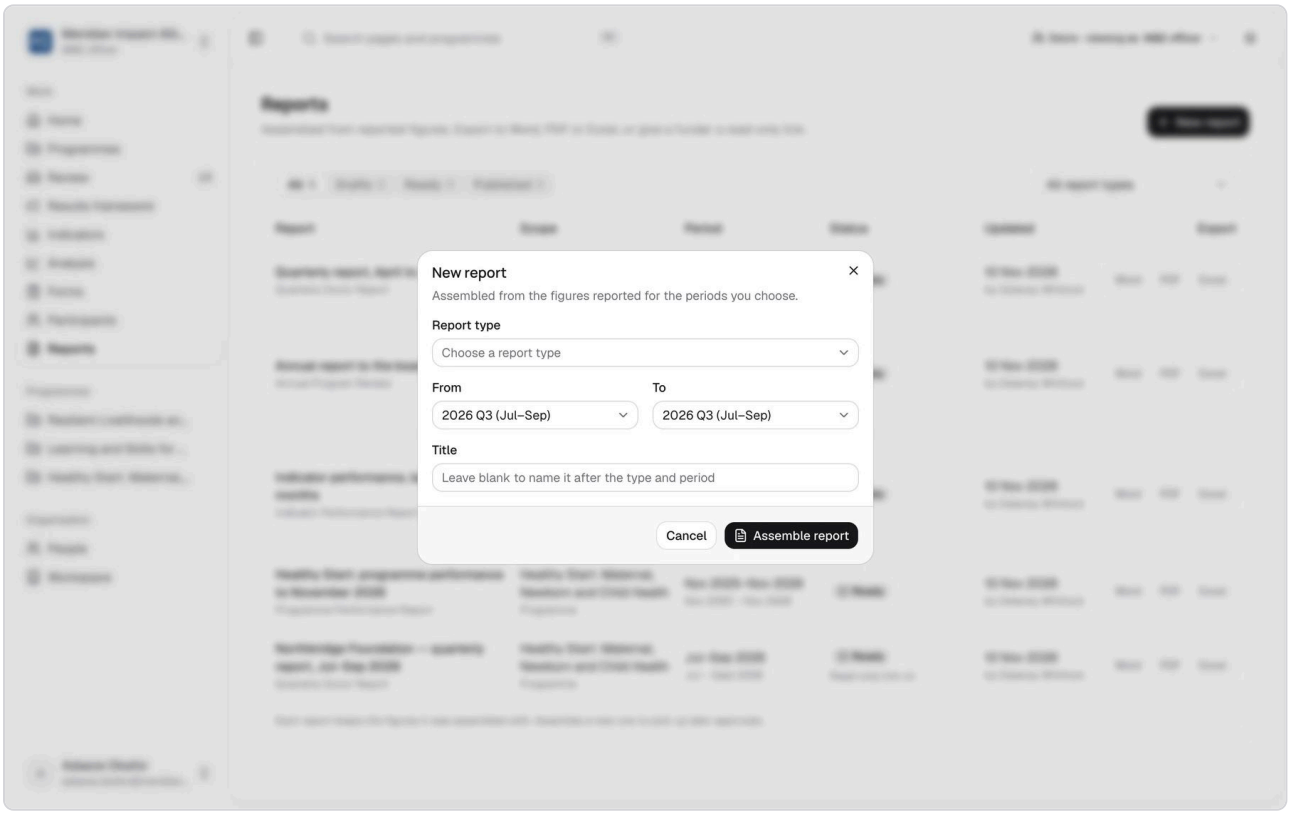


Figure 27.2 Creating a new report.

27.4 The quarterly donor report

The Quarterly Donor Report answers, in order: are we on track, why or why not, and what happens next. Then it shows what it cost and whether the figures can be trusted. A donor can stop after the first page.

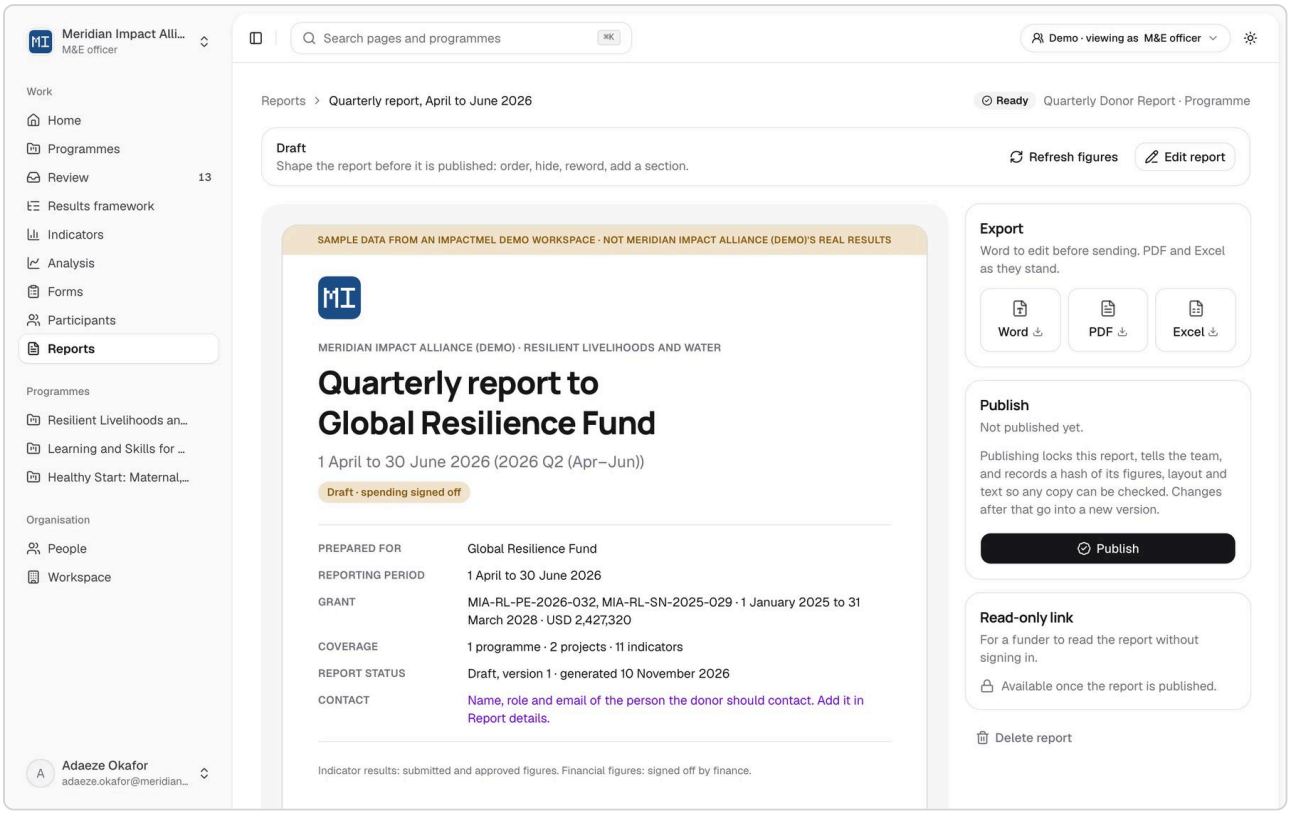


Figure 27.3 A quarterly donor report on screen.

Section	Contains
Cover	Organisation and programme, donor, reporting period, grant reference and value, coverage, report status and version, contact
01 Quarter at a glance	Headline results against target, the status of results, money spent against plan and budget, the written summary, what needs attention, requests to the donor
Results against targets	Indicators down, projects across, the programme total at the right. Each cell shows actual, % of target and target, with change since the last period. The status thresholds are printed. Disaggregation follows
Results and budget lines needing attention	Each at-risk or off-track result and each budget line beyond the variance threshold: position, what the team reported, action, owner and due date
Review of results	Performance judgements for the period
Delivery by project	What each project achieved, what got in the way, next quarter, and activities. An optional story of change with a quote and photo
Financial summary	Budget version and approval, spending by heading and by project, variance explanations
Risks and issues	One register for the grant: rating, movement, response, owner and next review
Next quarter	Priorities by project, with target dates
Data notes and sign-off	Data sources and review status, the progress formula, thresholds, sections left out, prepared, reviewed and approved by, and the content fingerprint

Section	Contains
Annex	Full indicator tables by project

Sections with no data are left out and listed in the data notes. Missing explanations show as "Explanation outstanding", and indicators without targets as "No target set". Progress uses the baseline formula.

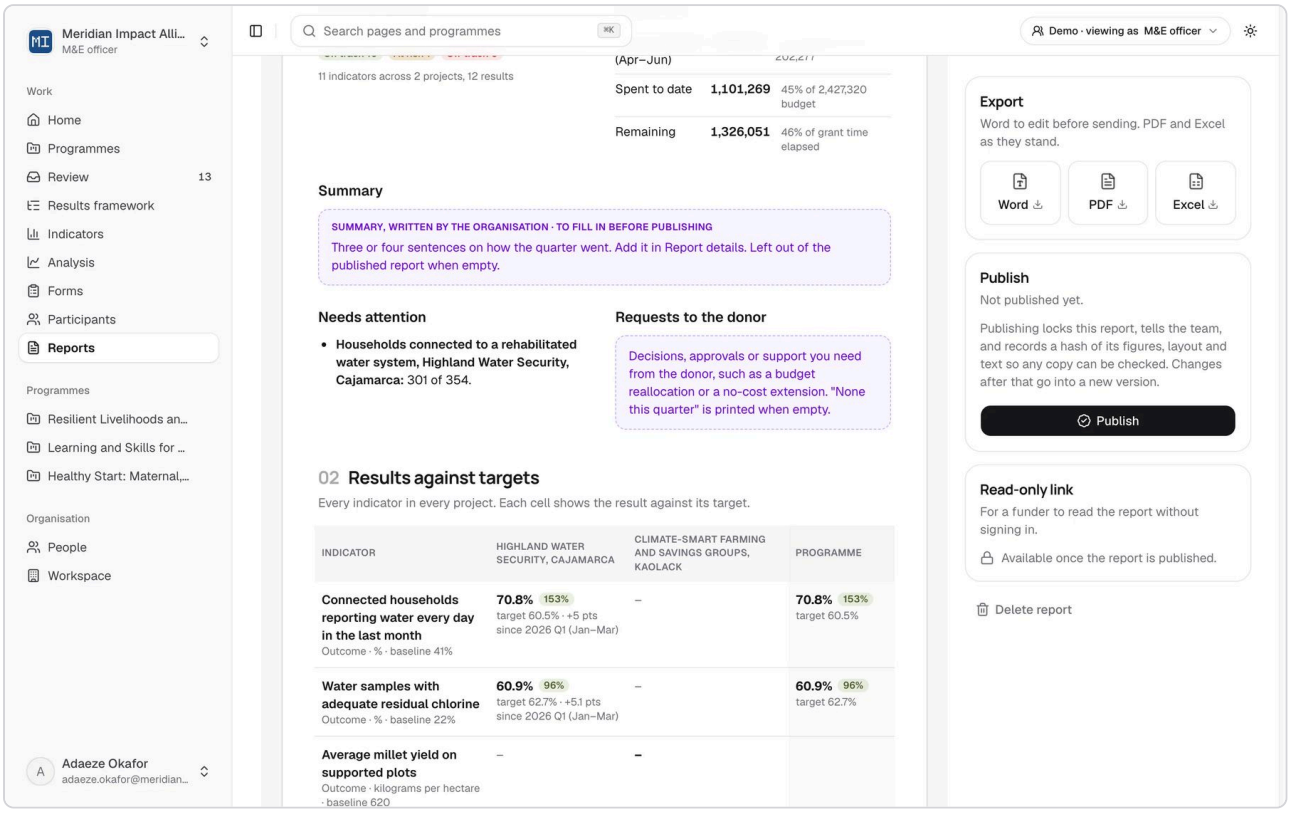


Figure 27.4 Results against targets: indicators by project, with the programme total.

The other report types use the same building blocks and rules.

27.5 Edit a draft

Choose **Edit report**.

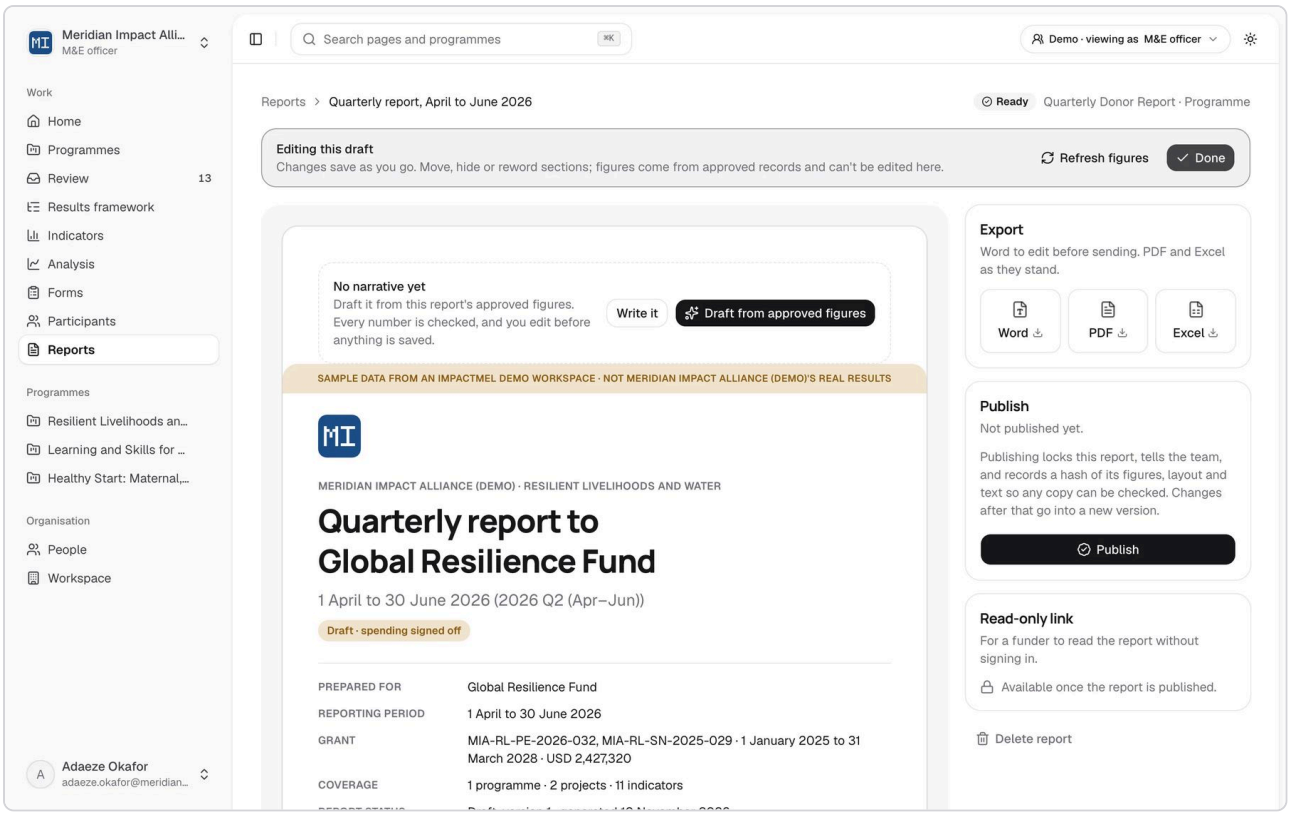


Figure 27.5 Editing a draft report.

- Move sections (drag or use the arrows), reword their headings, or hide them.
- **Add a section**: Challenges, Next steps, Lessons learned, or your own.
- Leave out a single indicator, with an internal reason. Readers see that an indicator is not shown, not the reason.
- Choose which risks to include: those shared with the funder only, or all.
- **Refresh figures** re-reads approved figures and keeps your layout and text.

Figures cannot be typed or changed in a report. To change a figure, correct it through review.

Report details

On a Quarterly Donor Report draft, the **Report details** panel holds the parts only your team can write:

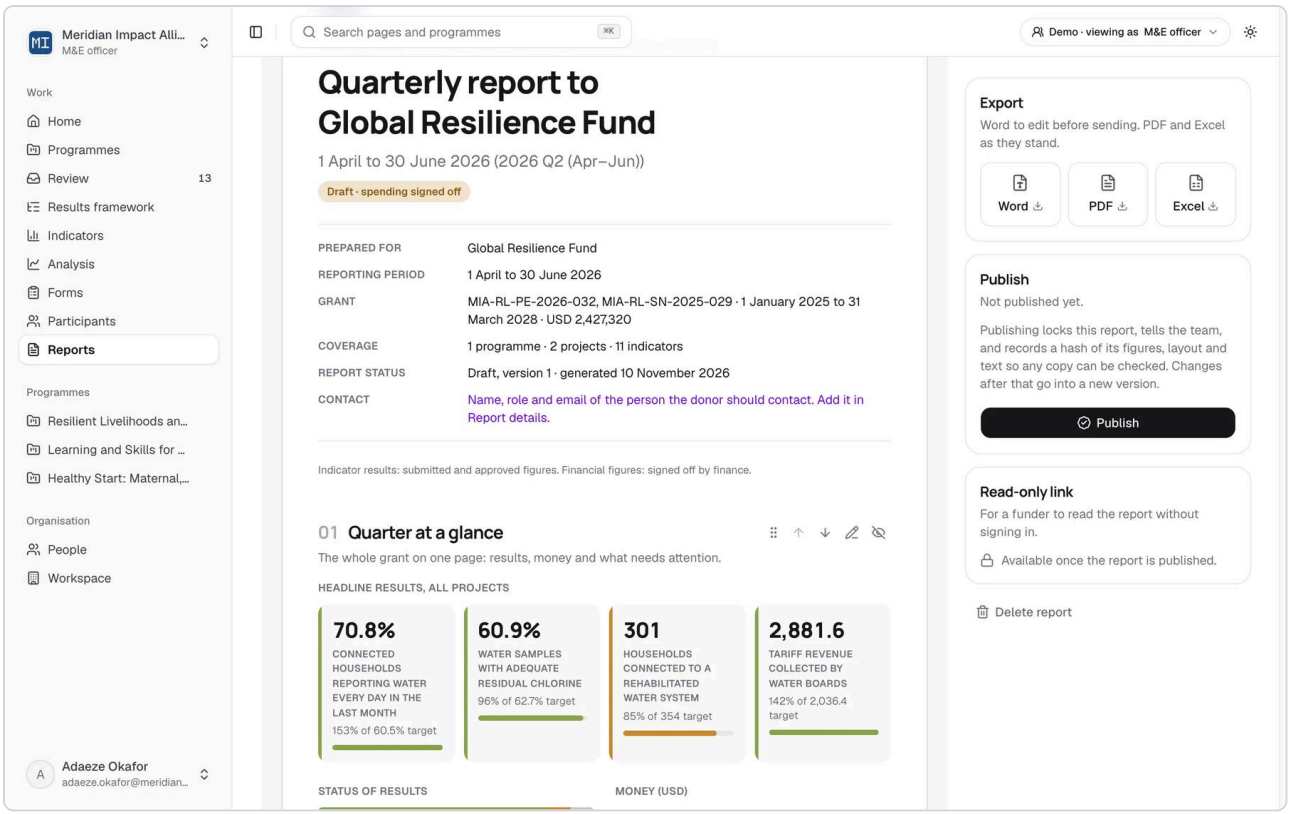


Figure 27.6 The Report details panel.

- **Summary**, three or four sentences on how the quarter went;
- **Requests to the donor**, such as decisions, approvals or a no-cost extension. If empty, the report prints "None this quarter";
- **Contact**, the person the donor should contact;
- **Grant**, taken from the funding agreement unless you type an override;
- **Story of change**, with a direct quote, who said it, and a photo from your evidence;
- **Actions on what needs attention**, each with an owner and due date;
- **Next-quarter target dates.**

Choose **Save details**. Empty fields show as prompts in the draft and are left out when the report is published.

Narrative with AI

If AI features are on, **Draft from approved figures** writes a narrative from the report's approved figures. You can **Accept AI text**, **Edit text** or **Write it** yourself. A report cannot be published while any section is still an AI draft.

27.6 Publish a report

Choose **Publish**. ImpactMEL locks the report, tells the team, and records a SHA-256 fingerprint of its figures, layout and text.

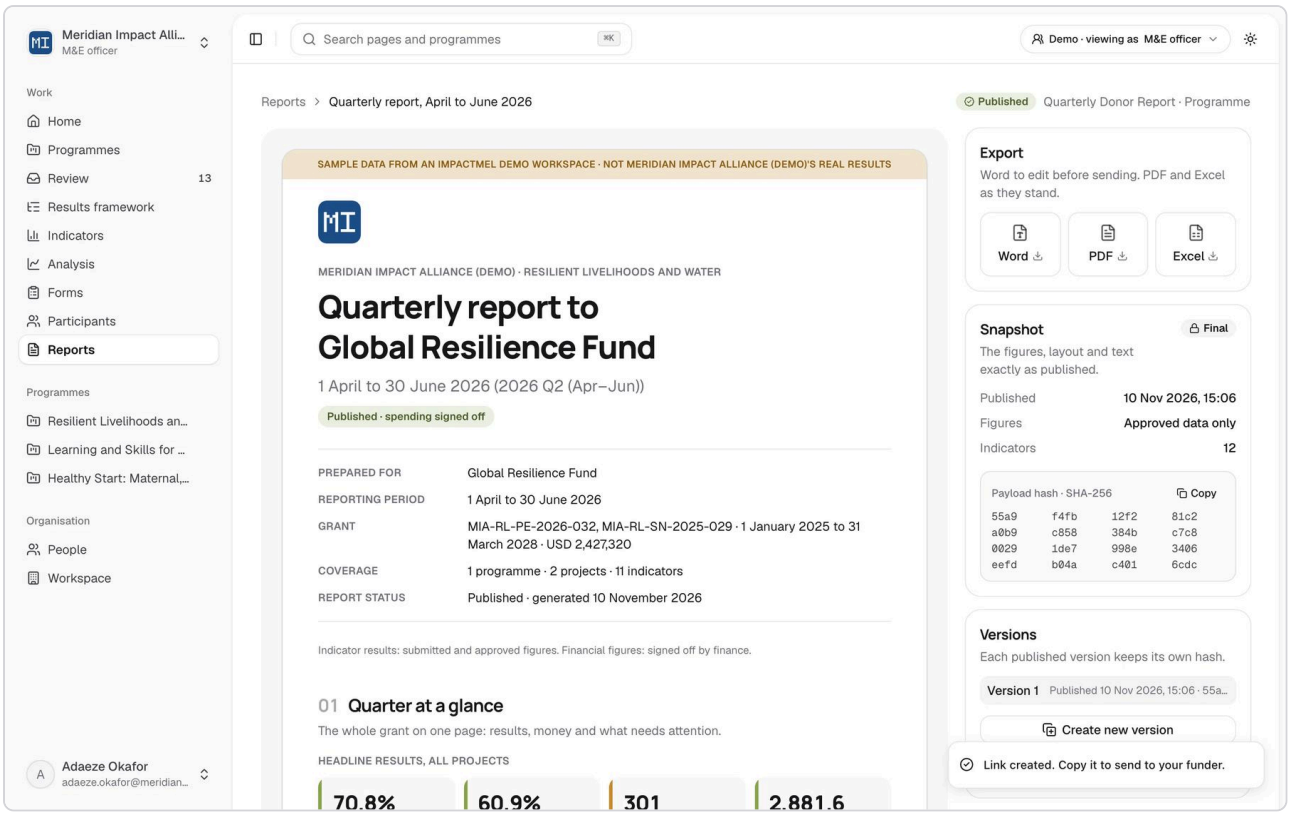


Figure 27.7 A published report, with its snapshot and fingerprint.

- The **Snapshot** card shows the publication date and the payload hash. **Copy** it to quote it.
- To change a published report, choose **Create new version**. Each published version keeps its own fingerprint, listed under **Versions**.
- The **Changes** card shows the report's history.

27.7 Export

Every report downloads as **Word**, **PDF** or **Excel**, with your logo. The Word file keeps the same sections and real headings, so it can be edited. The Excel file has flat sheets for indicators, disaggregation, budget lines, activities and risks.

27.8 Share a report

Once a report is published, you can give a funder a read-only link.

1. Choose **Create a read-only link**, then **Create link**.
2. Copy the link and send it.

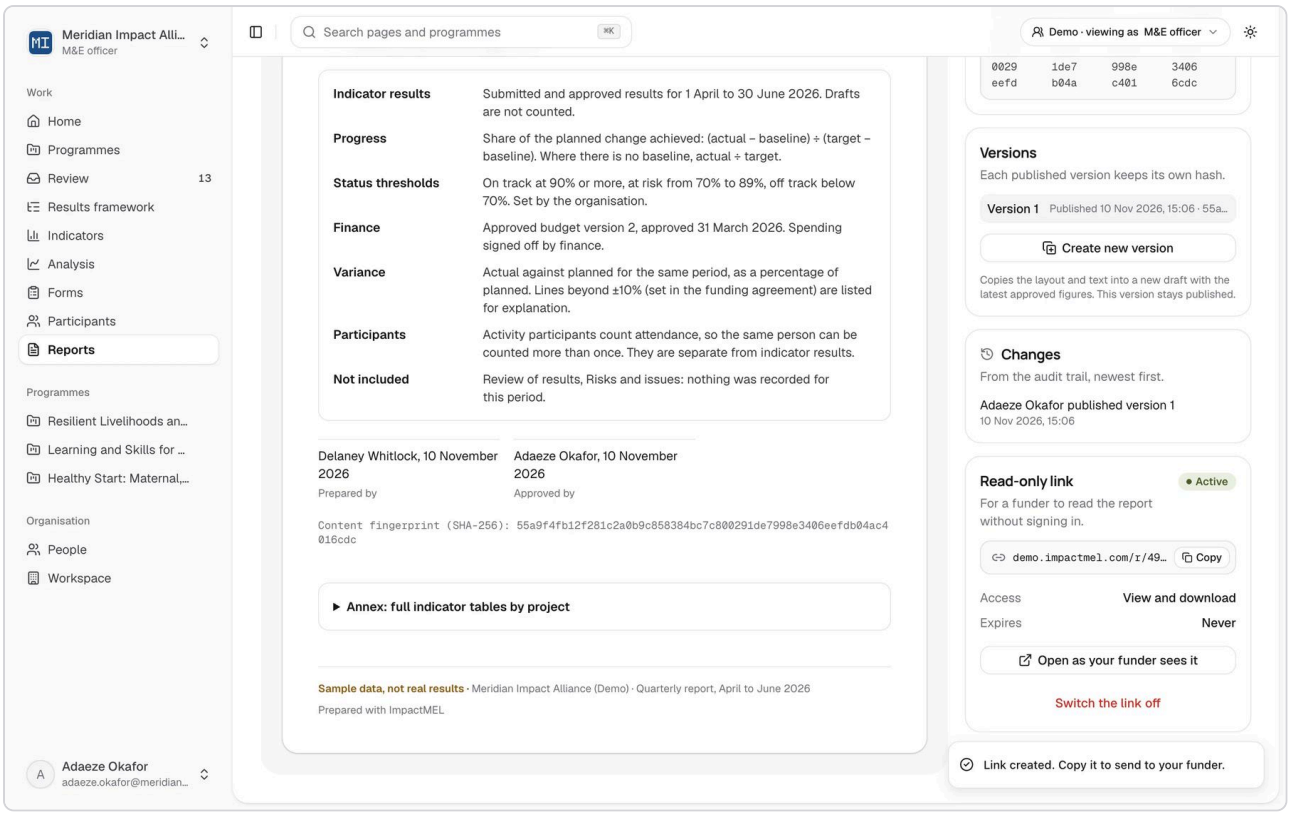


Figure 27.8 The read-only link on a published report.

The link opens the published report with its Word, PDF and Excel downloads, and nothing else in your workspace. It does not show hidden indicators, internal reasons or risks not shared with the funder. The link does not expire. Choose **Switch the link off** to stop it; deleting a report also ends its link.

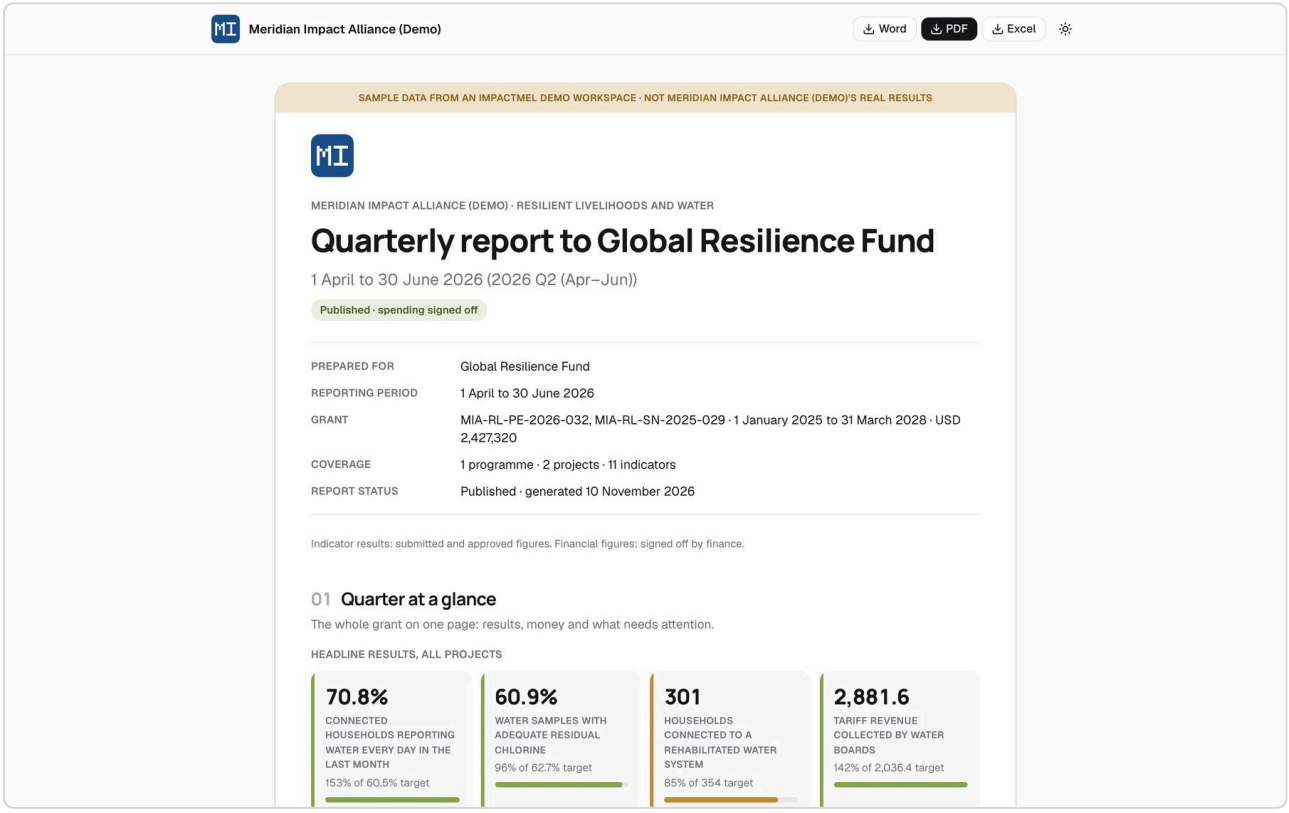


Figure 27.9 A shared report as the funder sees it.

28 Funder workspace

Funders who support several organisations can have their own ImpactMEL workspace. They ask grantees for results, and grantees choose what to share. Funders see only what has been shared, in a locked copy.

Funder workspaces are set up by ImpactMEL on request. Contact inquiries@impactmel.com.

28.1 Funder roles

Funder admin, M&E lead, Programme officer and Board viewer. The menu has four pages: **Portfolio**, **Grantees**, **Requests** and **Reports**.

28.2 Portfolio

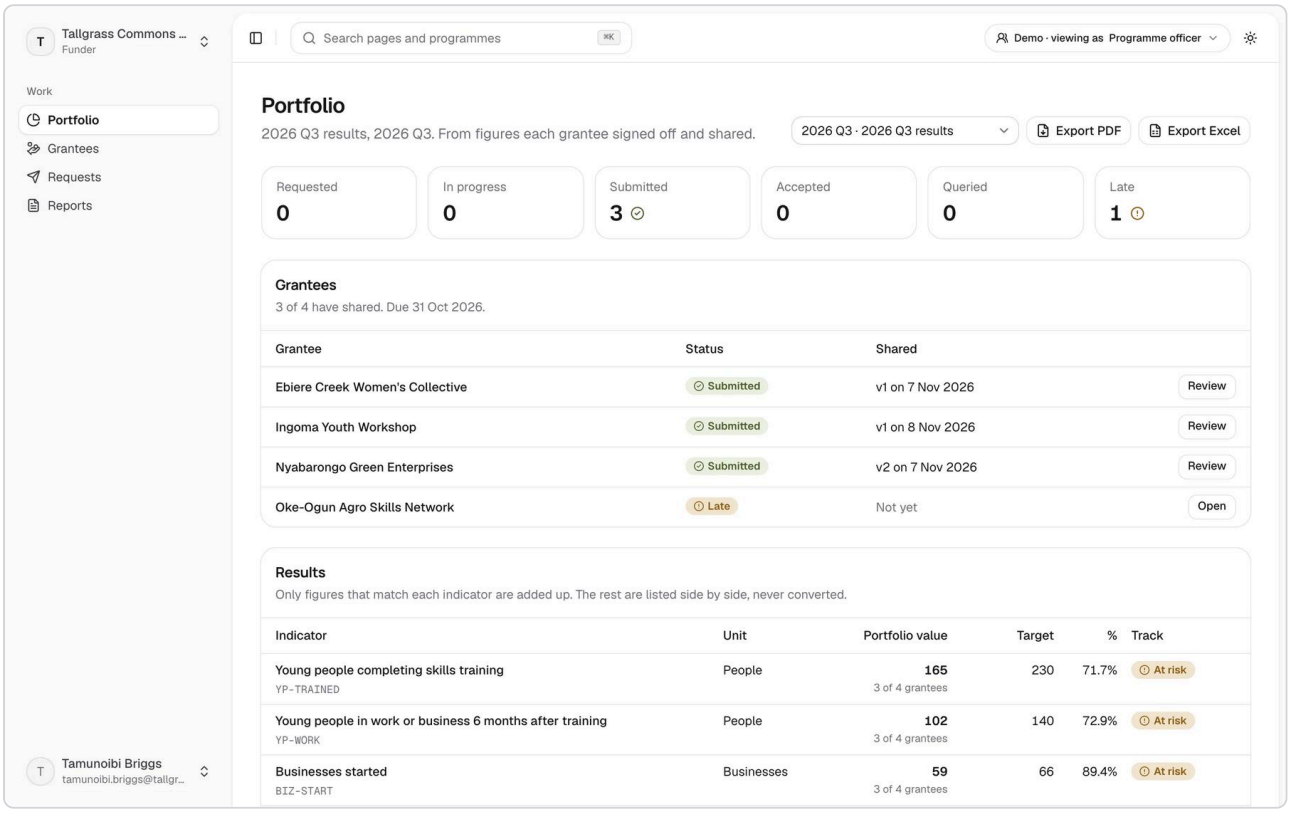


Figure 28.1 The funder portfolio.

Choose a request to see where every grantee stands: requested, in progress, submitted, accepted, queried and late. **Results** adds figures up only where the indicator units match; the rest are listed side by side. The portfolio also lists flagged risks and what grantees said in their own words. **Export PDF** and **Export Excel** produce a board pack with a fingerprint.

28.3 Grantees

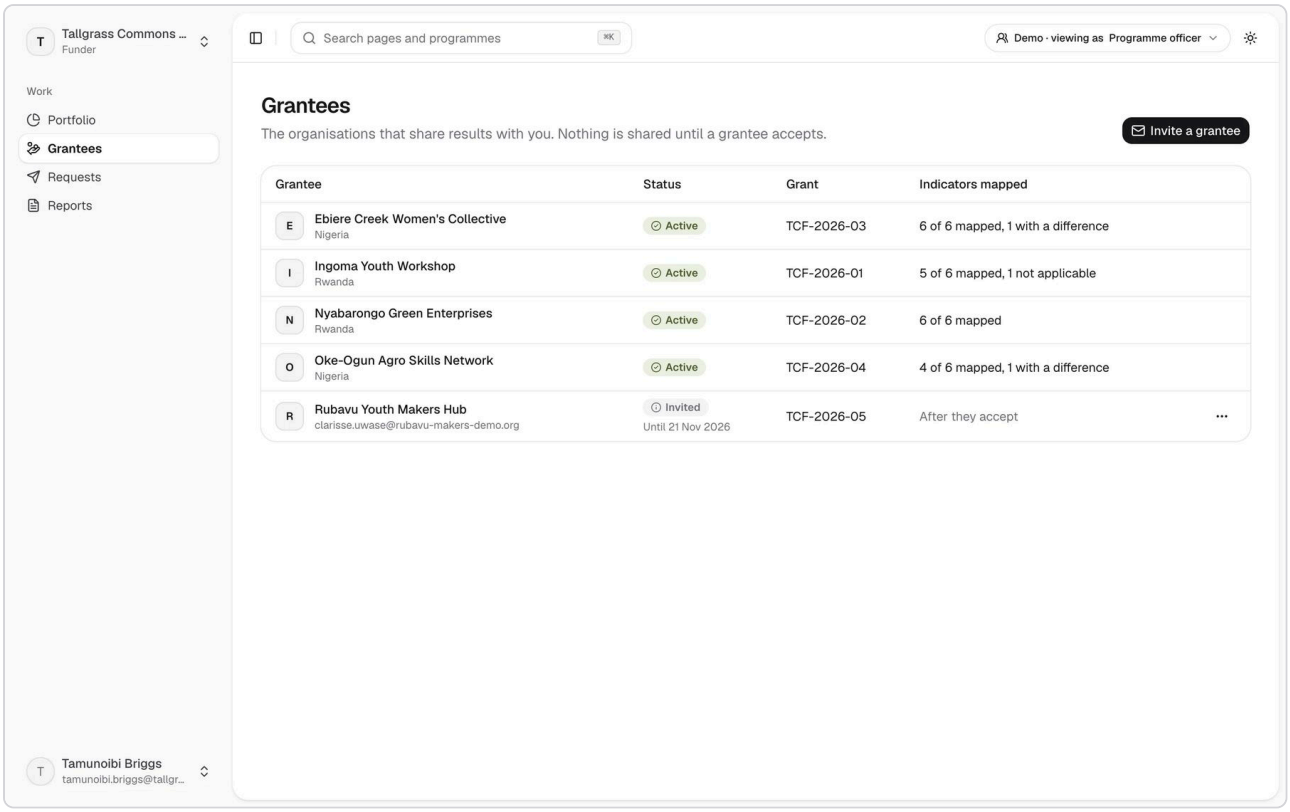


Figure 28.2 Grantees and the indicators each one has mapped.

Invite a grantee with the organisation, email, grant reference, grant dates and a message. The invitation lasts 14 days. Each grantee page shows how their indicators map to yours, what they have submitted, and what each side has viewed. **End link** stops the sharing.

28.4 Requests and common indicators

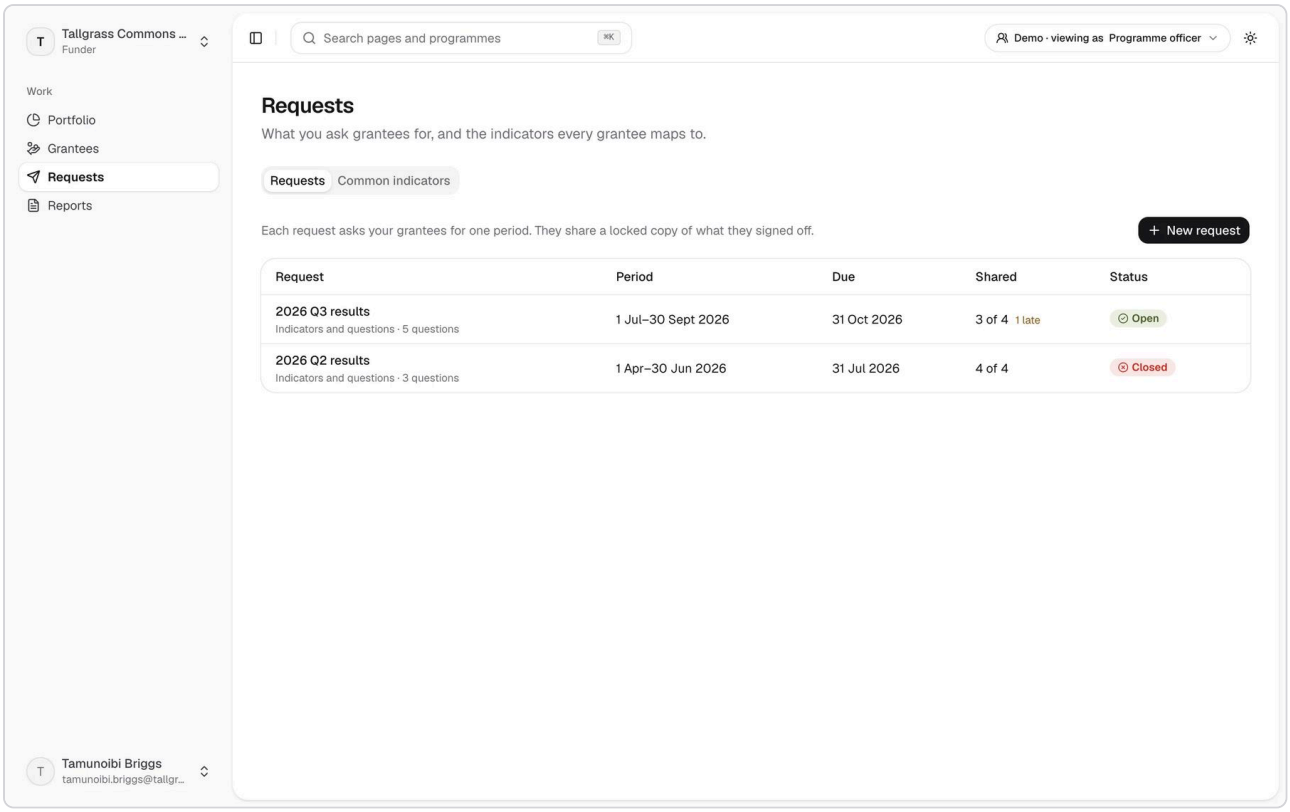


Figure 28.3 Requests sent to grantees.

- **Common indicators** are the indicators the funder wants every grantee to answer.
- **New request** asks grantees for one period: indicators and questions, or a light check-in. Start from a donor template, add up to eight questions, optionally ask for risks and a financial summary, choose the grantees and a due date.
- On a request, **Remind** grantees who have not shared. On a submission, **Accept** it or send a question.

28.5 The grantee side

When a funder invites your organisation, an administrator reads the data-sharing agreement and accepts or declines.

- In **Workspace**, **Funders you share with** shows each funder, the programmes in scope, and how your indicators answer theirs: "One of ours answers it" or "It doesn't apply to our work". Small counts are hidden. You can see what the funder viewed, and end the link.
- Requests arrive under **Reports**, in the **Funder requests** tab. Each request shows what is asked, your answers (saved as you type), a preview, questions and replies, and the versions you have shared.
- You share from the sign-off of a locked period, in four steps: what is included, answers, a time check and confirm. The funder receives a locked copy with a fingerprint.

PART

Connect and administer

29 Integrations

ImpactMEL brings figures in from KoboToolbox, DHIS2 and spreadsheets, and sends approved figures back to DHIS2. Everything imported arrives as a draft for review; nothing goes straight into reports.

Who can do this: Organisation admins and M&E officers by default. Open **Integrations** in the sidebar, or **Import from Kobo or DHIS2** on the Forms page.

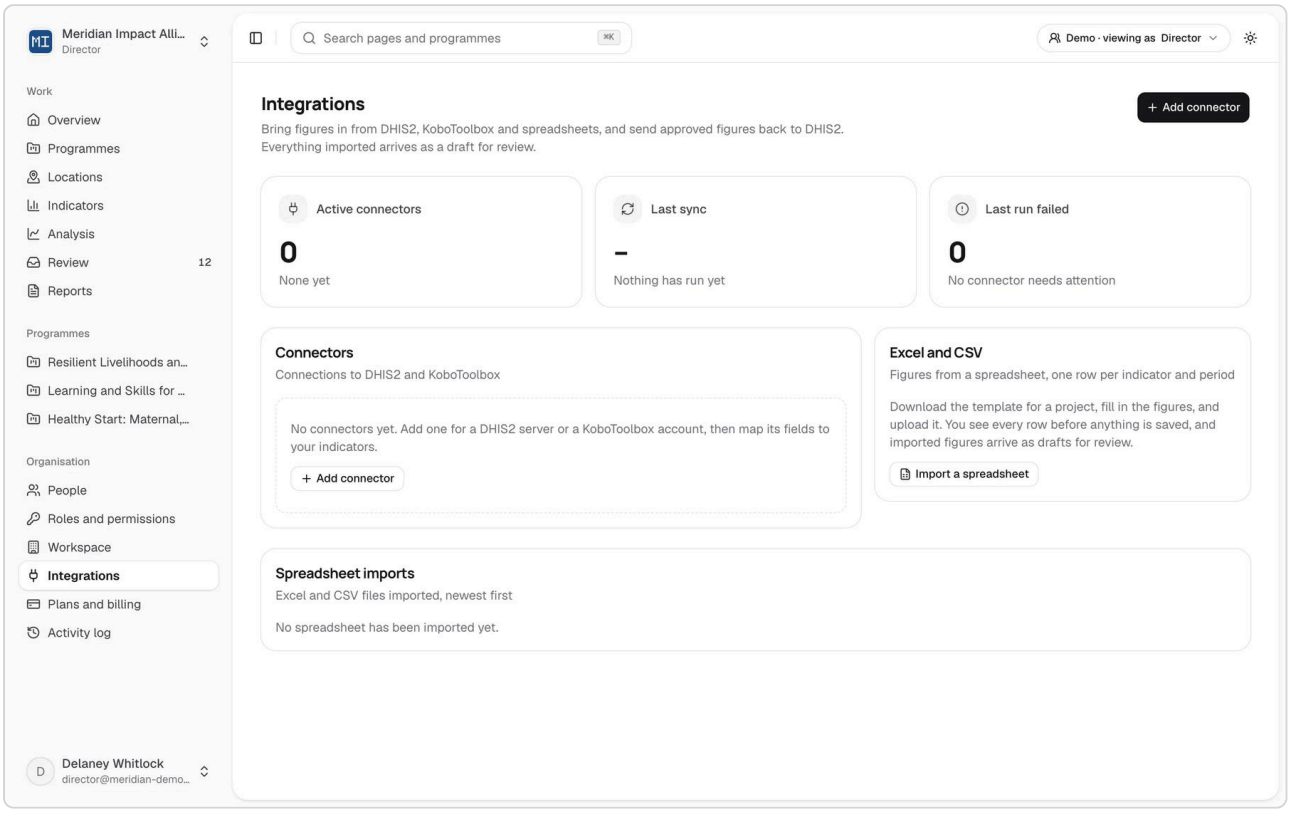


Figure 29.1 The Integrations page.

29.1 Add a connector

Choose **Add connector**, then **DHIS2** or **KoboToolbox**.

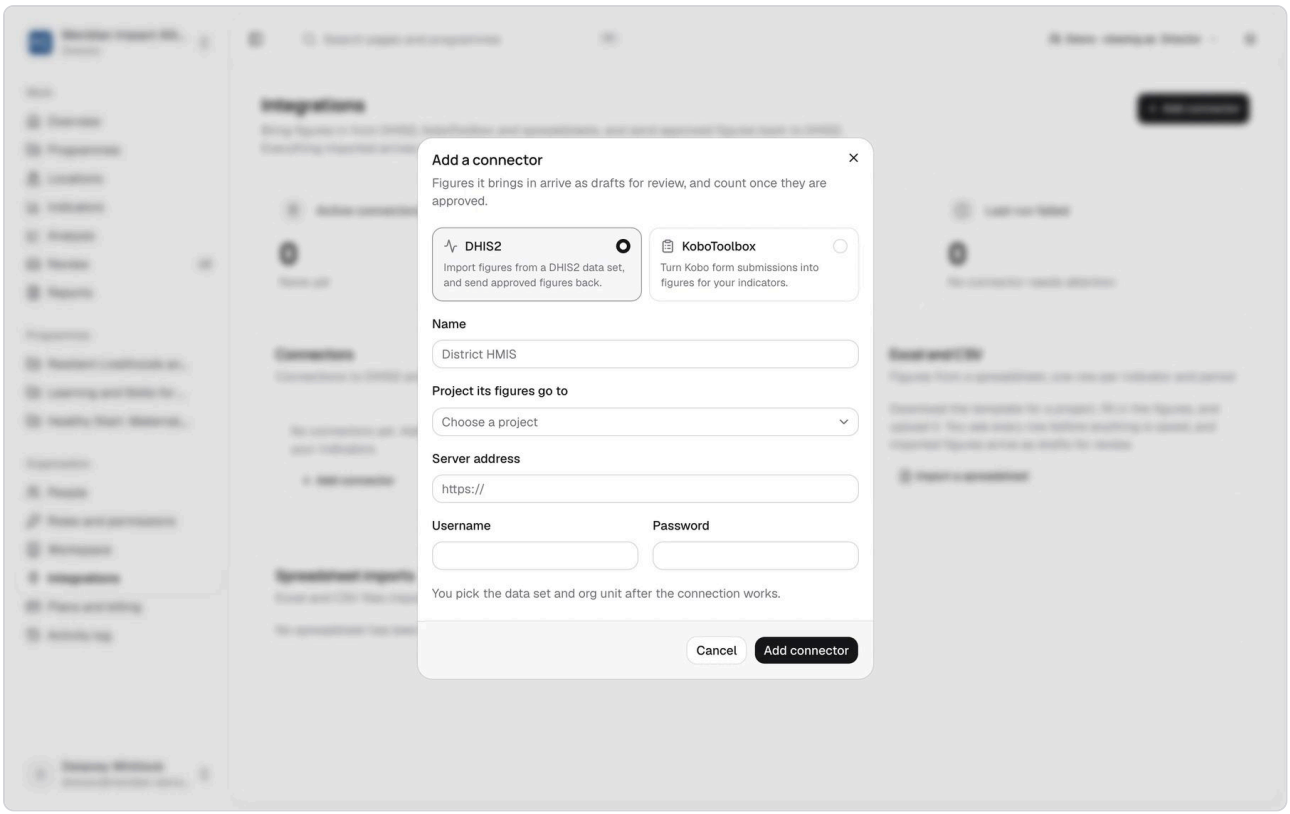


Figure 29.2 Adding a connector.

Enter a name, the project its figures go to, and the server address (https only).

- **DHIS2:** a DHIS2 username and password. The password is stored encrypted.
- **KoboToolbox:** your API token (in KoboToolbox, Account settings, then Security, then API key) and the server: Global, EU, or another server.

On the connector page, choose **Test connection**. Under **Runs**, choose whether it runs only when someone runs it, every day or every week. Scheduled runs only import. The **Run log** keeps every run.

29.2 KoboToolbox

Set up the connector in four steps:

1. Choose the Kobo form.
2. Map questions to indicators, and choose how each is counted: add up the answers, count submissions that answered, or count submissions that chose an option.
3. Map answers to breakdowns.
4. Choose the reporting period.

Choose **Import submissions**. Kobo submissions become draft figures in Review, under **Not sent**. Submissions marked Not approved in Kobo are skipped by default. **Copy as an ImpactMEL form** creates a draft form from the Kobo form and lists any questions it could not copy.

29.3 DHIS2

Set up the connector in three steps:

1. Choose the data set and organisation unit.
2. Map data elements to indicators. ImpactMEL warns when units do not match, for example a count against a percentage.
3. Map category option combinations to breakdowns.

- **Import:** tick the DHIS2 periods to bring in. Monthly DHIS2 data goes into the matching ImpactMEL period, such as a quarter. Figures already imported are not added twice.
- **Export:** sends approved or locked figures only. **Check only** runs a test without sending.

29.4 Excel and CSV

Choose **Import a spreadsheet** on the Integrations page, or **Import figures** on the Indicators page.

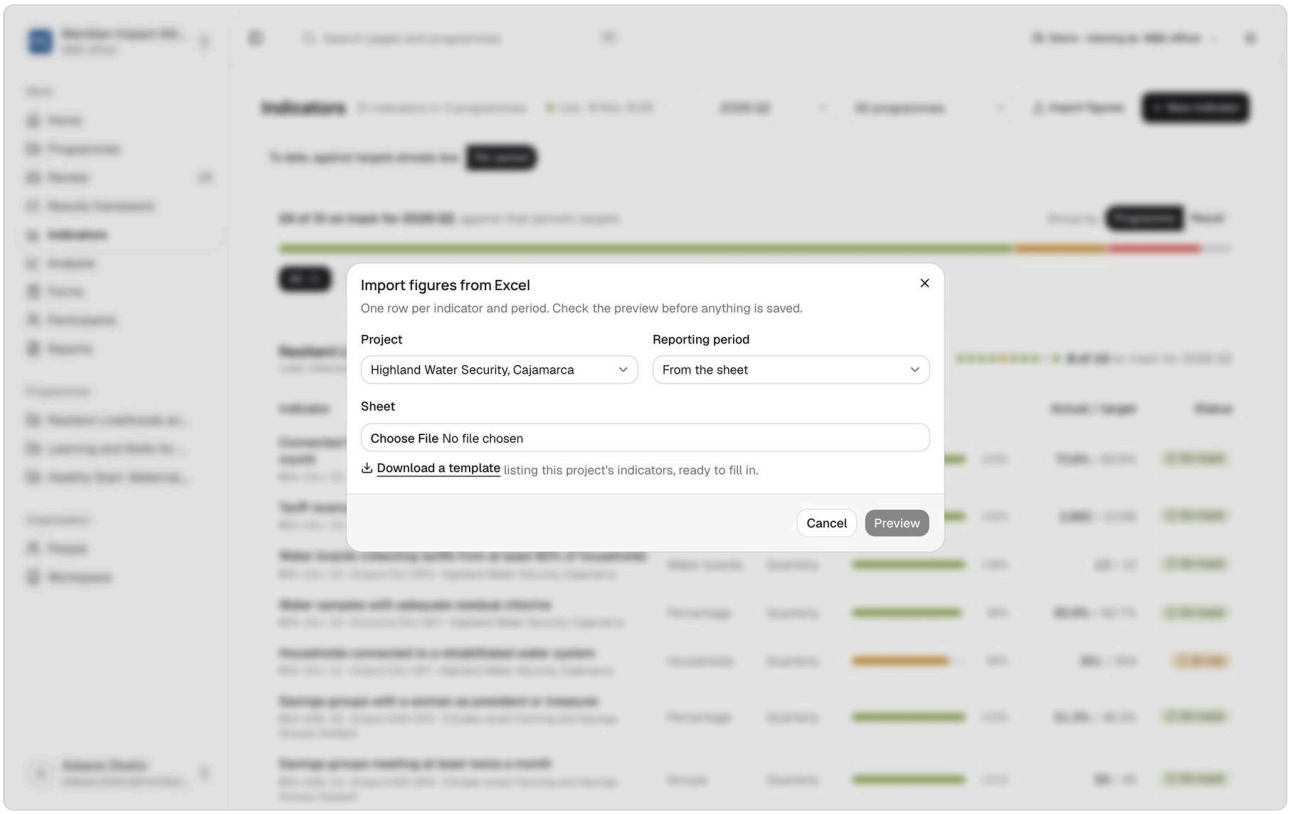


Figure 29.3 Importing figures from Excel.

1. Choose the project and reporting period, or let the sheet say.
2. **Download a template** listing the project's indicators, ready to fill.
3. Upload the sheet (.xlsx, .xls or .csv).
4. Check the preview. Each row is marked New, Update, Unchanged, Skipped or Error.
5. Confirm.

Send the imported figures for review is ticked by default, so the figures go to the review queue. Untick it to keep them as drafts. Either way, they count only once approved. Past imports are listed under **Spreadsheet imports**.

Participants and spending have their own imports. See Participants and Budgets.

30 AI features

ImpactMEL's AI assistant helps with drafting. It works from your own data, marks what it writes as a draft, and never changes a figure. A person always checks and accepts its work, and an administrator can switch it off for the whole workspace.

30.1 What it does

Feature	Where	What you get
Draft a form	Forms, **New form**, **Describe it**; **Ask AI** in the builder	Questions and skip logic from a plain description. Nothing is created until you accept
Draft a framework	Results framework, **Draft from a proposal**	Results and indicators from a proposal or concept note, each with its source sentence. You accept each one
Explain checks	Review, **Explain with AI**	A short explanation of the data-quality checks on a figure, with questions to ask the sender
Report narrative	Reports, **Draft from approved figures**	A narrative from the report's approved figures
Recommended dashboards	Analysis, **Recommended for you**	Ready-made dashboards from your approved figures

30.2 The rules it follows

- **Your data only.** It works from what is in your workspace or the document you upload. Uploaded documents are not stored.
- **Drafts, not facts.** AI text is labelled as a draft. A report cannot be published while any section is still an AI draft.
- **No invented numbers.** Explanations and narratives may quote only figures that exist in the submission or report. Sentences with other numbers are removed.
- **Questions, not guesses.** Where a proposal is unclear, the question is saved for your team to confirm.
- **Figures are never changed.** AI cannot enter, edit or approve figures.

There is a daily limit on AI use for each organisation, which resets at midnight UTC.

30.3 Switch AI off

An Organisation admin can switch every AI feature off for everyone.

1. Open **Workspace**.
2. Under **AI assistant**, turn the switch off.

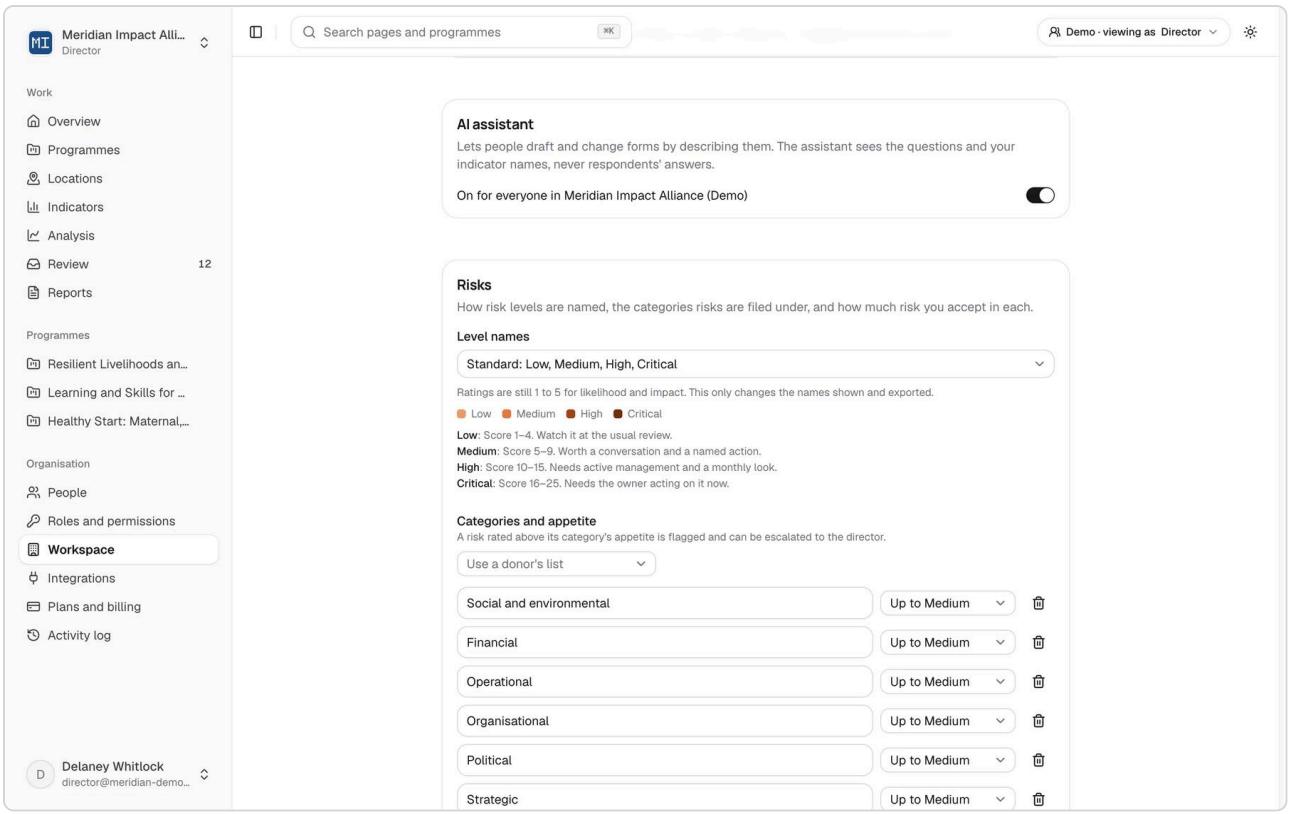


Figure 30.1 The AI assistant switch in Workspace settings.

When AI is off, the AI buttons disappear for everyone in the workspace, and the server refuses AI requests. The change is recorded in the activity log. Turn it on again the same way.

31 Administration

Administration covers who is in the workspace, what each person can do, how the workspace is set up, what has changed, and how it is paid for.

Who can do this: Organisation admins. Other roles see the workspace pages their permissions open, in the **Organisation** group of the sidebar.

31.1 People

Open **People**.

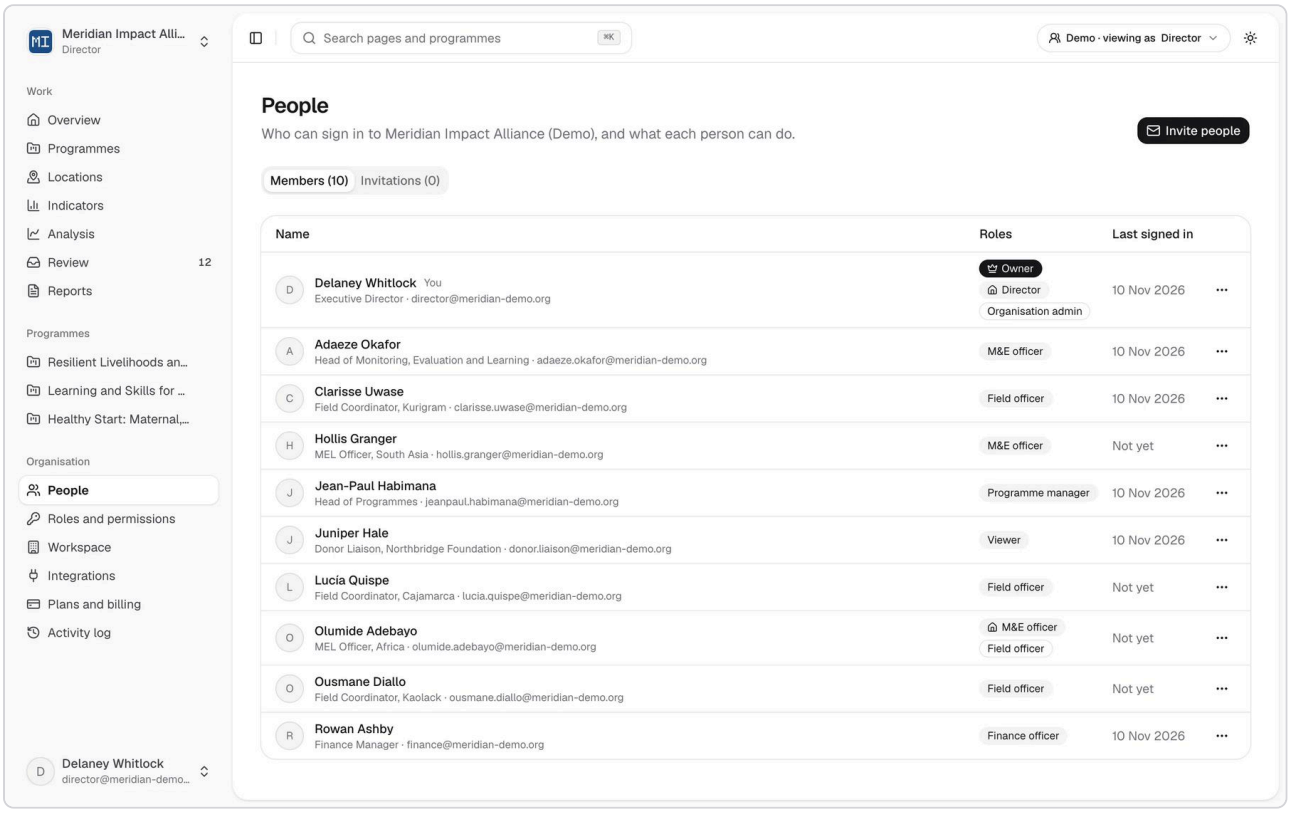


Figure 31.1 The People page.

The **Members** tab lists everyone with their roles and when they last signed in. **Invite people** sends invitations; see Invite your team. From a member's **...** menu:

- **Change roles.** Tick the roles they hold and choose which one their home **opens on**.
- **Make owner.** Transfers ownership. Type "transfer" to confirm. Only the owner can do this.
- **Remove from workspace.** Removes their access. Their past work and history stay.

31.2 Roles and permissions

Open **Roles and permissions**.

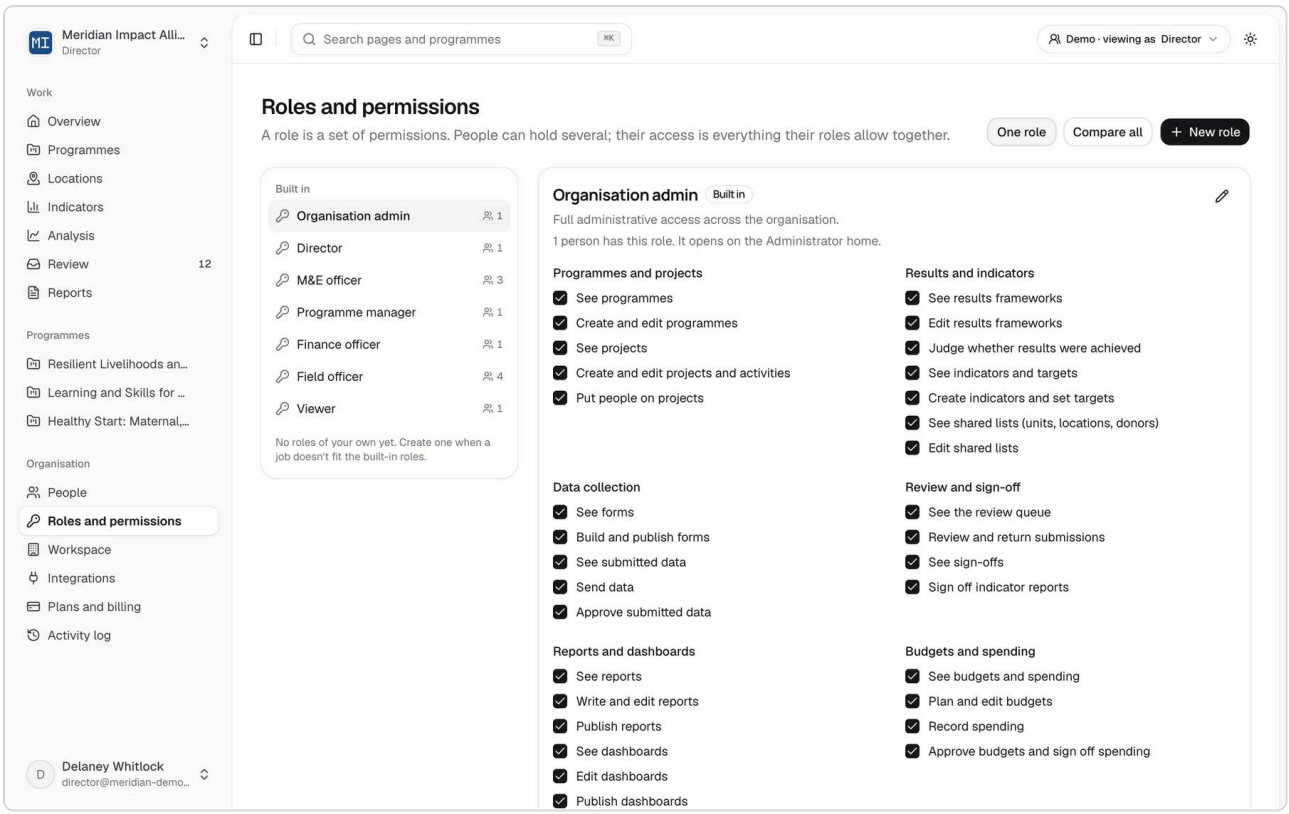


Figure 31.2 Roles and permissions.

- **One role** shows a role's permissions, grouped by area. **Compare all** shows every role side by side.
- Tick or untick permissions to change a role. Built-in roles can be changed, and **Reset to defaults** restores them.
- **New role** creates a role, starting from an existing one. **Rename** and **Delete role** manage your own roles.

Permission groups: Programmes and projects, Results and indicators, Data collection, Review and sign-off, Reports and dashboards, Budgets and spending, Risks, Funders, Integrations, People and access, Workspace, and Records.

Only owners can grant Organisation admin. Anyone else can only give access they already have, and cannot edit a role they hold.

31.3 Workspace settings

Open **Workspace**.

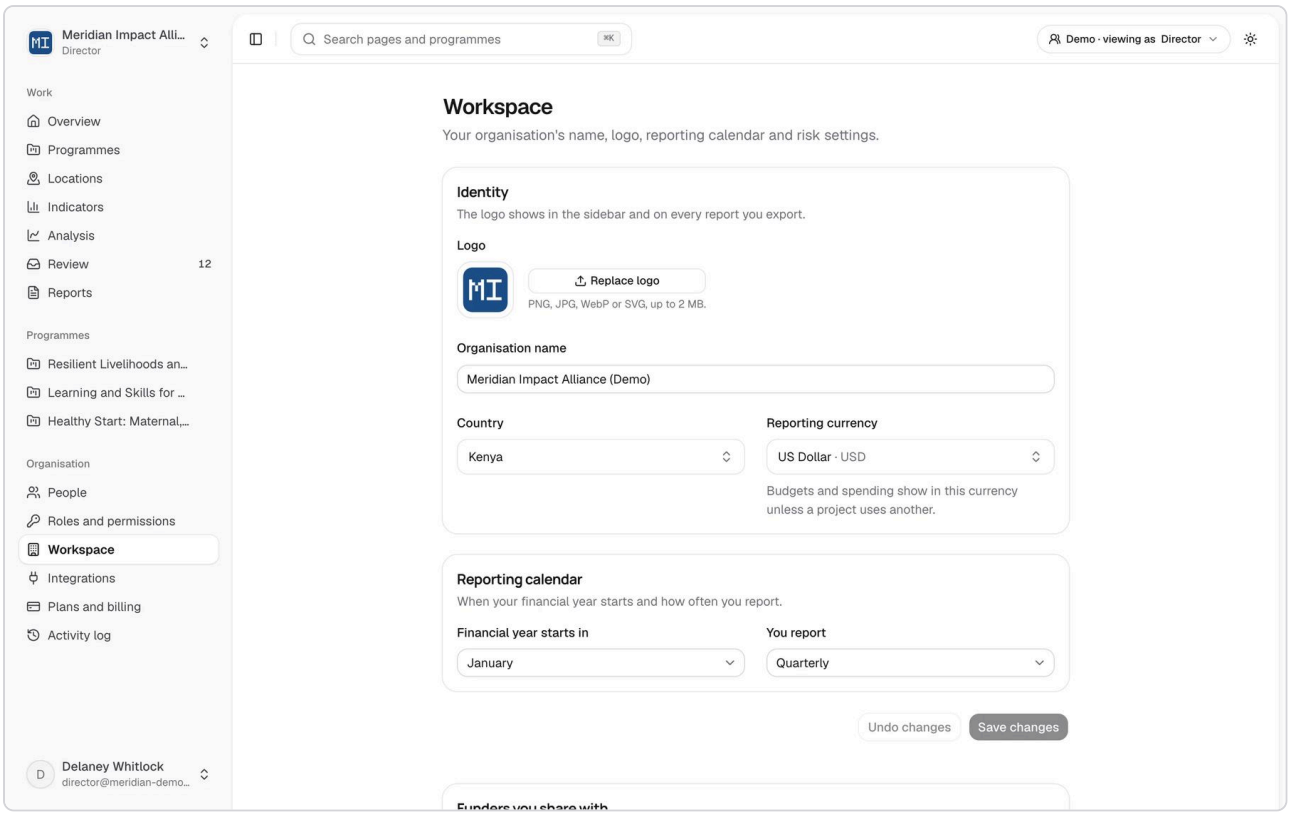


Figure 31.3 Workspace settings.

- **Identity:** logo, organisation name, country and reporting currency. The logo shows in the sidebar, on every exported report and on public pages.
- **Reporting calendar:** when your financial year starts and how often you report. See Reporting periods.
- **Funders you share with.** See Funder workspace.
- **AI assistant:** on or off for everyone. See AI features.
- **Risks:** level names, categories and appetite. See Risks.

31.4 Activity log

Open **Activity log** to see who did what, and when, newest first.

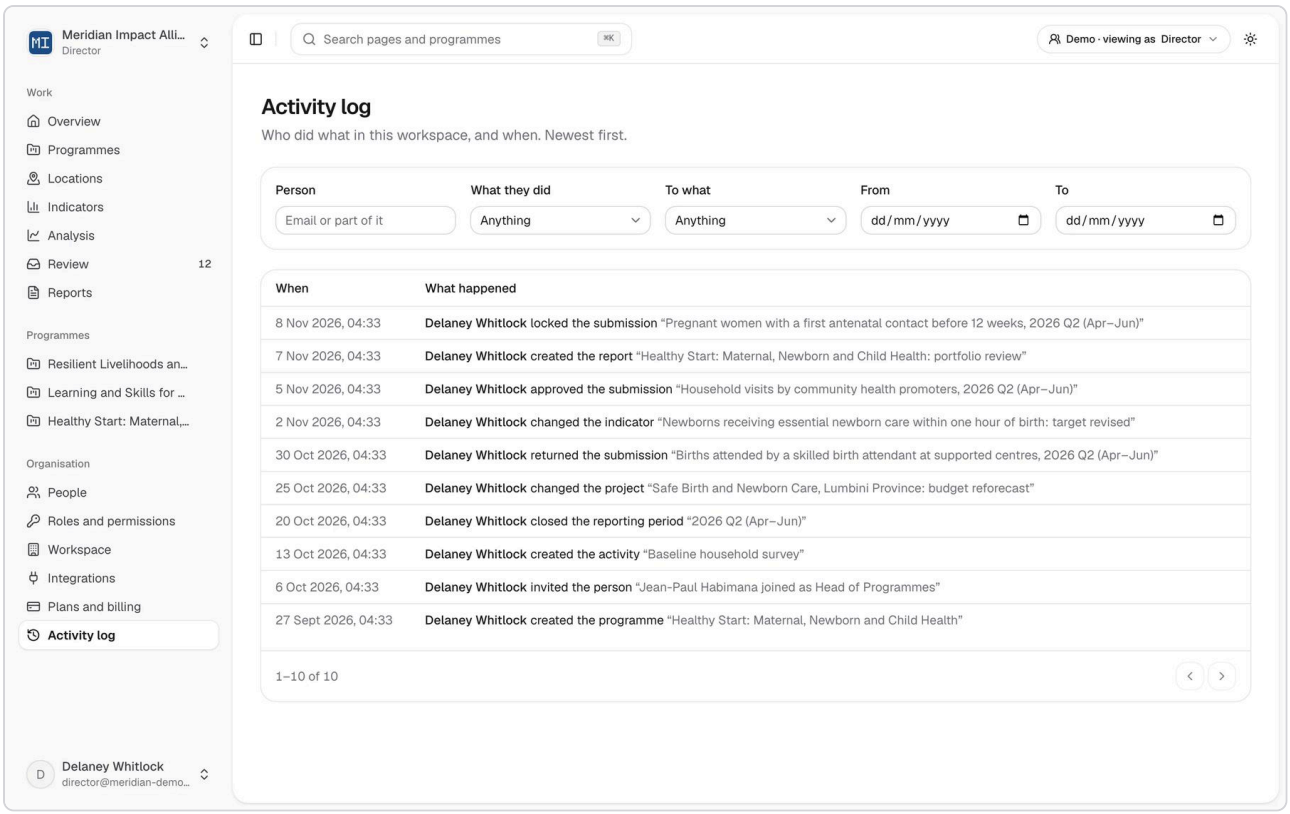


Figure 31.4 The activity log.

Filter by person, what they did, what it was done to, and dates. The log records changes to people and roles, figures sent, approved and returned, periods closed and locked, reports created and published, and more. Each change keeps the value before it.

31.5 Sign-in and security

Open **Sign-in and security** from the sidebar or the user menu.

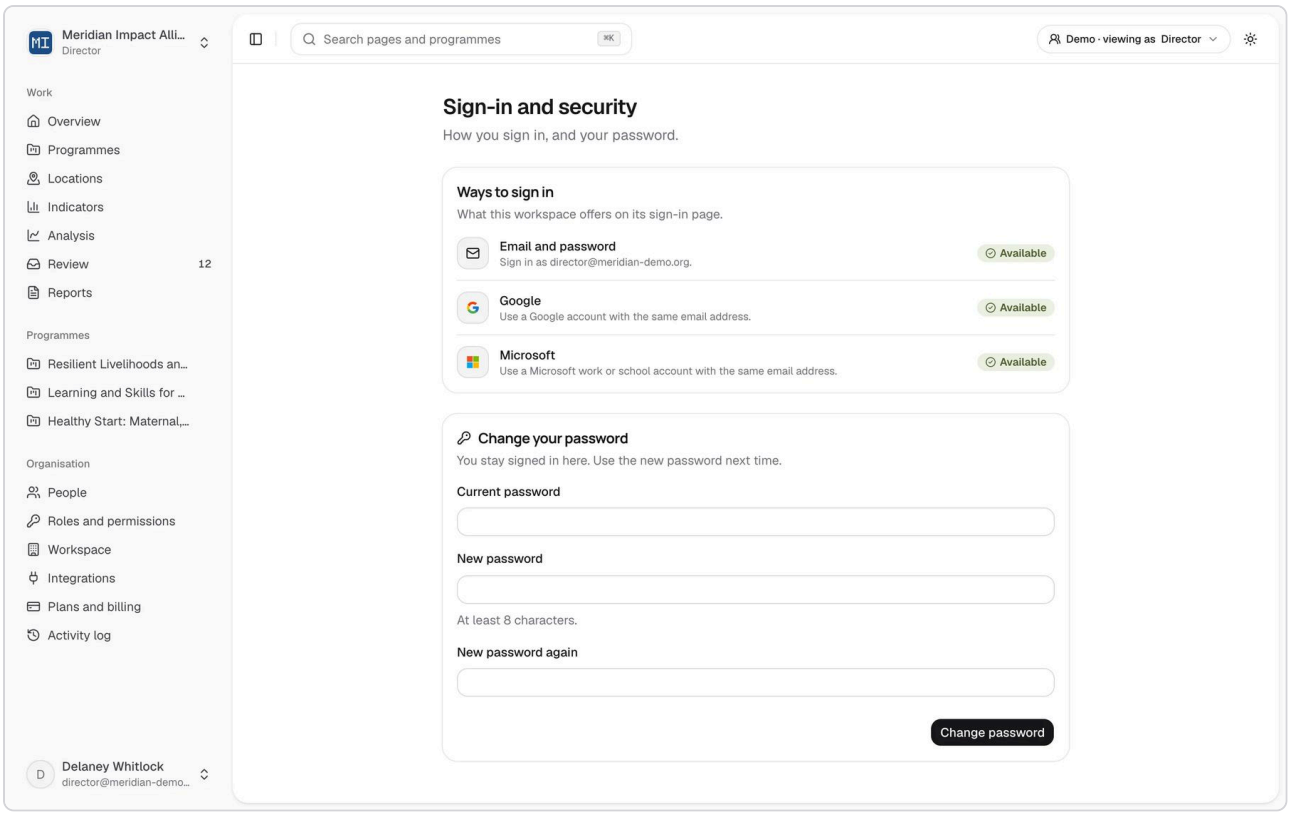


Figure 31.5 Sign-in and security.

It shows which sign-in methods your workspace offers (email and password, Google, Microsoft), and lets you change your password.

31.6 Plans and billing

Open **Plans and billing**.

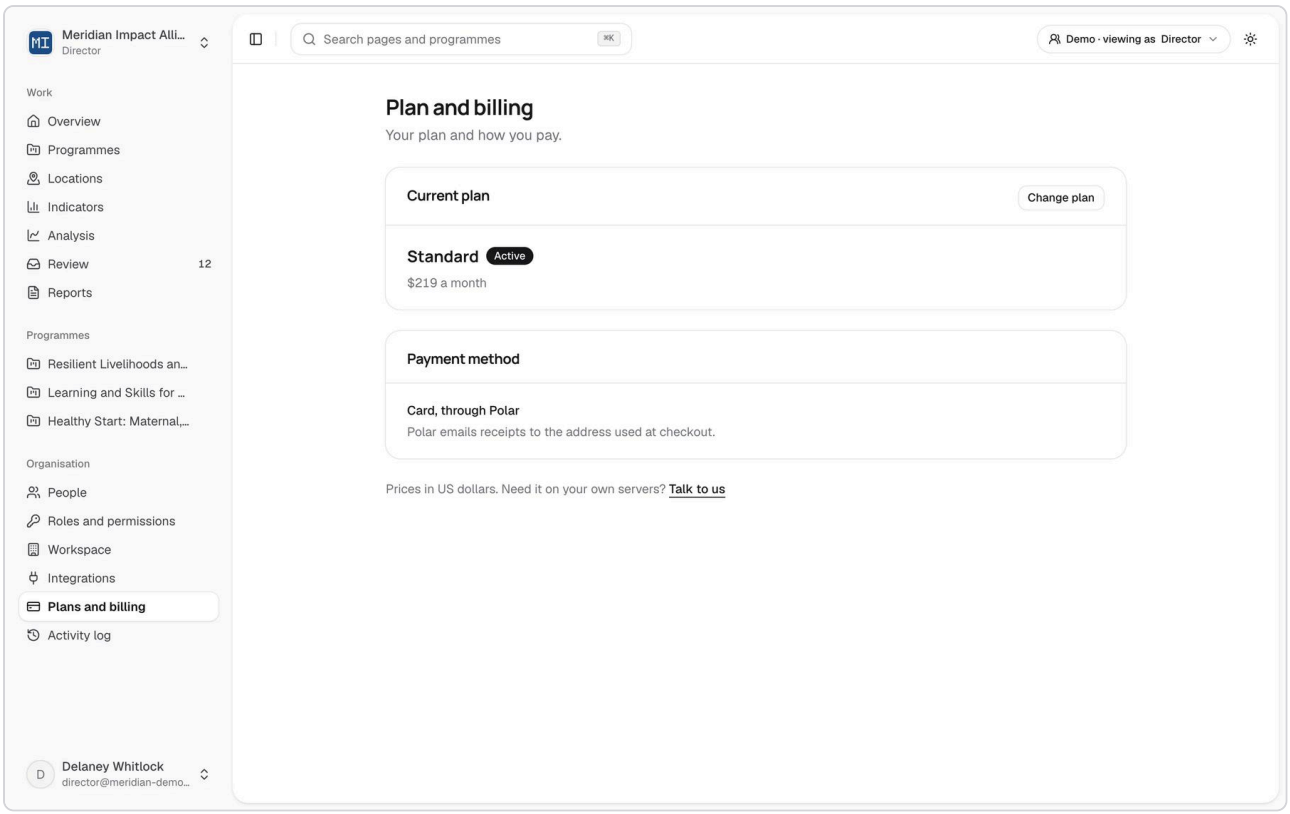


Figure 31.6 Plans and billing.

- **Current plan** shows your plan, its status (Trial, Invoice requested, Active, Payment overdue, Cancelled, or Paid by your funder) and when a trial ends.
- **Change plan** or **Choose a plan** to move between Individual, Standard and Custom.
- **Pay by card** opens checkout with Polar, which emails receipts. **Request an invoice** asks for an invoice instead.

Prices are on the pricing page. See Plans.

31.7 Your profile

Open **Your profile** from the user menu to change your photo, name and job title, see your roles, and choose between the new and classic interface.

PART

Reference

32 Security and data

This page summarises the controls in place today, as published in the ImpactMEL trust centre. For the full detail, and for questions from your IT reviewer, see the security overview and hosting and residency pages.

32.1 Certification

ImpactMEL is not yet certified against SOC 2 or ISO 27001. The controls below are in place today, and each can be shown in a session with your IT reviewer present.

32.2 Controls in place

- **Separation.** Each organisation has its own address and sign-in, and every request is limited to its own data. Contracted and self-hosted organisations run in a dedicated instance with their own database, storage and backups.
- **HTTPS everywhere.**
- **Backups.** Automated backups, with an off-site copy.
- **Server access** by SSH key only, never passwords.
- **Sign-in.** Email and password with address verification, optional Google sign-in, and rate limiting on sign-in attempts. External collaborators are invited as users, so every action has a person behind it.
- **Role-based access** built from permission sets, with viewers narrowed to the projects they are assigned. See Roles.
- **Audit trail.** Each audit event records who acted, on what, the action, and the full state before and after the change. Access logs record views as well as edits.
- **Sharing that can be withdrawn.** Read-only links can be revoked, and dashboard links expire. See Sharing dashboards and Reports.
- **Published reports carry a payload hash**, so a figure quoted to a donor can be reproduced exactly as it stood on the day it was published.

32.3 Your data

- **Ownership.** Your organisation owns its data, in the managed cloud and on your own infrastructure alike.
- **Export.** Your data can be exported at any time. Export is a permission that can be granted separately from viewing.
- **GDPR.** ImpactMEL is GDPR compliant and has an appointed Data Protection Officer. Write to inquiries@impactmel.com to reach them.

32.4 Where your data sits

ImpactMEL runs in two ways:

- **Managed cloud.** We run the infrastructure and apply updates. Each organisation runs in its own isolated instance, served over HTTPS, with automated backups and an off-site copy.
- **On your own servers.** The application runs inside your own infrastructure and the database never leaves it. Use this where residency is written into your funding agreement or national policy.

The application, roles, audit trail and sign-in controls are the same in both. See hosting and residency.

32.5 AI and your data

AI features work from your workspace's own data and are optional. An administrator can switch them off. See AI features.

33 Plans

ImpactMEL is priced by where it runs and whether you want it customised. The pricing page is the source of truth for plans and prices; this page explains how plans work in the product.

33.1 Cloud plans

Plan	For	Customisation
Individual	M&E consultants and officers who report on their own work	None
Standard	An organisation that wants the full platform as it is and to start straight away	None, the product as it is
Custom	An organisation that wants ImpactMEL set up around how it already works	Your framework, forms, reports and workflows, configured and set up with us

Every cloud plan includes results frameworks, forms, approvals, evidence, dashboards, and PDF, Word and Excel reports. Standard and Custom run the same platform. There is no charge per project, indicator, record, participant or file.

Cloud plans can be paid monthly or yearly, by card or, except on Individual, by invoice. Every cloud plan can start with a 30-day free trial.

33.2 On your own servers

Organisation-hosted plans run ImpactMEL on your infrastructure, with training, documentation and support. They start with a conversation. See the pricing page or write to inquiries@impactmel.com.

33.3 In the product

- Choose your plan when you sign up.
- Change plan or payment method in Plans and billing.
- An Individual workspace is one person holding every role, with nothing missing.

34 Frequently asked questions

34.1 Getting started

Is there a free plan?

No. Every cloud plan can start with a 30-day free trial, without a card. See Plans.

How long does it take to set up?

Creating a workspace takes a few minutes. Setting up a programme, its framework, indicators and targets depends on how much you have ready. On the Custom plan, we set it up with you.

Can we bring our existing logframe?

Yes. Build it in the results framework, or, if AI features are on, upload your proposal or logframe document and choose **Draft from a proposal**.

Can we import figures we already have?

Yes. Import figures from Excel or CSV, and participants from CSV or Excel. See Integrations.

34.2 Using ImpactMEL

Why doesn't my figure show on the dashboard?

Only approved figures count. Check whether it is still a draft, waiting in Review, or returned to you.

Why is an indicator shown as "No target"?

It has no target for the period, or no target has fallen due yet. Indicators without targets are not counted as off track. See Indicators.

How is progress worked out?

With a baseline: (actual − baseline) ÷ (target − baseline). Without one: actual ÷ target. See the progress formula.

Can we change the on-track and at-risk thresholds?

Yes. The defaults are on track at 90% or more and at risk from 70%. Ask ImpactMEL support to set your organisation's thresholds; there is no screen for this yet.

Can a project need two approvals?

Yes. Ask ImpactMEL support to set it for the project. The review queue then shows "1 of 2", and a figure is final after the second approval.

Can I see only my projects?

Field officers and other roles limited to their projects see only the projects they are assigned to. Programme managers see their own projects first.

I hold two roles. How do I switch?

Choose your name at the bottom of the sidebar, then **Work as**. See Finding your way.

Can I still use the old interface?

Yes. Choose **Switch to classic interface** in the user menu. You can switch back at any time.

34.3 Field collection

Do forms work offline?

Partly. Opening a form needs a connection. Once it is open, answers are kept on the phone and sending waits until the connection returns. See what happens without a connection.

Do partners need an account to send data?

No. Share a form's public link. Anyone with the link can fill it in, and responses still go through review.

Can we use KoboToolbox or DHIS2?

Yes. See Integrations.

34.4 Reports and sharing

Can we edit figures in a report?

No. Reports are built from approved figures. To change a figure, correct it through review and refresh the report.

What does the fingerprint on a published report mean?

It is a SHA-256 hash of the report's figures, layout and text at publication. If anything changed, the fingerprint would change. See Publish a report.

Can a funder see our reports without an account?

Yes. Publish the report and create a read-only link. Dashboards can also be shared by link. See Reports and Sharing dashboards.

34.5 Data and security

Who owns our data?

Your organisation does, and it can be exported at any time. See Security and data.

Can we run ImpactMEL on our own servers?

Yes. See Plans and hosting and residency.

Can we turn the AI off?

Yes. An Organisation admin can switch it off for everyone in Workspace settings. See AI features.

34.6 Support

Write to inquiries@impactmel.com.

35 Release notes

What changed in recent ImpactMEL releases, in plain language. Every organisation on the managed cloud runs the same release.

35.1 v0.10.36 · 10 November 2026

- Faster pages for large workspaces: long lists now load page by page.
- Notifications about figures to review go only to people who can review them.

35.2 v0.10.35 · 10 November 2026

- **Progress is measured from the baseline on every screen**, the same way as in reports: (actual − baseline) ÷ (target − baseline). Without a baseline, progress is actual ÷ target. See Indicators.

35.3 v0.10.33 to v0.10.34 · 10 November 2026

- **New quarterly donor report format.** A one-page quarter at a glance, a results matrix with programme totals, what needs attention with owners and dates, delivery by project, a single risk register, next quarter, data notes and sign-off, and an annex. See Reports.
- **Report details panel** for the parts only your team can write: summary, requests to the donor, contact, story of change, actions and target dates.
- Demonstration workspaces mark every report "Sample data".
- Plans are now named **Individual**, **Standard** and **Custom**.

35.4 v0.10.31 to v0.10.32 · 9 November 2026

- **Public dashboard links.** Share a dashboard with anyone, with an expiry date and a switch to turn it off. Small counts are hidden. See Sharing dashboards.
- Large organisation logos now show on public pages.

35.5 v0.10.30 · 9 November 2026

- **Sign-up starts with the plan.** Individual plans skip the organisation name and web address.

35.6 v0.10.27 to v0.10.29 · 7 to 8 November 2026

- **Funder workspace.** Portfolio, grantees, common indicators, requests with donor templates, review with accept and query, board pack export with a fingerprint, and a view log on both sides. See Funder workspace.
- Grantees see funder invitations, choose what to share, and answer requests from the Reports page.

35.7 v0.10.25 to v0.10.26 · 6 to 7 November 2026

- Form responses: view, export to Excel or CSV, and delete.
- Participants: edit, delete, households, and import from CSV or Excel.
- Performance judgements per period in the results framework.
- Project places, and copy or delete programmes and projects with a preview of what is affected.
- Project registers: stakeholders and target groups, evaluations, period narratives and documents.
- Tighter access rules for roles limited to their own projects.

35.8 v0.10.24 · 6 November 2026

- **Budgets and finance.** Budgets on the project page, funding agreements, versions and approval, spending, variance explanations, sign-off and programme roll-ups. New **Finance officer** role. See Budgets and finance.
- **Risk register.** Heat map, reviews, escalation and decisions, donor risk scales. See Risks.
- **Period sign-off** in the new interface: close, lock and reopen with a reason.

35.9 v0.10.21 to v0.10.23 · 4 November 2026

- Security releases: stricter permission and organisation checks across budgets, risks, organisations and related records.

35.10 v0.10.13 to v0.10.20 · 3 to 4 November 2026

- **Analysis and dashboards.** Charts from approved figures, many chart types, maps, saved dashboards with drag and resize, and recommended dashboards.
- Reports: edit a draft before publishing, lock and fingerprint on publish, versions, and your logo on the report page.
- Every number on a home page opens the list behind it.
- Indicators without a target are no longer counted as off track.
- Participants export to CSV.

35.11 v0.10.5 to v0.10.12 · 3 November 2026

- **AI assistant:** draft a form from a description, draft a results framework from a proposal, explain review checks, draft a report narrative. Administrators can switch it off.
- **Form logic:** show a question only when earlier answers call for it, checked on the server too.
- Programme and project pages.
- Automatic data-quality checks in review.

35.12 v0.10.0 to v0.10.4 · 1 to 2 November 2026

- **The new interface (version 2)** is the default, with a home page and menu for each role, and a switch back to the classic interface.
- Self-service sign-up with a 30-day trial, card or invoice payment, and a web address for each organisation.
- Sign in with Google or Microsoft.
- Branded emails.